



INDIA JUST GIFTED THE WORLD A QUESTION

WHY IS
MELODY SO
CHOCOLATY?

¿POR QUÉ LA
MELODY ES TAN
CHOCOLATOSA?

POR QUE
A MELODY É TÃO
CHOCOLATUDA?

Oi, WHY'S
MELODY SO
CHOCOLATY?

TOFFEE È MOLTO,
MOLTO È UONO.

WARUM IST
MELODY SO
SCHOKOLADIG?

MELODY ITNI
CHOCOLATY
KYUN HAI?

なんで
メロディーは
こんなにチョコっぽいの？

Hey mate,
WHY'S MELODY
SO CHOCOLATY?

**Thank you
Honourable Prime Minister
Shri Narendra Modi Ji,**

for sharing a little piece of India
with the world.

Not just a toffee. A memory. A smile.

A question we all have grown up asking.

For over 40 years, India has wondered...

**MELODY ITNI
CHOCOLATY KYUN HAI?**



THIS TIME, THE WORLD JOINED IN.

Parle Melody, sweetening relationships since 1983.



SUGAR BOILED
CONFECTIONERY

Gabbard steps down as US director of national intelligence

Cites husband’s health behind her decision to quit

Meg Kinnard, Will Weissert & David Klepper
Washington, May 22

TULSI GABBARD resigned as President Donald Trump’s director of national intelligence on Friday, saying she needed to step away as her husband battles cancer.

She is the fourth Cabinet official to depart during Trump’s second term. “Unfortunately, I must submit my resignation, effective June 30, 2026,” Gabbard wrote in her resignation letter, which she posted on X.

“My husband, Abraham, has recently been diagnosed with an extremely rare form of bone cancer.” There had been rumblings that Gabbard would split with Trump after the president’s decision to strike Iran, which caused some division within his administration.

Joe Kent, the director of the National Counterterrorism Center, announced his resignation in March, saying he “cannot in good conscience” back the war.

Gabbard, a veteran and former Democratic congresswoman from Hawaii, built her political name on her opposition to foreign wars. This put her in an awkward position when the US joined Israel in launching attacks on Iran on February 28.

She repeatedly dodged questions about whether the White House had been warned of potential fallout from the conflict, including Iran’s effective closure of the Strait of Hormuz. Gabbard said in written remarks to the Senate Intelligence Committee that there

Freed Gaza flotilla activists allege abuse by Israeli forces

Reuters
Rome, Jerusalem, Paris, May 22

ACTIVISTS RELEASED from Israeli custody after being detained on a flotilla trying to bring aid to Gaza were subjected to abuse, organisers said on Friday, with several hospitalised with injuries and at least 15 reporting sexual assaults, including rape. Israel’s prison service denied the allegations.

Germany said some of its nationals had been injured and that some accusations were “serious”, without giving further details. A legal source in Italy said prosecutors there were investigating possible crimes including kidnapping and sexual assault.

“The allegations raised are false and entirely without factual basis,” an Israeli prison service spokesperson said in a statement. “All prisoners and detainees are held in accordance with the law, with full regard for their basic rights and under the supervision of professional and trained prison staff,” it said.



Tulsi Gabbard will continue work till June 30, 2026

had been no effort by Iran to rebuild its nuclear capability after US attacks last year “obliterated” its nuclear program.

That statement contradicted Trump, who has repeatedly asserted that the war was necessary to head off an imminent threat from the Islamic Republic.

This created several awkward exchanges with lawmakers who asked Gabbard for her opinion on the threat posed by Iran as the nation’s top intelligence official. She repeatedly said it was Trump’s decision to strike, not hers.

“It is not the intelligence community’s responsibility to determine what is and is not an imminent threat,” she said.

Gabbard’s departure follows Trump having ousted Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem in late March, in the midst of mounting criticism over her leadership of the department — including the handling of the administration’s immigration crackdown and disaster response.

The second Cabinet member to leave was Attorney General Pam Bondi, in response to growing frustration over the Justice Department’s handling of files related to Jeffrey Epstein.

Labor Secretary Lori Chavez-DeRemer resigned in April, after being the target of various misconduct investigations. **AP**



Recruits of the Ukrainian Armed Forces attend a military training near a frontline in Zaporizhzhia region in Ukraine. REUTERS

35 children wounded in Ukrainian attack: Russia

Reuters
Moscow, May 22

RUSSIAN OFFICIALS said at least four people had been killed and 35 children wounded in an overnight Ukrainian drone attack on a student dormitory in the Russian-controlled Luhansk region in eastern Ukraine.

Reuters was not able to verify what happened independently and there was no immediate comment on Friday from Ukraine, which wants to recapture Luhansk, one of four eastern regions that Moscow unilaterally claimed as its own

THE TWO SIDES ARE AT ODDS OVER URANIUM STOCKPILE, STRAIT OF HORMUZ

Rubio sees progress in Iran talks, but says ‘not there yet’

Jacob Bogage & Parisa Hafezi
Washington, Dubai, May 22

THE UNITED States has seen some progress towards a deal with Iran but more work is required, Secretary of State Marco Rubio said on Friday, as diplomatic efforts intensified to find an end to a conflict that has roiled the global economy.

Iran’s foreign minister met his Pakistani counterpart on Friday to discuss proposals to end the war, Iranian media reported, while Qatar sent a negotiating team to Tehran to try to resolve key differences.

While gaps have been narrowed between the two sides, there are still sticking points over Iran’s enriched uranium and control over the Strait of Hormuz, whose closure since the beginning of the war has triggered a global energy crisis.

“There’s been some progress. I wouldn’t exaggerate it. I wouldn’t diminish it,” Rubio told reporters after a meeting of NATO ministers in Sweden. “There’s more work to be done. We’re not there yet. I hope we get there.”

Rubio reiterated comments made on Thursday that Iran’s



An Iranian woman who lost two of her children in Minab school strike, on February 28, stands at a memorial on Friday. REUTERS

plans for a tolling system for the strait through which a fifth of the world’s oil and liquefied natural gas flows were “unacceptable”.

“We’re dealing with a very difficult group of people, and if it doesn’t change, then the president’s been clear he has other options,” Rubio said.

He also said the U.S. had not asked the NATO military alliance for help on the Strait of Hormuz but that there needed to be a Plan B if Iran refuses to reopen the waterway.

Qatar team in Tehran to secure Iran-US deal

Reuters
May 22

A QATARI negotiating team arrived in Tehran on Friday in coordination with United States to try to help secure a deal to end the war with Iran and resolve outstanding issues, a source with knowledge of the matter told Reuters on Friday.

Doha, which has worked as a mediator in the Gaza war and other areas of international tension, had till now distanced

itself from playing a mediation role in the Iran war after it came under attack from Iranian missiles and drones during the latest conflict.

“A Qatari negotiation team is in Tehran on Friday,” the source said, adding that the team had travelled in coordination with the United States and was there to help “reach a final deal that would end the war and address outstanding issues with Iran.”

The Qatari Ministry of Foreign Affairs did not immediately re-

spond to a request for comment.

While Pakistan has served as the official mediator since fighting began, Qatar’s re-engagement reflects its longstanding role as a US ally in the region and trusted back-channel between Washington and Tehran.

A shaky ceasefire is in place in the war that began with US-Israeli strikes on Iran on February 28, but there has been no major breakthrough, with a U.S. blockade of Iranian ports and Tehran’s effective closure of the Strait of

Pak military chief arrives in Tehran for talks

Press Trust of India
Islamabad, May 22

PAKISTAN ARMY Chief Field Marshal Asim Munir on Friday reached Tehran for a crucial visit to expedite efforts for a deal between the US and Iran to end the war in the region, the army said.

According to a statement issued by the army, Field Marshal Munir’s visit is “part of ongoing mediation efforts”.

On arrival, he was received and warmly welcomed by Iranian Interior Minister Esfandar Momeni at the airport. Pakistan’s Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi was also present at the airport, according to the army.

His second visit to Tehran in little more than a month comes after progress was reported in talks held by Naqvi, who has been in Iran since Wednesday, with top Iranian leadership, including twice with Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi, according to sources.

• BRIEFLY

Foreigners seeking green cards must return to their home countries, apply: US

Jasper Ward
Washington, May 22

FOREIGNERS SEEKING to adjust their immigration status in the United States to secure green cards will have to do so from outside the country via the State Department, the US Citizenship and Immigration Services (CIS) said on Friday, in a move criticized by aid groups.

USCIS announced the move in a policy memo, which directed officers to consider relevant factors and information on a case-by-case basis when determining whether extraordinary relief is warranted.

“An alien who is in the US temporarily and wants a Green Card must return to their home country to apply,” said the U.S. Department of Homeland Security, which has oversight of USCIS. “This policy allows our immigration system to function as the law intended instead of incentivising loopholes.”

The USCIS said the new policy will free up agency resources to focus on processing other cases.

HIAS, an aid group that provides services to refugees, among other groups of immigrants, said USCIS was forcing



Aid groups have criticised the move by the US CIS

survivors of trafficking and abused and neglected children to return to the dangerous countries they fled in order to process their applications for green cards granting them permanent residency in the US Friday’s policy change is the latest in a series of steps taken by U.S. President Donald Trump over the last year to tighten migration to the United States.

Last year, the Trump administration moved to shorten the duration of visas for students, cultural exchange visitors and members of the media.

In January, the State Department announced that it had revoked more than 100,000 visas since Trump took office the year before. **REUTERS**

Probe into King Charles’ brother Andrew will be lengthy: Police



Andrew Mountbatten Windsor, younger brother of King Charles

THE BRITISH police investigation into Andrew Mountbatten-Windsor will be long and complex, senior officers said on Friday, after his arrest earlier this year on suspicion of misconduct in public office, an offence that can include sexual impropriety. King Charles’ younger brother was interviewed under caution for hours by detectives after he was arrested at his home in Norfolk in February following the release of millions of documents by the US Department of Justice relating to the late US sex offender Jeffrey Epstein.

Mountbatten-Windsor, 66, the second son of the late Queen Elizabeth, has always denied any wrongdoing in relation to Epstein, and said he regrets their friendship. He has made no public statement since his arrest. **REUTERS**

Bangladesh seeks Hasina’s return through legal process, says its Home Minister

Press Trust of India
Dhaka, New Delhi, May 22

BANGLADESH’S HOME Minister Salahuddin Ahmed has said the government wants Hasina to return through “legal procedures”, reacting to her recent remarks that she hoped to return home “very soon” despite facing a death sentence.

“We want to get her back through legal procedures,” Ahmed, a senior minister, told reporters on Thursday, adding that he was not aware of any legal obstacle to Hasina’s return if she wished to do so. She has been living in India since August 2024.

The subsequent interim ad-

ministration led by Muhammad Yunus banned the Awami League through an executive order and initiated proceedings against Hasina in Bangladesh’s reconstituted International Crimes Tribunal. Hasina was later sentenced to death in absentia by the tribunal in November 2025.

The BNP government, which came to power in February, endorsed the interim administration’s decision to ban the Awami League. Home Minister Ahmed’s remarks came a day after Prime Minister Rahman’s information affairs adviser Zahedur Rahman said no “extra-judicial measures” would be taken against Hasina if she returned to Bangladesh.

• IT IS REFRESHING TO SEE THIS ALL-MALE COMPANY CHOOSING SILLINESS AS A PRESSURE VALVE

With *Coward*, Lukas Dhont delivers a striking new trench warfare romance



SHUBHRA GUPTA

WHEN YOU think of the war in the trenches during the first World War, the images that come to mind are that of mud trampled under a million boots, young soldiers hunkered down just below the enemy sightline in the cold and damp, never knowing when it will be their turn to die, the grim reaper never far away.

When the tall, silent Pierre (Emmanuel Macchia) arrives at

a Belgian front, the war has been on for some time, even if it isn’t specifically mentioned. He learns, quickly enough, that flinching doesn’t help when the instruction — the ones ‘who are still breathing’ out first — when it comes to lifting bloody bodies out of trucks. But that doesn’t mean that he gets used to it, unlike so many others who get desensitized to the horrors that surround them.

Pierre finds himself drawn to Francis (Valentin Campagne), so different in his quick-silver, artistically inclined ways from his (Pierre’s) rather stolid self. In one of their first exchanges, when you can see the them slowly getting aware to the fact of the other, they learn that Pierre is a

farmer, and Francis, a tailor. And like so many other young men who find themselves plucked from their regular lives, pitchforked into an impossible situation, they learn to ways to unwind after each close shave; they paint, they play-act, they sing, and in all the drag-by-necessity performances, lose themselves, only if momentarily, to the terrible reality to the rain of blood and bones surrounding them. It is refreshing to see this all-male company chooses silliness as a pressure valve.

When the film moves away from the war zone itself, it becomes very much a Lukas Dhont film — a queer romance set during the backdrop of war — in the way it frames the two



(From left) Emmanuel Macchia, Lukas Dhont and Valentin Champagne before the screening of the film *Coward*. REUTERS

young men. Standing in the middle of the make-shift barracks, looking, really looking, at each other. Crawling into the loft-space where they come

breath-close for their first kiss. On a stage from which Pierre sings a song of love and loss: his cheeks may be painted pink, but it’s no vaudeville, the sweet

high-pitched melody makes many in the assembly tear up, from hardened war-horses to the newbies.

The title is bald (Luke’s previous films *Girl*, *Close* are all pointedly one word), but it gets tossed into the cauldron of young men brutally being picked up by gunfire — we never see the ‘Hun’, we only hear references to them — and gets into a churn. One soldier, who has just become a father, yearns to see his baby so much that his hold on reality starts slipping, and his final resting place is a shroud: is he a coward for wanting to leave the war-front, or is his desire to see his new-born so strong that he abandons all discipline that the Army drills into its recruits?

By now, Pierre has become so enamoured by Francis, that he hatches a plan to flee to the mountains. At this point, of course, it’s almost as if *Coward* has entered familiar territory, becoming a cross between *All’s Quiet On The Western Front* and *Brokeback Mountain*. Is Pierre a deserter because he fears for his life — a compatriot flings the term ‘coward’ in his face when Pierre makes too much of an injured hand — or does he want to hold on to the love of his life, and the only way it seems possible for that to happen, is to be far away from the trenches?

The film itself is ambivalent. Or at least that’s what it appears to be, in the way a soldier visiting his home, with Francis having worked for ‘cheap’ in the or-

chards for the past two years, recognises the runaway, crying out in anguish — you were not there. You turned your back on us, your comrades, you did not bear witness. Is he right, or wrong in judging Pierre? It is to be noted that the word ‘coward’ doesn’t come up at this point.

That a war can also create moments of startling beauty, in painting, and in theatre — both art-forms in scarce supply for soldiers battling the enemy — is the burden of Dhont’s film, performed by the two actors beautifully. There’s hardly anything in common between them, and yet when you see them lying next to each other, all you can see is a union that feels right. And in that there’s no ambivalence at all. It is as clear as day.



Happening today

● **PAKISTAN PM** Shehbaz Sharif will begin his visit to China, during which he will meet President Xi Jinping and Premier Li Qiang.

● **IMD'S 'RED ALERT'** will be in place in parts of Maharashtra's Vidarbha, where temperatures touched 47 degrees Celsius.

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CBI ARRESTS ANOTHER PUNE TEACHER WHO HAD ACCESS TO NEET PHYSICS PAPER

'LOOKING AT YOUTH PRESSURE GROUP'

Founder of Cockroach handle: Threats to my family... nobody should be hounded for opinion

Don't defame this by raising Nepal, Lanka, Bangladesh... our dissent peaceful, within Constitution: Dipke

Jatin Anand
New Delhi, May 22

"I DO not want anything to happen to my family because this is a choice I made, not them": Six days after he launched the satirical platform, "Cockroach Janta Party, Abhijeet Dipke told *The Indian Express* that he has been receiving constant threats and is worried about his family in India.

Dipke, 30, is in Boston, where he moved two years ago to pursue a course in public relations. His family lives in Maharashtra's Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar district, formerly known as Aurangabad. "I have been getting constant threats both for myself and my family, which is in India. I just received a video in which a man is saying that they have reached outside my home and that I need to wait until evening to see what

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DAYS AFTER A BENCH QUESTIONED DENIAL OF BAIL TO UMAR, SHARJEEL

Pointing to conflicting views, SC refers UAPA bail question to larger bench

'Settle approach to bail under special statutes where Art 21, prolonged incarceration, statutory restrictions intersect'

Ananthkrishnan G
New Delhi, May 22

FOUR DAYS after a Supreme Court bench raised questions over another bench's January order rejecting bail to 2020 Delhi riots case accused Umar Khalid and Sharjeel Imam, a two-judge bench Friday referred to a larger bench the con-

licting views on granting bail in anti-terror cases on the grounds of prolonged delay in trial.

"We do not propose to enter into any adjudication of the correctness of the observation made by the coordinate bench. Judgements of this court are not to be answered by counter observations from another bench of equal strength. The

discipline of precedent demands a higher institutional method," a bench comprising Justices Aravind Kumar and P B Varale said while referring the issue to the Chief Justice of India for constituting an appropriate bench.

The bench was hearing a bail plea by two accused in the 2020 Delhi riots case, Tasleem

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3-DAY INTERIM BAIL FOR UMAR KHALID

Ahmed and Khalid Saifi, charged under the stringent

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Rubio meets PM today, will also attend Quad huddle on May 26

Says US wants to sell as much energy as India is willing to buy

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, May 22

US SECRETARY of State Marco Rubio, who is reaching Kolkata Saturday morning, will meet Prime Minister Narendra Modi in New Delhi later in the day.

On his first visit to India as



US Secretary of State Marco Rubio in Sweden, Friday. AP

US Secretary of State and National Security Advisor, Rubio will also attend the meeting of Quad Foreign Ministers in New

Delhi on May 26.

He will land in Kolkata around 7 am, and will be in New Delhi by afternoon. His visit to Kolkata is significant because the US consulate in the city was the first American diplomatic outpost not only in India, but also in Asia. It is also the second oldest American diplomatic post in the world, established in the late 18th century. This year is the 250th anniversary of US independence.

In New Delhi, Rubio is expected to meet Modi around 2 pm, and will also be attending

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Absconding for 10 days, Twisha's husband taken into custody; Bar suspends his licence

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, May 22

SAMARTH SINGH, the husband of model and actor Twisha Sharma, was taken into police custody after he reached the Jabalpur district court on Friday "to surrender" — after absconding for 10 days in a dowry death case filed against him and his mother.

His advocate, Jaideep Kaurav, said, "He appeared before the Jabalpur District Court to surrender, but the court was not



Twisha Sharma's husband Samarth Singh arrives at a court in Jabalpur, Madhya Pradesh, Friday. ANI

available. After that, the Jabalpur police took his custody and handed him over to the Bhopal police. I don't have any information about the commotion at the court. There are chances that the police will present him in the Bhopal court tomorrow."

Bhopal Commissioner of Police Sanjay Kumar said, "Yes, he has been taken into custody, and our police team is handling this entire process. He will be questioned as part of the ongoing investigation, and

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24 Rajya Sabha seats, 10 states: NDA looks at two-thirds majority, will know on June 18

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, May 22

THE ELECTION Commission on Friday announced that elections to 24 Rajya Sabha seats across 10 states will be held on June 18 and the votes will be counted the same evening. These seats are set to fall vacant in June and July.

With the BJP's current strength at 113 and the NDA at a consolidated tally of 148 in the Rajya Sabha, the BJP-led alliance is 15 MPs short of the two-

thirds majority in the 245-member House required for significant legislative business such as Constitution amendments. While the NDA is unlikely to achieve this, it will register gains of four seats in Andhra Pradesh and Gujarat taken together and possibly suffer the loss of one seat each in Karnataka and Jharkhand, given how the

numbers are stacked. The NDA tally is likely to climb further but still fall short of a two-thirds majority. The government needs to have a two-thirds majority in a House to pass any Constitution amendment Bill.

Among the well-known MPs whose seats will fall vacant are Union Minister Ravneet Singh Bittu from Rajasthan, Congress

president Mallikarjun Kharge from Karnataka, former Prime Minister and JD(S) leader H D Deve Gowda from Karnataka, former Union minister and Congress leader Digvijaya Singh from Madhya Pradesh, and former Gujarat state Congress president Shaktisinh Gohil.

Four Rajya Sabha MPs each from Andhra Pradesh and Gujarat, three each from Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan, and one each from Manipur and Meghalaya will retire on June 21.

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Delhi HC raps WFI over remarks on Vinesh Phogat's Olympics exit

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, May 22

THE DELHI High Court came down heavily on the Centre and the Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) Friday, taking serious objection to the WFI describing wrestler Vinesh Phogat's 2024 Paris Olympics defeat as a "national shame".

The bench of Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia said it would "pass orders" on Phogat's request to be allowed to participate in the

selection trials for this year's Asian Games in Japan, scheduled on May 30-31.

Despite oral inquiries by the court on multiple occasions, the WFI has so far refused to relent on Phogat's participation. On Friday, the court remarked orally that "we will not leave anything to you (WFI) now".

Phogat has challenged two circulars of the WFI, laying down eligibility criteria for participating in the Asiad selection trials. In a departure from

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Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



BOOST TO GOVT'S FINANCES

Rs 2.86 lakh cr: RBI clears record surplus transfer to Centre

Contingency risk buffer hiked by over Rs 64,000 cr to Rs 109,379 cr

George Mathew
Mumbai, May 22

AT A time when the West Asia conflict and the surge in crude oil prices are weighing heavy on the fisc, the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) Central Board Friday approved a record surplus transfer of Rs 2,86,588 crore to the Central Government for the accounting year 2025-26, offering a significant boost to the Centre's finances.

The higher dividend could help improve the government's overall fiscal position and provide greater flexibility in policy spending during an increasingly tough year ahead.

The dividend payout is approximately 6.7 per cent, or Rs 17,998 crore, higher than the Rs 2,68,590 crore transferred by the RBI in 2024-25, marking the highest-ever surplus transfer by the central bank. The RBI had paid Rs 2,10,874



Dividend payout 6.7 per cent higher than what RBI transferred to the government in 2024-25. REUTERS FILE

E. EXPLAINED

Sparing some for market intervention

The amount transferred to the government could have crossed Rs 3.5 lakh crore had the RBI limited the contingency risk buffer to last year's level. But transfers to the buffer will help the central bank intervene in the financial market as per evolving macro conditions.

crore in FY2023-24 and Rs 87,416 crore in FY2022-23.

The sharp increase in dividend payouts was supported by the RBI's strong earnings during the year. At the same time, the RBI raised the contingency risk buffer (CRB) to Rs 109,379 crore to create a safeguard in case geopolitical tensions escalate or crude oil prices worsen. A significant contributor to higher surplus was the central bank's large-scale sale of US dollars in the foreign exchange market to support the rupee amid persistent depreciation pressures, leading to substantial trading gains for the RBI.

"The transfer would have been Rs 64,518 crore higher had the RBI limited contingency

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SECTION ON JUDICIAL CORRUPTION

SC recalls own order blacklisting 3 experts over NCERT book row

Ananthkrishnan G
New Delhi, May 22

THE SUPREME Court Friday recalled its March 11 direction blacklisting academics Michel Danino, Suparna Diwakar and Alok Prasanna Kumar in connection with the row over the inclusion of a section on "corruption in the judiciary" in the NCERT Class 8 Social Science textbook, publication and distribution of which was banned.

Its March 11 order had come in the wake of the court taking suo motu cognizance of the matter following a report in *The Indian Express* on February 24.

The bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi agreed to pleas by the three academics to remove the directions against them.

"While we reiterate, in no

uncertain terms, that the curriculum contained in the Class 8 NCERT textbook was wholly undesirable and unnecessary, remedial steps regarding the insertion of new content relating to the Indian judiciary have already been initiated by the Government of India through the constitution of an expert committee headed by a former judge of this Court," the bench said.

"However, in view of the explanation furnished by the applicants, namely the authors, we deem it appropriate to modify paragraph 8 of the order and recall the direction issued to the Government of India, the State Governments, Union Territories, universities, and educational institutions to disassociate themselves from the applicants in academic activities," it said.

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INDIA AND CYPRUS ELEVATE THEIR TIES TO STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP
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● **KERALA TRANSPORT MINISTER CP JOHN IS COMMUNIST MARXIST PARTY (CMP) CHIEF AND A FIRST-TIME MLA**

'No room for despair': Country's lone Communist minister charts new course

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, May 22

WHILE THE recent Kerala Assembly elections saw the ouster of the country's last CPI(M)-led Left government, the poll outcome has also left one of the Left's ideological embers in the form of CP John glowing in the new Congress-led UDF government.

A first-time MLA, John, 68, is the lone legislator of the Communist Marxist Party (CMP), who has been inducted as the Transport Minister in the Chief Minister V D Satheesan-led Cabinet in Kerala.

A long-standing partner of the UDF, John is now the only communist minister serving in any state government. This is the first time in five decades that the Left is not in power in any state in the country.

In the polls, John rounced a Left-backed Independent to win the Thiruvananthapuram Assembly seat, even as the UDF ended the decade-long rule of the Pinarayi Vijayan-led LDF.

During the Satheesan Cabinet's swearing-in ceremony Monday, John, who is also the CMP general secretary, underscored his communist roots by opting for a solemn affirmation instead of taking

the oath in the name of God, unlike 19 other ministers. The Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP)'s Shibu Baby John also opted for a solemn affirmation.

The last time the CMP bagged a seat in an Assembly election was in 2001. At the time, party founder and its sole MLA from Trivandrum West, M V Raghavan, who had walked out of the CPI(M) in 1986, also served as a minister in the UDF government.

In the 2026 elections, the Congress was keen to allot a "safe seat" to John, who had not made it to the Assembly despite being a key UDF face over the last three decades. In 2011 and 2016, John had contested the



Kerala Transport Minister C P John (left) being administered the oath of office by Governor Rajendra Arlekar on May 18. ANI

Kunnankulam seat, but could not win.

This time, he contested from Thiruvananthapuram —

a seat won by the UDF in all but one election since 1977 — despite resentment among a section of the UDF leaders. But

John emerged victorious with a margin of nearly 10,000 votes, defeating the LDF's Sudheer Karamana, an actor, and the BJP's Karamana Jayan.

In 1986, the CPI(M) had ousted its Kannur heavyweight M V Raghavan after he argued for an alliance with the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML). John had then been a part of the national leadership of the party's student wing Students' Federation of India (SFI). At a time when most prominent leaders chose to remain with the CPI(M), John took a different path. Along with Raghavan, he left the party and played a key role in the CMP's formation. A fiery young communist,

John soon emerged as an intellectual face of the CMP, a role he continued to play after the party aligned with the UDF. During the two UDF regimes from 2001 to 2006 and 2011 to 2016, he served as a member of the State Planning Board, helping shape various development projects.

After Raghavan's death in 2014, the CMP suffered a split with a section of leaders later merging again with the CPI(M). Despite the party weakening over the years, John stuck to its ideology. In 2011, when the UDF came to power, John lost his contest by just 481 votes.

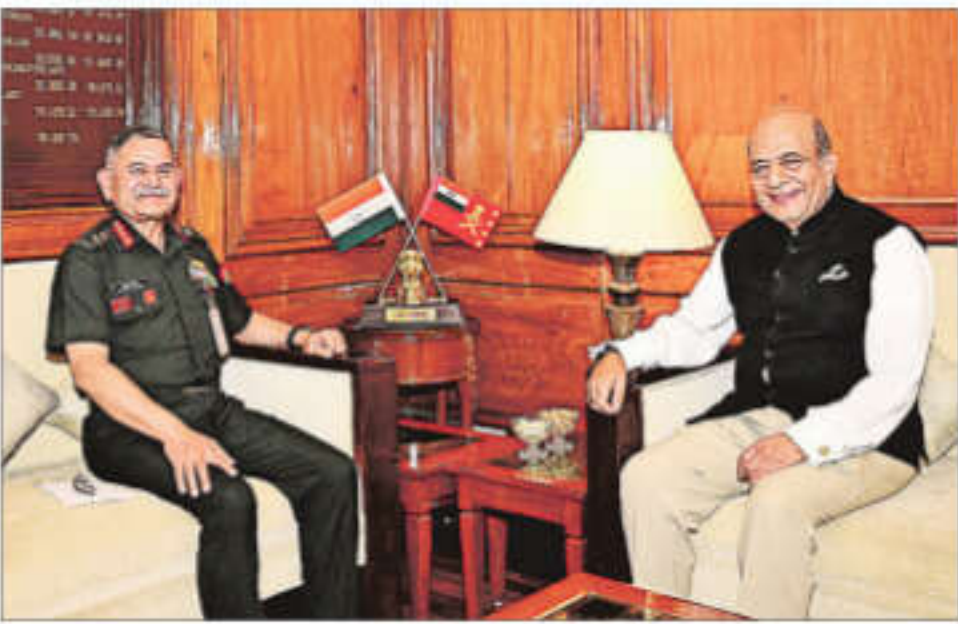
On his long political journey, John told *The Indian Express* that "There is no room for des-

pair. We cannot say the recognition came very late. It is politics."

John, who is also the leader of Confederation of Indian Communists and Democratic Socialists (CICDS), a coalition of splinter communist parties in the country, said he is planning to strengthen the organisation. "We will open communication with the CPI(M) rebels, including leaders who have come out of the party and won with UDF backing," John said.

On the defeat of the LDF in the Kerala elections, John said, "The CPI(M) never expected they would be defeated. The party failed to realise it was heading towards defeat. That

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Dhaka-bound

Army chief General Upendra Dwivedi with the High Commissioner-Designate of India to Bangladesh Dinesh Trivedi, in New Delhi. “The interaction focused on strengthening India-Bangladesh defence ties, border security and enhancing military-to-military engagement,” the Army said in a post on X. PTI

Two Indians die while descending Everest summit

Press Trust of India Kathmandu, May 22

TWO INDIAN mountaineers who summited Everest have died while descending, an official said on Friday.

The climbers, identified as Arun Kumar Tiwari and Sandeep Are, were exhausted while they were coming down from the peak and could not be saved despite the best efforts of their guides, said Rishi Bhandari, secretary general of the Expedition Operators Association of Nepal. It appears that Are summited on Wednesday and Tiwari on Thursday around 5.30 pm, Bhandari told PTI. The guides “worked really hard” but were not able to save them, he said.

Tiwari died near the Hillary Step, just below the summit, after falling ill during his descent on Thursday evening while being assisted by four Sherpa climbers, said Nivesh Karki, Director at Pioneer Adventures, which organised the expedition. Are summited on Wednesday but became unwell during the descent. He was rescued by Sherpa guides from the South Summit and died shortly after arriving at Camp II early Friday, Karki said.

Efforts are underway to bring back the bodies of the deceased climbers to Kathmandu, Karki said.

With this, the death toll on Everest has reached five this season. Earlier, three Nepali

Record-holder urges limit on climbers

A RENOWNED Mount Everest guide, who this week scaled the peak a record 32nd time, urged authorities on Friday to limit climbers on the summit.

The number of climbers making the ascent on the peak from the Nepalese side is higher this season because China has closed the route from Tibet. On Wednesday, 274 climbers reached the summit - the highest number on a single day from the Nepal side.

“It was very crowded this year compared to last year because there were more clients,” Kami Rita Sherpa told reporters. “There is a need for authorities to control this number.” -AP

climbers died on Mt Everest.

On Wednesday, three Indians, including Are, were part of 274 climbers who summited the 8,848.86-metre peak. It was a new record for the highest number of ascents ever recorded in a day. The other two were Tulas Reddi Palpunoori and Ajay Pal Singh Dhalialwal.

The following day, on Thursday, India's Lakshmi Kanta Mandal also reached the world's highest peak.

Hours after retirement party, principal falls to death in drain in Kota, 3 engineers suspended

Hamza Khan Jaipur, May 22

THE KOTA Development Authority (KDA) on Friday suspended three of its engineers and imposed a penalty of Rs 17 lakh on the contractor after a retired school principal driving his motorbike fell into an under-construction drain in the Borkhera area and died.

On Wednesday evening, retired principal Rameshwar Rawal was felicitated by his former colleagues at his retirement party. They reportedly garlanded the 60-year-old and honoured him with a Rajasthani turban. Rawal also posed for photos with his friends.

These would be Rawal's last photos, as hours later, his bike fell into an under-construction drain while he was on his way home. As his family desperately searched for him, Rawal's body was found the next day.

ASI Dharmveer Singh, posted at Kota's Borkhera police station, said, “We received information that there is a bike in the drain. The information was only about the bike, but when the bike was pulled out, there was a body underneath it. It was taken to the Maharao Bhim Singh Hospital (MBS), where the doctors declared him dead.”

Singh said police identified Rawal from the bike's registration number and contacted his relatives. “His son answered and said that he had been missing since the night before. We then handed the body to the family,” he said.

The principal's nephew, Manish Rawal, said that his uncle did not return at night and his phone could not be reached. The body was found on Thursday when locals in

Gokul colony spotted a motorcycle in the local drain and informed the police.

ASI Singh said that the drain “is on the corner of the Gokul colony and Adarsh Nagar where some construction is underway.” Nephew Manish said, “The drain was quite deep, and he died from drowning in it. This is the administration's failure; they keep digging holes every other day and don't care about it.”

Singh said that a post-mortem has also been conducted and a case has been lodged.

After the incident came to light, executive engineer Sagar Meena, assistant engineer Lalchand Matoria and junior engineer Vinod Madawat were suspended for negligence, KDA secretary Mukesh Choudhary said. The contractor tasked with the drain construction work was fined Rs 17 lakh — 10% of the contract amount — for not covering the drain or putting up a cautionary sign, the secretary said.

“Action was taken based on a probe report of a committee headed by the KDA deputy commissioner, who visited the site early Friday morning,” Choudhary said.

Meanwhile, the Congress targeted the state government, calling the incident “extremely tragic”.

“It is even more unfortunate that no action will be taken against those responsible for this tragic incident under the BJP government, because for the BJP government, the life of the common man has no value, nor can the government hold anyone accountable,” former Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot said.

WITH PTI INPUTS

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

RBI's surplus transfer

risk buffer (CRB) to the last year level of Rs 44,862 crore. Transferring higher amount to the CRB will help in RBI intervening in the financial market as per the evolving domestic and global macroeconomic conditions,” said Devendra Kumar Pant, Chief Economist, India Ratings & Research.

The ongoing geopolitical tensions, conflict in West Asia, risks to energy prices, and volatility in bond and currency markets may have led the RBI to favour building a stronger CRB,

analysts said.

In addition, the RBI benefited from higher returns on its foreign currency assets as global interest rates remained elevated across major advanced economies. The increase in yields on overseas securities and investments strengthened the central bank's income position, enabling it to transfer a larger surplus to the government while maintaining adequate risk buffers.

The record transfer is expected to provide the govern-

ment, which has been facing a fiscal strain, with additional fiscal space, helping it to manage expenditure commitments, support infrastructure spending, and contain the fiscal deficit without significantly increasing borrowing.

“Surplus transfer by RBI is 90.8 per cent of budgeted non-tax revenue under ‘dividend/surplus of Reserve Bank of India, Nationalised Banks & Financial Institutions’ head for FY27 (BE). Higher transfer will reduce some pressure on the fiscal deficit due to the geopolitical situation,” Pant said.

The enhanced inflow will provide the government with

greater flexibility to increase infrastructure and capital expenditure, particularly in sectors such as transportation, energy, urban development and public logistics, which are seen as key drivers of long-term economic growth.

The higher dividend payout is expected to ease concerns surrounding the government's borrowing programme by lowering the need for additional market borrowing during the financial year. This could help contain bond yield — 10-year benchmark yield is at 7.09 per cent now — and reduce upward pressure on interest rates, thereby supporting overall financial stability.

and how long he can stay in the US, Dipke said. “Have a full visa. Currently, my visa gives me the option to stay (in the US) until July. I have no tension till July, but I will have to return to India sometime... People will say, ‘he is himself sitting in the US. What is he asking us to do?’”

To a question on whether he has a plan, he replied, “I had not made any plans at all since I had not anticipated that something like this would happen at such a level. I am trying to talk to the relevant people so I can have more options.”

Dipke said GenZ “are exerting a lot of pressure on me, like, ‘don't back off, now you have started something’”.

Asked about his plans regarding the “party,” and whether he was looking to register it, he said: “I had not thought this far ahead; this had begun as a satire. But let's see what they (the people) say; we are going to take suggestions; we will see how it turns out. But it will be too early to say anything...”

“(It) will mostly be like a political front operating like a pressure group; that is what I have thought for the time being. Going forward, let's see, as we identify more and more people.”

immediately thereafter.

Meanwhile, in its petition filed before the High Court, the state government alleged that the sessions court granted anticipatory bail to Giribala Singh “in a very mechanical manner without going through the prosecution evidence,” despite what it described as “crystal clear allegations” emerging from WhatsApp chats between Twisha Sharma and her parents.

One of the strongest allegations made by the state concerns the handling and public circulation of CCTV footage from the house where Twisha was found dead. According to the petition, police had already seized the CCTV footage from the residence on May 13 as part of the investigation.

However, the government alleged that Giribala Singh had separately retained copies of the footage and strategically leaked “selected small clips” on social

media “in a manner to tamper prosecution evidence and obstruct investigation.”

According to the state, the investigating officer issued notices to Giribala Singh on May 13 and May 14 directing her to cooperate in the investigation, but “she did not turn up.” Even after securing anticipatory bail, the state alleged, she continued to evade investigators.

The petition states that a notice sent on WhatsApp on May 20 seeking her appearance for questioning went unanswered despite being seen. It further alleged that when a police officer visited her residence on May 21, her domestic help informed police that she was unavailable and refused to accept the notice.

“Thus, it is apparent that she is not cooperating in the investigation and is blatantly violating the terms and conditions of the order of grant of anticipatory bail,” the government argued.

Threats to my family...

happens next,” he said.

“Cockroach Janta Party” was launched in response to a remark by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant on those who “attack the system”. On May 15, the CJI pulled up a lawyer who had filed a petition seeking directions to the Delhi High Court over the designation of a Senior Advocate, a status he himself was aspiring to. The CJI questioned if “pursuing” the designation looked “proper”. “There are already parasites of society who attack the system, and you want to join hands with them? There are youngsters like cockroaches, who don't get any employment or have any place in (the) profession. Some of them become media, some of them become social media, RTI activists and other activists, and they start attacking everyone,” he said.

The remarks triggered an uproar, following which the CJI clarified that it is “totally baseless” to suggest that he criticised the youth. “What I had specifically criticised were those who have entered professions like the Bar (legal profession) with

the aid of fake and bogus degrees. Similar persons have sneaked into the media, social media, and other noble professions as well, and hence, they are like parasites. It is totally baseless to suggest that I criticised the youth of our nation. Not only am I proud of our present and future human resource, but every youth of India inspires me,” he said.

Dipke had criticised the CJI's remark and announced a platform for “cockroaches”, triggering an online trend. On Thursday, the X account of Cockroach Janta Party was withheld in India. *The Indian Express* reported that this was done at the direction of the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) after inputs from the Intelligence Bureau flagging “national security concerns”.

Dipke said his family should not face the consequences of his decisions. “Nobody's family should be hounded like this just for expressing their opinions,” he said.

Asked about his visa status

Twisha

necessary seizures will be carried out. He will be produced in court tomorrow.”

Samarth had evaded the police for 10 days, and a reward of Rs 10,000 for information leading to his arrest was later increased to Rs 30,000.

The Bhopal-based lawyer had entered Jabalpur court wearing a mask, cap and sunglasses. Meanwhile, the Bar Council of India's chairman, Manan Kumar Mishra, said that Samarth's license had been suspended, given the “seriousness of the case”.

Meanwhile, Justice Avanimdra Kumar Singh of the Madhya Pradesh High Court heard a batch of connected matters arising out of Twisha's death.

The court heard preliminary submissions on Twisha's

father's plea seeking a second postmortem of his daughter at AIIMS Delhi. During the proceedings, the state indicated that it would not oppose a second postmortem.

At the same time, the court also took up petitions filed both by Twisha's father and the state government seeking cancellation of the anticipatory bail granted to Twisha's mother-in-law, Giribala Singh. Both petitions allege that the retired judicial officer tampered with evidence, leaked selective CCTV footage, failed to cooperate with investigators and influenced the investigation.

Addressing reporters after the hearing in Jabalpur, Madhya Pradesh Advocate General Prashant Singh said the High Court directed the Director of AIIMS Delhi to constitute a medical board for conducting the second postmortem and ordered that logistical support be arranged

Rubio

an event at the US embassy.

On Sunday, he will meet External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and attend the US Independence Day celebrations in the evening. He is likely to visit Agra and Jaipur Monday.

On Friday, the Ministry of External Affairs, in a statement, said: “At the invitation of External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, the Foreign Minister of Australia, Penny Wong; the Foreign Minister of Japan, Toshimitsu Motegi; and the United States Secretary of State, Marco Rubio, will undertake an official visit to New Delhi to participate in the Quad Foreign Ministers' meeting on 26 May 2026.”

“In keeping with the Quad vision for a free and open Indo-Pacific, the Ministers will build

on discussions held in Washington, D.C. on 1 July 2025. They will exchange views on advancing Quad cooperation across priority areas, review progress on ongoing Quad initiatives, and reflect on recent developments in the Indo-Pacific region and other international issues of mutual concern,” it said.

During their visit to New Delhi, the Foreign Ministers are also expected to hold bilateral meetings with the External Affairs Minister and call on Prime Minister Modi, the MEA said.

US State Department spokesperson Thomas “Tommy” Pigott, in a statement, said, “Secretary Rubio will travel to India from May 23-26, where he will visit Kolkata, Agra, Jaipur, and New Delhi. The Secretary will discuss energy security, trade, and defense cooperation during meetings with senior Indian officials.”

Ahead of the visit, Rubio said

the US is ready to sell as much energy as India is willing to buy.

Interacting with reporters in Miami before heading out to Sweden and India, he described India as a “great partner” and said his visit was important as it would give him an opportunity to meet with ministers from the Quad nations.

“Well, we want to sell them as much energy as they'll buy. And obviously, you've seen, I think, we're at historic levels of US production, and US export,” he said.

“We want to be able to do more. We were already in talks with them to do more. We want them to be a bigger part of their portfolio. We also think there are opportunities with Venezuelan oil,” he said.

Describing India as “a great ally, a great partner,” he said, “We do a lot of good work with them. And so it is an important trip. I'm glad we're able to do it because I

falling vacant, and one is held by the ruling Telugu Desam Party (TDP). This too shall change, as the present party position in the 175-member Assembly is 135 for TDP, 21 for Jana Sena Party, eight for the BJP, and 11 for the YSRCP. The quota to win is 36. In this situation, the NDA with 164 seats is sure to win all four seats.

In Gujarat, the BJP at present has three seats out of the four falling vacant and the Congress one in the 182-member House. The quota to win any of the four seats is 37. With the BJP having 156 MLAs and the Congress 17, all four seats are set to go to the BJP.

In Rajasthan, the BJP has two and the Congress one among the three seats falling vacant in the 200-seat Assembly. The quota to win a seat is 51. With the BJP having 115 seats

and the Congress 69, the BJP is again expected to bag two seats and the Congress one.

In Madhya Pradesh, the BJP has two among the three seats falling vacant and the Congress 1 in the 230-seat Assembly. The quota here is thus 58, while the present strength of the BJP and the Congress is 163 and 66, respectively. The BJP thus seems set to bag two seats again, and the Congress one, unless the BJP springs a surprise by bagging all three.

In Jharkhand's 81-member Assembly, the quota is 28, as two seats are falling vacant. As of now, the BJP and JMM share one each. Given the present strength of 56 for the INDIA bloc and 24 for the NDA, the Opposition will look to clinch both seats, while the NDA will try to bag one through strategy.

UAPA bail question

Unlawful Activities Prevention Act (UAPA), when Additional Solicitor General S V Raju and Advocate Rajat Nair, appearing for the Government of the National Capital Territory of Delhi, requested referring the issue to a larger bench. Raju brought up the May 18 ruling and said the logic of that ruling would have ensured bail to Mumbai terror attack convict Ajmal Kasab.

“If we take the case of Ajmal Kasab, there are a large number of witnesses. Will the court grant him bail, given that he has been in jail for seven or eight years? It can't be done. Therefore, you have to examine the facts of each case. Suppose if (Lashkar-e-Taiba's) Hafiz Saeed is brought from Pakistan and tried, and he is in jail for five years because there are a large number of witnesses (because) you have to collect evidence from abroad, will the court release him on bail (saying) no, no, five years (has passed)?” Raju contended.

On May 18, a two-judge bench comprising Justices B V Nagarathna and Ujjal Bhuyan granted bail to a resident of Jammu and Kashmir, Syed Iftikhar Andrabi, in custody since 2020 under the UAPA in a narco-terror case. The Court relied on a landmark 2021 three-judge bench precedent of the Supreme Court in *Union Of India vs KA Najeib* which had held that violation of a fundamental right, like the right to speedy trial, can be a ground for the grant of bail even under a stringent law like the UAPA. The bench had then upheld the bail granted to an accused jailed since April 2015 for alleged involvement in chopping the hand of a Kerala profes-

sor in 2010. The bench, in doing so, expressed “reservations” over how the precedent was interpreted in the January ruling.

“We have serious reservations on various aspects of the judgment in *Gulfisha Fatima*, including foreclosing the right of the two appellants to seek bail for a period of one year. The judgment in *Gulfisha Fatima* would have us believe that Najeib is only a narrow and exceptional departure from Section 43-D(5) justified in extreme factual situations. It is this hollowing out of the import of the observations in Najeib that we are concerned with,” the bench had said. Section 43-D(5) of the UAPA is the provision that deals with bail and lays down a rather high bar for the grant of bail, making it virtually impossible for an accused to secure bail. A key exception to this is the ground of delay in the trial.

In January, the two-judge bench denying bail to Khalid and Imam and barring them from approaching the Court for bail for a year, considered the Najeib precedent and said that it was not persuaded that “on the present record, continued detention has crossed the threshold of constitutional impermissibility so as to override the statutory embargo.” Incidentally, the January ruling was also delivered by a bench headed by Justice Kumar, who referred the same question to a larger bench.

When two or more benches of equal strength disagree on the interpretation of a precedent or take contrary legal positions, then the case is referred to a larger bench to “settle the law.”

Delhi HC raps WFI

previous years, the criteria made medal wins in 2025 or 2026 mandatory to be eligible to even participate in the selection trials.

This means that Phogat, who has been on a break since December 2024 — which included a maternity break — is excluded from participation.

Phogat has also challenged a showcase notice sent by the WFI on May 9, accusing her of indiscipline, violations of anti-doping regulations, and breaches of United World Wrestling (UWW) rules.

The notice also accused her of failing to make the weight at the 2024 Paris Olympics, “resulting in disqualification and national embarrassment”. She has been barred from participating in any WFI events until June 26, even though the world federation has held that she is eligible to participate from January 1 this year.

On Friday, the bench strongly objected to the WFI terming Phogat's failure to make weight by 100 grams in the 50 kg category as a “national shame”.

CJ Upadhyaya said, “The mishap that happened with this lady, was it a national shame?... She reached the finals and was disqualified for being overweight by how many grams?... Can you describe it as a national shame? One of the reasons indicated in the showcase notice is national shame?... That's how

you're serving the cause of wrestling in the country?... She became a mother only in July 2025, and motherhood in this country is celebrated. It is not to be looked upon like this. Everything is clear. What are her credentials, how many medals has she won?... Don't act in vengeance.”

On May 3, Phogat said she was one of the six women wrestlers who had complained about alleged sexual harassment by former WFI chief Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh, a former MP.

The bench also pulled up the Centre over its inaction against sports administrators, and for “sitting silent” on the WFI's “retrograde” eligibility criteria that excluded wrestlers of repute from participating in selection trials.

The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports told the court that it “cannot step into the shoes of the WFI because then I (the Ministry) risk some international repercussions”. It was WFI and not the Central government that had set the eligibility criteria for participation in the selection trials, the Ministry said.

The Centre, however, said that if WFI decided to make an exception to allow Phogat to participate, either by modifying its criteria or by taking a decision to include her participation, it would “fully support them”.

Communist minister

showed a breakdown in communication within its organisational structure from the grassroots to the leadership. Several prominent leaders reportedly joined hands with rebels to work against the party candidates in Taliparamba, Payyanur and Ambalapuzha seats.” John, who has authored several books in Malayalam and English, said he had anticipated this verdict. In Ambalapuzha, where rebel CPI(M) leader G Sudhakaran emerged victorious, minority groups voted against party candidate H Salam, he claimed.

On the road ahead for the CPI(M), John said that “anything can happen” in the party. “The CPI(M) will break up without (ex-CM) Pinarayi Vijayan in the present situation. The coming days could be highly unpredictable for the party. Although Pinarayi has suffered an electoral setback, he remains organisationally strong. This election showed that the CPI(M) no longer has any sure seats to win. The party has lost several of its traditional citadels, and the election results have shattered them,” John said.

NCERT

The bench said the Centre and state governments and other authorities will be free to make their own decisions on associating with them, independent of its observations.

“In this regard, we leave it open to the Union of India, the State Governments, and other competent authorities to take an independent decision without being influenced by the observations made in paragraph

8 of the aforesaid order,” it said. It also recalled the first line of paragraph 8 of its March 11 order which said the three academics had deliberately and knowingly misinterpreted the facts.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said the government would not like to associate itself with the three experts. “We would not like to be associated with any such members who drafted that Class 8 chapter,” he said.

The bench said it was up to the government what to do.

HC notice to AAP's Gopal Rai, journalist Saurav Das on criminal contempt plea

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, May 22

THE DELHI High Court on Friday issued notice to AAP leader Gopal Rai and journalist Saurav Das in a plea accusing them of running a “coordinated campaign” against Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma.

The petition by lawyer Ashok Chaitanya also named AAP convenor and former Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal and AAP leader Saurabh Bhardwaj as parties.

Criminal contempt proceedings against Kejriwal and six others, initiated suo motu by the High Court earlier this month, is already pending.

Seeking response from Rai and Das, Justices Navin Chawla and Ravinder Dudeja clubbed the matter for hearing with the suo motu criminal contempt proceedings it initiated on May 14, and appointed senior advocate Rajdipa Behura as amicus curiae in the case.

“...instead of multiplying the number of matters, this contempt case be also be taken up along with that matter (suo motu criminal contempt proceedings),” the bench directed, while ordering that Kejriwal and Bhardwaj be also served with the latest petition. It also directed the Registry to preserve the social media material relied on in the petition, that Chaitanya told the court, were still online.

Chaitanya's plea alleged that Das and the AAP leaders, during the hearing of the applications by some AAP leaders, seeking recusal of Justice Sharma from hearing the CBI's plea challenging the discharge of 23 accused in the alleged liquor policy scam, initiated a “concerted and orchestrated campaign” on X and published and amplified content containing “serious, unfounded, and scandalous allegations” against her.

The plea objected to the posts which purportedly highlighted “supposed conflict of interest, bias, and impropriety, based on misleading assertion” in relation to Justice Sharma's family.

On May 14, Justice Sharma, in an order, had accused Kejriwal, Sisodia, Pathak, former party MLA Vinay Mishra, AAP Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh, party's Delhi president Bhardwaj, and Devesh Vishwakarma, who is said to be involved in AAP's social media operations, for alleged contempt of court by publishing “contemptuous material” against her and the judiciary on social media.

Umar Khalid gets 3-day interim bail for his mother's surgery

A lower court had earlier declined to grant interim bail

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, May 22

THE DELHI High Court on Friday granted jailed student activist Umar Khalid interim bail for three days from June 1 to 3 to attend to his mother, who is due to undergo a surgery.

A division bench of Justices Prathiba Singh and Madhu Jain recorded that it is taking an “empathetic view”, while noting that Khalid was denied regular bail by the Supreme Court in January as he appeared to be one of the “prime conspirators” in the 2020 north-east Delhi larger conspiracy case under the stringent UAPA.

Khalid sought interim bail for 15 days to attend the 40th day death ritual of his uncle as well as to take care of his mother who is due to undergo a minor surgery. He has earlier been released thrice on interim bail during the period of his incarceration as an undertrial.

“The court is also conscious of the fact that the regular bail application was rejected by the SC on January 5, the appellant being one of the prime conspirators... However, taking an



Umar Khalid

empathetic view that his mother is due to undergo surgery, this court is inclined to grant interim bail from June 1, 7am to June 3, 5pm,” the bench recorded. The court did not grant him interim bail to attend his uncle's death ritual.

While ASG SV Raju, appearing for Delhi Police on Friday, impressed that Khalid be released only with police escort, the court did not order for the same.

The court has ordered him to furnish surety and personal bond of Rs 1 lakh and also restrained him from moving beyond NCR region, permitting him to stay at his residence at Jamia Nagar and to visit the hospital only.

On May 19, a day after the Supreme Court, while underlining that bail is the rule and jail an exception even in UAPA cases, expressed “serious reservations” on the decision of one of its own benches to deny bail to activist Umar Khalid in the

2020 Delhi riots case, a Delhi court had declined to grant him interim bail.

While noting that Khalid and other co-accused in the case have “never flouted conditions imposed by the court”, it, however, recorded: “But it doesn't mean that on every occasion, whenever the accused seeks bail, the court should grant it.”

In January, a division bench of the Supreme Court, comprising Justices Aravind Kumar and NV Anjarlia, while granting bail to five accused in the larger conspiracy case, had declined bail to Khalid and activist Sharjeel Imam, saying they stood on a “higher footing in the hierarchy of participation”. The court had observed that prolonged incarceration cannot be an “absolute entitlement” to seek bail in terror cases.

On May 18, another division bench of the Supreme Court, comprising Justices B V Nagarathna and Ujjal Bhuyan, expressed its disagreement with the January order. It referred to the three-judge decision in K A Najeeb in 2021, which had said that an accused undertrial suffering long incarceration under UAPA with no end in sight to the criminal trial must be enlarged on bail.

Khalid has been in jail for five years and eight months, since his arrest in September 2020.

Big relief for property owners as govt slashes infra charges of water, sewer

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, May 22

IN A major relief for residents, the Delhi government has announced major reductions in ‘Infrastructure Charges’ paid by property owners while constructing a new house, along with a 50% rebate for all properties in E- and F-category colonies and a 70% rebate for properties in G and H categories.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said, “Infrastructure Charges (IFCs) for water and sewer will be levied on water demand basis and only on new development or additional construction within a property...It will not apply to redevelopment cases where the water demand remains unchanged.”

“For instance, A & B category who earlier paid Rs 13.18 lakh as IFC charges, will have to pay Rs 5.4 lakh now...the E to H residential category who paid Rs 3.29 lakh will get rebate of 50% (E&F) and 70% (G&H)...,” said the CM, adding that non-FAR and open/uncovered areas will not be considered for calculation of water demand and IFC.

Gupta said the changes in the IFC of the Delhi Jal Board will bring transparency in the system and provide relief to the public.

IFCs are paid by buyers or those constructing a new house to the government during the registration of the property and documentation process, for facilities like water connection, pipeline, sewer line, roads, etc.

Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh, meanwhile, accused the previous AAP gov-



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh during a press conference on Friday. PRAVEEN KHANNA

• Revised charges

Residential house (above 200 sqm, 300 FAR, 4-storey building)		
Category of Colony	Old	New
A,B	Rs 13,18,412	Rs 5,40,000
E,F	Rs 3,29,579	Rs 2,70,000 (50% rebate)
G,H	Rs 3,29,579	Rs 1,62,000 (70% rebate)

Industry (1,000 sqm, 150 FAR, 4-storey building)		
Category of Colony	Old	New
A,B	Rs 57,67,871	Rs 8,91,000
E,F	Rs 16,47,974	Rs 4,45,500 (50% rebate)
G,H	Rs 16,47,974	Rs 2,67,300 (70% rebate)

ernment of using the IFC system to harass the public.

“Charges that were once reasonable suddenly became six to seven times higher after they changed the formula from practical usage-based calculations to complicated area-based calculations. Ordinary families trying to build their homes had to pay Rs 15-20 lakh or more. People were trapped in confusing rules related to

built-up area, FAR, balconies, staircases and measurements,” Singh said.

This led to corruption, harassment and endless visits to government offices, he said.

“We have simplified the IFC process and made it transparent and fair. Plots up to 200 square metres will remain exempt, and there will be no

Vigilance team raids CPA over ‘Rs 350-crore procurement irregularities’; DGHS transferred

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi, May 22

THE DELHI Directorate of Vigilance conducted raids at the office of the Central Procurement Agency (CPA) on Wednesday and Thursday night following complaints of alleged irregularities in procurement tenders related to medicines, surgical items and medical equipment, sources said.

Amid the probe, sources claimed, the Delhi government transferred Dr Vatsala Aggarwal, who was serving as Director General of Health Services (DGHS), and replaced her with the medical superintendent of Jag Pravesh Chandra Hospital.

Sources said complaints were received regarding pro-

curement of medicines and medical equipment worth over Rs 350 crore at prices allegedly higher than prevailing market rates. Questions have also allegedly been raised over the necessity of these purchases, procurement procedures and possible financial irregularities.

The CPA, the nodal authority under DGHS for the Government of the NCT of Delhi, is responsible for acquiring medicines, surgical consumables, and medical equipment for all state-run hospitals and healthcare facilities.

According to sources, the Directorate of Vigilance had allegedly received confidential complaints regarding irregularities in the procurement process of medicines and equip-

Complaints received regarding procurement of medicines, devices at prices allegedly higher than market rates: Sources

ment, following which a Vigilance team reached the CPA of office and initiated a probe.

During the raid, the team allegedly seized files related to procurement of medicines and medical equipment. The officials are now allegedly examining major tenders connected with hospitals and scrutinising documents related to X-ray and MRI machines, anaesthesia ma-

chines, medicines, surgical equipment, chairs, modular operation theatres and other medical items. During the raid, Vigilance officials allegedly questioned employees and seized important files linked to the procurement process.

The matter allegedly reached the Lieutenant Governor's office, after which Dr Aggarwal was removed as DGHS. Sources alleged she was questioned by Vigilance officials and that a team conducted searches at her residence.

According to sources, complaints had been made regarding multiple tenders, alleging that contracts were awarded without proper technical evaluation and that equipment and infrastructure items were

procured without adequate justification. It was also alleged that certain firms repeatedly got contracts worth crores of rupees for medicines, surgical equipment, diagnostic devices and anaesthesia-related items.

Dr Aggarwal was appointed DGHS last August. She had earlier faced a Vigilance inquiry initiated by the Health and Family Welfare department over alleged manipulation of recruitment rules during her tenure as the director of Delhi State Cancer Institute. The probe had looked into complaints regarding the alleged appointment of Dr Minakshi Mann to the post of assistant professor without following due procedure. Health Secretary Rupesh Thakur was unavailable for comment.

EXTRACT OF STANDALONE / CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED MARCH 31, 2026 (₹ in Crore)

Particulars	Standalone					Consolidated				
	Quarter ended 31 March, 2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended 31 December, 2025 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended 31 March, 2025 (Unaudited)	Year ended 2026 (Audited)	Year ended 2025 (Audited)	Quarter ended 31 March, 2026 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended 31 December, 2025 (Unaudited)	Quarter ended 31 March, 2025 (Unaudited)	Year ended 2026 (Audited)	Year ended 2025 (Audited)
Total income from Operations	2,997.79	1,965.35	3,243.45	8,478.86	10,193.14	3,188.98	2,119.04	3,412.07	9,071.05	10,759.58
Net profit / (loss) (before tax & exceptional items)	245.74	131.19	258.02	797.85	917.81	247.83	134.69	263.05	766.50	939.02
Net profit / (loss) (before tax & after exceptional items)	245.74	131.19	258.02	797.85	917.81	247.83	134.69	263.05	766.50	939.02
Net profit after tax	192.03	91.18	218.21	618.45	737.59	191.46	99.85	211.78	591.92	727.83
Profit is attributable to :										
Owners of the Parent	192.03	91.18	218.21	618.45	737.59	191.60	100.66	210.85	595.47	727.41
Non Controlling Interest	-	-	-	-	-	(0.14)	(0.81)	0.93	(3.55)	0.42
Total comprehensive income	191.37	93.37	220.64	622.73	743.13	190.70	102.02	214.17	596.09	733.32
Equity share capital	188.10	188.10	188.10	188.10	188.10	188.10	188.10	188.10	188.10	188.10
Other Equity attributable to Owners of the Parent (Excluding Revaluation Reserve)				6,442.29	6,049.33				6,450.54	6080.68*
Earnings Per Share (Not annualized)										
(Face Value of ₹2/- each)										
(a) Basic (in ₹)	2.04	0.97	2.32	6.58	7.84	2.04	1.07	2.24	6.33	7.73
(b) Diluted (in ₹)	2.04	0.97	2.32	6.58	7.84	2.04	1.07	2.24	6.33	7.73

***Restated NOTES:** 1. The above standalone and consolidated financial results were reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their meeting held on 22nd May, 2026. The Statutory Auditors have expressed an unmodified opinion.
2. The Standalone and consolidated financial results have been prepared in accordance with the Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS) as notified under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with relevant rules thereunder and in terms of Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (as Amended) and other recognised accounting practices and policies to the extent applicable.
3. The above is an extract of the detailed format of the financial results filed with the Stock Exchange under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, as amended. The full format of the aforesaid financial results are available on the Stock Exchanges website of BSE (www.bseindia.com), NSE (www.nseindia.com) and Company's website at www.ircon.org.
4. The BoD has recommended a final Dividend of ₹ 0.70/- per equity share on face value of ₹ 2/- per equity share for the financial year 2025-26, subject to the approval of the shareholders at the AGM. This is in addition to Interim Dividend of ₹ 1.20 per equity share on face value of ₹ 2/- per share for the year 2025-26 approved in BoD held on 11th February 2026, and subsequently paid.
5. Figures for the previous periods / year have been re-grouped / re-classified / re-casted to conform to the classification of the current period / year.

For and on behalf of IRCON International Limited
Sd/-
Hari Mohan Gupta
Chairman & Managing Director and CEO
DIN- 08453476

Place: New Delhi
Date: 22nd May, 2026

IRCON INTERNATIONAL LIMITED
(A Government of India Undertaking)

Registered Office: C-4, District Centre Saket, New Delhi-110017; Tel: +91-11-26530266; Fax: +91-11-26522000/26854000
E-mail: investors@ircon.org; Website: www.ircon.org; Corporate Identity Number: L45203DL1976G01008171

CENTRAL UNIVERSITY OF RAJASTHAN

Advrt. No. CURAJ/R/176/Rectt./2026/5631 Date : 20.05.2026

03 Teaching Positions

Online applications are invited for
03 Teaching Positions (under Direct Recruitment) in:
Department of Economics
Department of Culture & Media Studies
Applications are invited till **06.07.2026 (11:59PM)**
For more information visit: www.curaj.ac.in Registrar

GARWARE HI-TECH FILMS
GARWARE HI-TECH FILMS LIMITED
CIN: L10899MH1957PLC010899
Registered Office: Naigaon, Post Wajul, Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar - 431 133.
Tel: +91-22-6698 8000, E-mail: cs@garwarehitech.com, Website: www.garwarehitechfilms.com

POSTAL BALLOT NOTICE (THROUGH REMOTE E-VOTING)

Notice is hereby given to the members of Garware Hi-Tech Films Limited (the "Company"), pursuant to Section 108 and 110 and other applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 (the "Act") read with Rule 20 and Rule 22 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014 (the "Rules"), Regulation 44 of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("SEBI Listing Regulations"), Secretarial Standard on General Meetings ("SS-2") issued by the Institute of Company Secretaries of India read with General Circular No. 14/2020 dated 8th April, 2020, 17/2020 dated 13th April, 2020 and subsequent circulars issued in this regard, the latest being General Circular No. 03/2025 dated 22nd September, 2025 issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs ("MCA Circulars") and other applicable laws, rules and regulations, if any, (including any statutory modification(s) or re-enactment(s) thereof for the time being in force), that the Company is seeking approval of members by passing following as Special Resolution by way of Postal Ballot through remote e-Voting i.e. voting through electronic means ("Remote e-Voting");

Sr. No.	Description of Special Resolutions
1.	Appointment of Ms. Sonali Rajesh Mehta (DIN: 11485935) as an Independent Director of the Company
2.	Re-appointment of Ms. Monika Garware (DIN: 00143400) as a Vice-Chairperson and Joint Managing Director of the Company and minimum remuneration to be paid in case of inadequacy of profit.

In this connection, Members are hereby informed that the Company has circulated the Postal Ballot Notice dated Wednesday, May 06, 2026 on Friday, May 22, 2026 to all the Members/Beneficial Owners whose names appear in the Company's Register of Members/ records of depositories as on the cut-off date i.e. Tuesday, May 19, 2026, through electronic mail to the Members whose emails ids are registered in the records with Depositories/ the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agents MUFG Intime India Private Limited (Formerly Link Intime India Private Limited).

The Postal Ballot Notice along with Explanatory Statement is also available on Company's website www.garwarehitechfilms.com, NSDL's e-voting website www.evoting.nsdl.com and on website of BSE at www.bseindia.com and website of NSE at www.nseindia.com where the equity shares of the company are listed.

Instructions for Remote e-Voting:

The voting rights shall be reckoned on the paid-up value of the shares registered in the name of members as on the Cut-Off Date. A person who is not a member as on the Cut-Off Date should treat this notice for information purpose only.

Please note that there will be no dispatch of physical copy of Notice or Postal Ballot Form to the Members for this Postal Ballot and no physical ballot forms will be accepted. The communication of assent/dissent of the members will take place only through the remote e-Voting system. The detailed procedure for remote e-Voting forms part of the 'Notes' section to the Postal Ballot Notice. Eligible Member whose e-mail address is not registered with the Company/Depositories, are requested to follow the process provided in the Notes of Postal Ballot Notice.

The remote e-Voting period will commence at **9:00 a.m. on Monday, May 25, 2026 and will end at 5:00 p.m. on Tuesday, June 23, 2026**. Only those Members whose names were recorded in the Register of Members of the Company or in the Register of Beneficial Owners maintained by the Depositories as on cut-off date i.e. Tuesday, May 19, 2026, are entitled to cast their votes on the Special Resolutions. In accordance with the provisions of Section 108 and 110 of the Act read with the Rules, the MCA Circulars and Regulation 44 of the SEBI Listing Regulations, the Company has engaged the services of National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) for the purpose of providing e-Voting facility to all its Members.

The Board of Directors of the Company has appointed Mr. Mannish L. Ghia (Membership No. FCS: 6252 and CP No. 3531), Partner of M/s. Manish Ghia & Associates, Company Secretaries, Practicing Company Secretaries, as Scrutinizer (hereinafter called the "Scrutinizer"), for conducting the said Postal Ballot process in a fair and transparent manner.

The Results of Postal Ballot will be declared on or before Thursday, June 25, 2026 along with the Scrutinizer's Report, will be made available on the Company's website www.garwarehitechfilms.com and on the NSDL's e-voting website <https://www.evoting.nsdl.com/>. The Results will also be submitted to the BSE Limited ("BSE") and National Stock Exchange of India Limited ("NSE") where the Company's shares are listed. The said results would be displayed for at least three days at the Registered Office of the Company.

In case of any query/grievance, Members may refer to the Frequently Asked Questions for members and e-voting User Manual for members available under the Downloads section of NSDL's e-voting website www.evoting.nsdl.com or contact Ms. Pallavi Mhatre, Manager, National Securities Depository Limited, 3rd Floor, Naman Chamber, Plot C-32, G-Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Mumbai, Maharashtra - 400 051 at telephone no. 022-2499 7000 or email at evoting@nsdl.co.in.

Members are requested to carefully read the notes set out in the Postal Ballot Notice and in particular, the manner of casting vote through Remote e-Voting.

By order of the Board
For Garware Hi-Tech Films Limited
Sd/-
Awaneesh Srivastava
Company Secretary
FCS No: 8513

Place: Mumbai
Date: May 22, 2026

CREAKING INFRA ADDING TO POWER CRISIS, PHASED REPLACEMENT PLAN IN THE WORKS

Power demand soaring, 43% Delhi’s transformers are past operating age

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, May 22

NEARLY 43% of transformers under Delhi Transco Limited (DTL) have crossed their operational life and are running beyond capacity, with 78 of the utility’s 183 transformers now over 25 years old — of which at least 18 are in a damaged condition — contributing to outages and power cuts during peak-load periods in the Capital, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

With Delhi’s peak power demand expected to touch 11,000 MW in the next four years, the government is planning a phased replacement of ageing transformers to prepare for rising electricity demand.

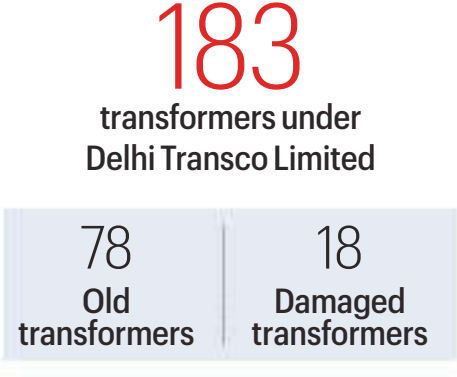
According to data shared by the Power department, 19 of the transformers that are over 25 years old are set to be replaced over the next three years. For 16 of these, contracts have been awarded to Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL), said officials, adding that the remaining transformers will be replaced in phases.

“No power transformer has been replaced with a new unit since 2020, with only temporary arrangements being made over the past five years,” Power Minister Ashish Sood said.

The data shows that since 2020, 18 power transformers had been damaged and 11 failed before completing the 25-year operational life defined by the Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission.

Five of these 18 transformers were arranged on loan from

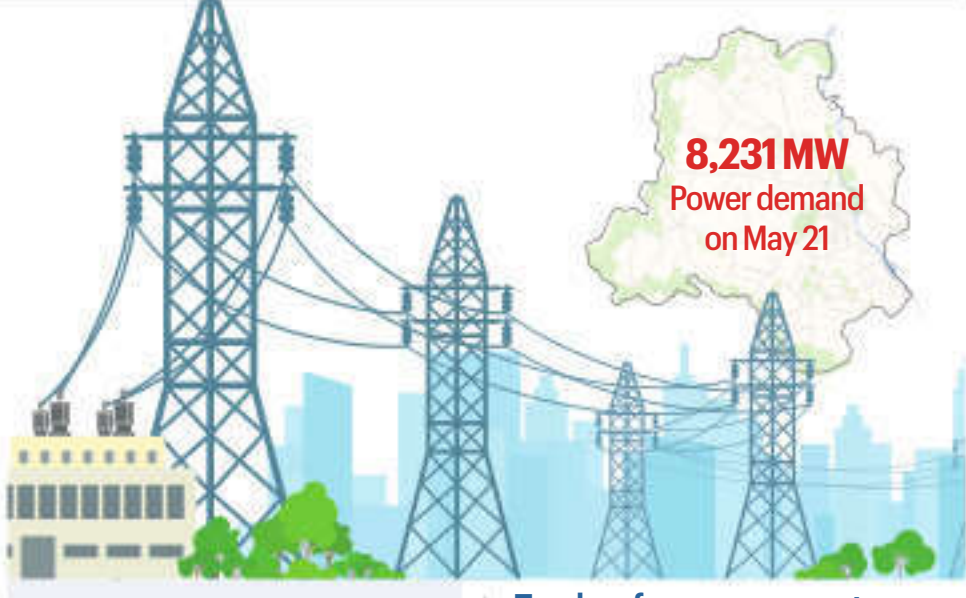
• DELHI’S POWER WOES



- Transformers over 25 years old: **19**
- To be replaced in 3 years: **16, by BHEL**
- Remaining 6: **To be replaced in phased manner**

Replacement of old/damaged transformers

- replaced by shifting transformers from other DTL substations
- diverted from the Project department
- damaged in July and August 2024 yet to be replaced
- replaced, took nearly a year



Tenders for procurement of transformers

500 MVA: Floated 4 times between July 2020 and January 2025; dropped each time

160 MVA: Floated 5 times between September 2019 and November 2024, repeatedly cancelled

100 MVA: Floated once in May 2022 but dropped; reissued in November 2024 and awarded to BHEL

66 kV GIS projects: Floated 3 times between 2019 and 2022 and dropped; yet to be re-floated

Revamp of transformers and assets under DTL: Govt to propose investment of Rs 7909 cr from 2025-26 to 2031-32	Works to do: Replace transformers, provide 24-hour power supply (Source: Power dept data since 2020)
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Power Grid Corporation of India Limited, BSES Rajdhani Power Limited and BSES Yamuna Power Limited. Seven were replaced by shifting transformers from other DTL substations, while one unit was diverted from the Project department. However, three transformers damaged in July and August 2024 — at IP, Patparganj and Pappanka-

lan-I — are yet to be replaced. Four others at Bawana, Peer-agarhi, Sarita Vihar and Park Street took nearly a year to be replaced. “There is a lack of coordination and ineffective decision-making, resulting in delay in taking timely and appropriate actions,” said an official.

Officials said that multiple tenders floated by DTL for pro-

curement of key power transformers were cancelled over the past few years. *(See box)*

“This reflects a lackadaisical approach towards the requirement of... transformers that are essential to meet Delhi’s future load demand. It further indicates poor planning, lack of market study, inaccurate estimation, and the inclusion of unfavour-

• Skywatch



Forecast: May 23, 2026: Partly cloudy sky. Thundery developments; heatwave.

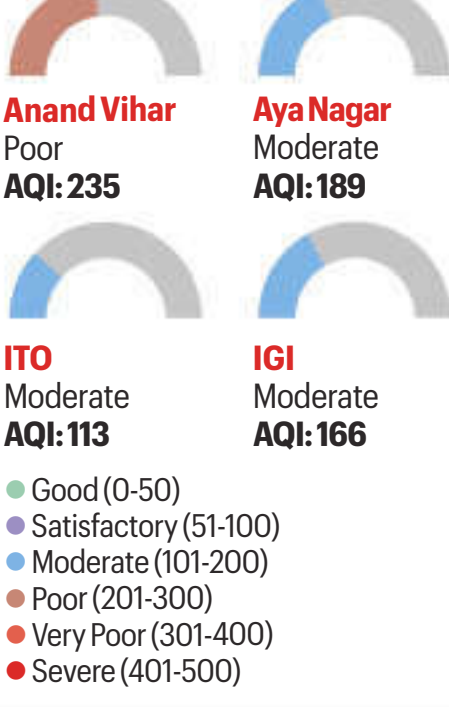
MAX: 43-45

4.8 above normal

MIN: 27-29

2.3°C above normal

• AQI Tracker



able terms and conditions in the Notice Inviting Tender (NIT),” an official document read.

Among the 24 transmission line schemes, only four have been commissioned so far, while land is yet to be made available for six projects, the records show. “Delay in re-floating tenders has nearly doubled the cost of several schemes,” an official said.

Outage stops Gurgaon Rapid Metro, commuters on tracks

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, May 22

ALREADY FACING hours-long power cuts over the week, many Gurgaon residents on Friday night were seen walking on Rapid Metro tracks after the services were stopped due to a power outage.

The outage was due to a fire that broke out at a 220-KVA power station at Sector 72. Videos of commuters walking on the track went viral on social media late night.

“Rapid Metro services were impacted for 25 minutes due to the fire that started around 8 pm. But a couple of hours later,

power supply was slowly restored. The situation is normal now,” Dakshin Haryana Bijli Vitran Nigam (DHBVN) spokesperson Sanjay Chugh said.

Residents across Gurgaon have been facing power cuts amid the sweltering summer heat, even as official supply logs claim nearly uninterrupted power supply.

Residents of ATS Tourmaline at Sector 109 (off Dwarka Expressway) said they have been facing severe power outages in the evening. “A major fault at the main switching station led to a complete power outage across multiple towers,” Mukul Uppal, a resident, said.



Commuters walk on the tracks in Gurgaon on Friday night.

Residents of M3M Woodshire attested to frequent power cuts, while people at Ardee City said multiple breakdowns in the feeder are leading to scenarios of no power and water.

This comes even as official running hour data from the

DHBVN for May 20 claimed an almost uninterrupted power supply across the city’s urban feeders. According to the latest logs available, urban areas in Gurgaon-I and Gurgaon-II circles received 23 hours 37 minutes and 23 hours 48 minutes of supply, respectively. The industrial sector, similarly, recorded 23 hours 51 minutes of supply in Gurgaon-I and 23 hours 55 minutes in Gurgaon-II.

Data indicates a wider deficit only in rural domestic sectors scheduled for 24-hour supply, where Gurgaon-I recorded an average running time of 22 hours 30 minutes, and Gurgaon-II logged 21 hours 35 minutes.

Despite the utility’s data reflecting minor shortfalls in urban zones, the recurrent, multi-hour outages experienced by residents point to localised infrastructure struggling to maintain distribution.

These localised faults coincide with a steady year-on-year increase in power demand. Consumption data for May 20 shows that the two Gurgaon circles cumulatively consumed 508.52 lakh units (LUs) of electricity in a single day.

Uppal said the power backup was falling too. “The diesel generator (DG) system has proven inadequate. There is power tripping even with minimal load.”

Gurgaon civic body asks residents of 3 neighbourhoods to replace water pipes

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, May 22

THE MUNICIPAL Corporation of Gurugram (MCG) earlier this week issued a public notice directing residents of Palam Vihar and Sectors 23 and 23A to replace aging galvanized iron (GI) water pipes, citing health and sanitation hazards.

The notice was issued by Additional Commissioner Yash Jaluka on Wednesday.

The civic body said these neighbourhoods are “old developed residential areas where many houses were constructed around 20-25 years ago”.

Warning of potential hazards from the existing infrastructure, the MCG notice stated, “Due to

aging, corrosion and damage in the GI pipelines, there are possibilities of leakage and contamination of water supply.”

The corporation cautioned that these issues “may affect not only individual households but also nearby residents”.

However, the financial responsibility for this upgrade falls entirely on the homeowners. The MCG clarified that the “connection from the MCG main line up to the individual house is the personal property/responsibility” of the house owner concerned.

The notice also urged residents to cooperate with officials during inspections.

Speaking with *The Indian Express*, Jaluka said they had

been receiving multiple complaints regarding “unsafe and dirty water”.

“In many older sectors, there are neighbourhoods where only one of the houses is getting dirty water. This shows that the issue is not with the supply, but damaged pipes,” Jaluka said. He said MCG has also been urging residents to get authorised metered connections.

General secretary, Resident Welfare Association, Sector 23A, Bhawani Shankar Tripathy, said the issue is a complex one. “Newer connections from the main line tend to have cheap plastic pipes... The issue also lies with the layout of water pipes, with many crossing sewage and stormwater ones.”

Court orders 2nd autopsy in Twisha case by AIIMS Delhi

Anand Mohan
Bhopal, May 22

THE MADHYA Pradesh High Court on Friday ordered a second postmortem of model and actor Twisha Sharma by a team of forensic experts constituted by AIIMS Delhi, observing that because the death had occurred within six months of marriage, “all doubts from any quarter” should be removed.

In a detailed order passed by Justice Avanimandra Kumar Singh, the court allowed a writ petition filed by Twisha’s father, Navnidhi Sharma, seeking the preservation of the body and a fresh postmortem examination by an independent expert board.

The court recorded that the petition specifically sought direction to preserve Twisha’s mortal

remains lying in the AIIMS Bhopal mortuary and restrain authorities from releasing the body for cremation or disposal.

The counsel appearing for Twisha’s husband, Samarth Singh, said that he had “no objection if the body of the deceased is subjected to a second postmortem”, though he expressed concern that the reputation of doctors at AIIMS Bhopal, “who are very good”, should not be tarnished.

The court also recorded submissions made by Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the state, who defended the integrity of the first post-mortem while supporting the family’s request for a second examination. “Conducting a second postmortem does not amount to raising a finger at

PROJECTS BY EARTH INFRASTRUCTURES LIMITED ‘Paid EMIs, lost jobs during Covid’: SC relief for 3,000 Gurgaon-Noida homebuyers

Drishti Jain
Noida, May 22

ON MAY 5, a WhatsApp group notification popped up on the phones of around 3,000 people.

They were not family, friends, or office colleagues, but were bound by a single thread — they were all homebuyers.

Back in 2011, many of them had booked flats in projects by Earth Infrastructures Limited in Greater Noida and Gurgaon. However, the projects stalled around 2014-15; the company then entered insolvency proceedings before the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT).

After decades of uncertainty, the Supreme Court on May 5 restored builder Alpha Corp Development’s resolution plan to acquire the stalled projects, setting aside a 2023 order of the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT).

The plan covers two commercial developments — Earth TechOne and Earth Sapphire Court in Greater Noida — and a residential project, Earth Copia, in Gurgaon.

For Col Bhavishya Kashyap (ret), the message about the judgment brought major relief.

Speaking to *The Indian Express* from Bengaluru, the 44-year-old said, “It’s been decades. When I invested in the project in 2011, I didn’t even have children. A lot changes in life over such a long period. We have lost about eight to 10 people to cancer, Covid-19, and accidents.”

Kashyap had bought a 3BHK in Earth Copia, along the Dwarka Expressway in Gurgaon’s Sector 112, at Rs 3,350 per square feet. “I had invested about Rs 68 lakh between 2011 and 2013, of which around Rs 30 lakh was a loan. Imagine being told that after liquidation, you may get only Rs 5 lakh back. This was my life savings. I opted to retire since my property investments failed, creating financial pressure about my child’s future expenses,” he said.

He is now working in the private sector.

Kashyap added that he had also persuaded his sister to invest: “I can’t describe the guilt I felt because that money should have been there for her children’s education. When investments don’t work out the way they should, it places an



Col Bhavishya Kashyap (ret), Alka Danwani, and Dr Gurinder Gill (above) had invested in Gurgaon’s Earth Copia (top) project. EXPRESS

enormous financial burden on your mind.”

When the case first reached the SC, Kashyap, who was stationed in Bareilly at the time, used to take the morning Shatabdi at 5 am, reach Delhi by 10 am, attend proceedings at 11 am and return the same day.

“It was a painful process. I personally attended Supreme Court proceedings two or three times... But at the end of it, we



Samarth Singh, Twisha Sharma

anyone; rather, it is intended to bolster the confidence of every common person in the entire process, right from the investigation onwards,” the court recorded. Mehta was submitting.

Mehta further said that he neither doubted “the correctness of the report or the competence of the concerned doctor”, but added that “in the best

interest of everyone, a second postmortem may be directed”.

A significant portion of the hearing focused on logistical questions surrounding whether the body should be transported to Delhi or whether a specialist forensic team should instead travel to Bhopal.

The court recorded that after discussions, the Advocate General informed the Bench that the government was prepared to arrange “all the logistic” support necessary for a team constituted by AIIMS Delhi to travel to Bhopal by special flight and conduct the second postmortem there itself.

The court directed the Director of AIIMS Delhi to constitute a team of experts who would travel to Bhopal “by special flight arranged by the

feel at least we got justice and our hopes are restored,” he said.

Alpha Corp Development is expected to invest approximately Rs 750 crore towards completion, redevelopment, infrastructure upgrades, and delivery of the projects, with a projected revenue potential of around Rs 1,200 crore.

Another homebuyer, Alka Danwani, who had also booked a flat in the Gurgaon project, said the prolonged delay brought years of emotional and financial strain.

“As soon as construction started, everyone took loans. Many people were living on rent, and during Covid, some lost their jobs while continuing to pay EMIs. It was an extremely difficult period,” she said.

“My father-in-law was diagnosed with cancer in 2015 while I was still paying installments. Managing Rs 10 lakh for his treatment was very difficult,” added Danwani, whose apartment cost around Rs 1 crore.

She said one of the biggest challenges was navigating the legal process. “We later found out that there was a newly established NCLT court where all these matters were being heard. We didn’t even know about it,” she said, adding that it may still take another three years for construction to be completed.

There are around 400 buyers in the Earth Copia residential project, said Dr Gurinder Gill, a government doctor practicing in Gurgaon. He is also a homebuyer and currently lives on rent in Dwarka.

“Most homebuyers had already paid nearly 90% of their installments. In 2015, around 15-20 buyers met at the construction site after hearing negative news about the builder. We held meetings, but no promoter came forward,” he said.

He said they submitted multiple complaints to authorities, eventually approaching the Real Estate Regulatory Authority and the Economic Offences Wing (EOW).

Gill said he now hopes the long legal battle will finally end with possession of his home.

“It was a 10-year fight that began in 2015. We are hopeful because justice may have been delayed, but it was not denied,” he said.

• ACCUSED LEARNT HOW TO DEVELOP AND MODIFY MALICIOUS APKs ON YOUTUBE, SAY POLICE

From Class 8 dropout to malware seller: Inside the ‘Jamtara’ Telegram network

Alok Singh
New Delhi, May 22

IMAGINE GETTING a call saying your electricity connection will be cut within hours unless you make a payment. Then comes a WhatsApp message with a ‘Customer Support APK (Android Package Kit)’ meant to solve the issue.

You install it, unaware that the app may have just handed strangers complete access to your phone, messages, OTPs and bank account.

This is the scam Delhi Police says led them to a 25-year-old alleged malware developer operating Telegram channels

under the name ‘Jamtara Official Developer’.

On May 14, a police team conducted a raid in Uttar Pradesh’s Deoria looking for Abhay Sahni, who allegedly sold malicious APKs to cyber fraudsters. They found him casually eating ice cream with his friends near his house.

During questioning, police found that Sahni, who had only studied until Class 8, knew how to develop and modify malicious APKs — which he learnt through YouTube — and sold to fraudsters for around Rs 4,000 per APK. Police said Sahni lives with his wife and two-year-old child; he had told his

family he was in the business of selling mobile phones.

Sahni was arrested in connection with a cheating case registered on July 29, 2025, at the Cyber police station in Delhi’s central district. The case was registered after a complainant reported that Rs 1,20,999 had been fraudulently transferred from his bank account through unauthorised digital transactions.

DCP (Central) Rohit Rajbir Singh said the victim had received a call from an unknown person posing as an official from the Power department, who claimed his electricity meter would be disconnected

• How the fraud typically works, step by step

BAIT: Victim receives WhatsApp message claiming urgent action is needed — to pay traffic fine, update bank account or download bill payment app.

DOWNLOAD LINK: Message contains link to download APK file directly onto phone.

PERMISSION REQUESTS: Once opened, app asks for permissions such as accessibility access, SMS access, notification access, or screen-sharing permissions.



notifications, or remotely control parts of device.

FRAUD EXECUTION: Using stolen information, cybercriminals can take over bank accounts, authorise transactions, or carry out financial fraud.

unless a payment was made.

The fraudster allegedly sent the malicious app — ‘Customer Support APK’ — via WhatsApp and convinced the complainant to install it. Soon after installation, police said, the accused gained remote access to the victim’s cellphone and carried out fraudulent transactions.

Police said the application was a ‘FUD’, a ‘Fully Undetected’ malicious APK designed to bypass anti-virus and mobile security systems. An APK is the file format (.apk) Android uses to install apps, especially those downloaded outside official app stores. Cyber fraudsters often disguise malicious APKs

as bank updates, traffic challan notices, electricity or gas bill payment apps, pension schemes, or government documents — and send them to victims through SMS links or messaging platforms (see box).

Police said their probe led them to a man who allegedly procured and used malicious APKs in cyber fraud cases. On December 5, last year, Umesh Kumar Rajak, a 25-year-old resident of Gorakhpur in Uttar Pradesh was arrested.

Further technical surveillance led investigators to Telegram IDs — @rahul_kumar717 and Jamtara_official_Developer — from where the APKs

were allegedly being supplied. Police identified the administrator as Sahani and arrested him earlier this month. Police said Sahani allegedly admitted to operating Telegram channels under the name ‘Jamtara_official_Developer’ and selling malicious files.

“The accused learnt cyber fraud techniques, APK development, remote-access exploitation, and anti-detection methods through YouTube videos, Telegram groups, and social media platforms,” said an officer. “He had sold 40-50 malicious APKs and admitted to his involvement in cheating around 20-25 victims.”

Himachal ends ‘power bank’ with neighbouring states, will sell surplus electricity in open market

Saurabh Parashar
Shimla, May 22

IN A major policy shift, the Himachal Pradesh State Electricity Board Limited (HPSEBL) has decided to stop supplying power to the neighbouring states under the long-running “power banking” system. This came after the Himachal government decided not to provide the power it receives as royalty to the Board at subsidised rates and instead chose to sell it in the open market to generate additional revenue.

The Himachal government used to provide the Board 1,800 million units of power.

Under the existing arrangement, the Himachal government supplied its share of power to the HPSEBL at a subsidised rate of Rs 3.50 per unit. The Board would then provide this surplus power to states such as Punjab, Haryana and Delhi during the summer and monsoon months when generation rises sharply in the hill state amid snowmelt and increased water

flow in the hydroelectric projects. Under the banking arrangement, the borrowing states used to the return an equivalent amount of power to Himachal in winters.

A senior HPSEBL official, privy to the development, said, “The State Electricity Regulatory Commission has given an in principal nod to the move. There are two primary reasons behind this — First, two mega projects, including the Nathpa Jhakri Hydroelectric Power Station and SJVN Limited, are now under the state government. Second, we have to cater to domestic consumption”. The official added, “This move doesn’t mean that the ‘power banking’ system will be completely shut. But it will be reduced to a great extent. We are yet to receive final approval, which is expected to come in the coming weeks.”

Asked if the neighbouring states could challenge the move, the official said, “Himachal has absolute right on how to utilise its electricity, which is generated within the state.”



MADHYA GUJARAT VIJ COMPANY LIMITED
Registered Office: Sardar Patel Vidyalay Bhavan,
Race Course, Vadodara 390007
Tel.No : (0265) 231 0582-86
Web Site : www.mgvcl.com E-mail : ce@tech.mgvcl.com
CIN: U40102GJ2003SGC042907

E-TENDER NOTICE
Tender is invited on turnkey base works for "For Full Turnkey Contract (Design, Supply and Installation) FOR CONVERSION OF HT O/H 11 KV OPEN LINE (55SQMM/100SQMM) TO MVCC OVERHEAD CONDUCTOR AND UNDER GROUND NETWORKING IN JURISDICTION OF MGVCL UNDER SI SCHEME (ROBUST III) FOR F.Y.2026-27."

Sr. No.	Tender No.	Tender ID	Tender Amount in Crs
1	MGVCL/TECH/ROBUST-III/ANDCR/2026-27	307369	80.84
2	MGVCL/TECH/ROBUST-III/BCC/2026-27	307376	98.20
3	MGVCL/TECH/ROBUST-III/BDL-DBH-JMB/2026-27	307380	64.86
4	MGVCL/TECH/ROBUST-III/BOMD/2026-27	307382	75.14
5	MGVCL/TECH/ROBUST-III/BORSAD/2026-27	307385	85.06
6	MGVCL/TECH/ROBUST-III/DHD-HAL-LUN/2026-27	307388	45.77
7	MGVCL/TECH/ROBUST-III/GODHRA/2026-27	307387	145.37
8	MGVCL/TECH/ROBUST-III/MBAD/2026-27	307381	190.45
9	MGVCL/TECH/ROBUST-III/NDOD/2026-27	307389	99.34
10	MGVCL/TECH/ROBUST-III/NDRD/2026-27	307393	58.46
11	MGVCL/TECH/ROBUST-III/PETLAD/2026-27	307394	59.29

Details of tenders can be viewed and downloaded on www.mgvcl.com/Tender and can be viewed, downloaded & submitted on www.tender.nprocure.com

Chief Engineer (T&O),
MGVCL corporate office,
Vadodara



झारखण्ड सरकार
Office of the Superintendent of Police, Gumla, Jharkhand.
Information for the general public.



Name:- Sanjita Kumari, age-13 year, (Current Age-21 years) Height:Approx-4' Fit, Face is round, Black-Hair, Wearing a Yellow suit.
It is informed to the general public that a minor girl named Sanjita Kumari, age-15 years, Father-Late Chandru Oraon, Address-Khora Jamtoli, Thana-District- Gumla, (Jharkhand) has been missing since the evening of 06.02.2018 from. In this regard, a missing report has been registered at Police Station AHTU Ps Case No.-03/20, Dated 06.02.2020. Her search is ongoing. The public is requested to cooperate in the search for the aforementioned missing person.
Therefore, it is requested from the general public that if anyone finds the above-mentioned missing girl Sanjita Kumari, age-13 years, (Current Age-21 years) or gets any information/clue about her, they can inform the Police Superintendent, Gumla or the following mobile numbers:
The person giving information will be given a reward of Rs. 2,00,000/-
Email ID (sp-gumla@jhpolicen.gov.in)
1. Superintendent of Police, Gumla – 9431706376
2. Deputy Superintendent of Police (hq), Gumla – 9471182113
3. Sub-Divisional Police Officer, Gumla – 9431706202
4. Police Station In-charge, AHTU – 8986604606, 8809624441
Sd/-
PR 380557 Police Wireless Headquarter(26-27)#D Superintendent of Police, Gumla
POLICE HELPLINE (EMERGENCY DIAL)-112 CHILD HELPLINE-1098
WOMEN HELPLINE-1091 DOMESTIC ABUSE HELPLINE-181
CYBER CRIME HELPLINE-1930 AMBULANCE SERVICE-108



इण्डियन ओवरसीज़ बैंक
Indian Overseas Bank
आपकी प्रगति का सच्चा साथी Good people to grow with
Central Office, 763, Anna Salai, Chennai - 600002

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS
Notice is hereby given to the shareholders that the Annual General Meeting (AGM) of the Shareholders of INDIAN OVERSEAS BANK will be held on **Tuesday, July 07, 2026 at 11:00 A.M.** (IST), through Video Conferencing (VC) / Other Audio Visual Means (OAVM) in compliance with the circulars issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA), Government of India and the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI). The deemed venue for the AGM shall be the Central Office of the Bank situated at Chennai.
Notice of AGM along with Annual Report 2025-26 is being sent only through electronic mode to those shareholders whose email addresses are registered with the Bank / Depositories. Shareholders of the bank may please note that the Notice and Annual Report 2025-26 will be made available on the website of the Bank at www.iob.bank.in, on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e., National Stock Exchange of India Limited and BSE Limited at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com respectively and also on the website of CDSL (agency for providing the e-Voting facility) i.e. www.evotingindia.com.
Shareholders holding shares in dematerialized mode and whose e-mail addresses are not registered are requested to register their e-mail addresses and mobile numbers with their relevant depositories through their Depository Participants.
Shareholders holding shares in physical mode are requested to furnish their e-mail addresses and mobile numbers with the Bank's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent, M/s. Cameo Corporate Services Ltd, (Unit-Indian Overseas Bank), Subramanian Building, V Floor, No.1 Club House Road, Chennai – 600 002, Telephone: 044 - 4002 0700 or through Online Investor Portal: <https://wisdom.cameoindia.com>, Website: www.cameoindia.com
Further Shareholders are hereby informed that the electronic copies of the Notice of the AGM along with Annual Report 2025-26 will be sent to all the shareholders whose email addresses are registered with the Bank/Depository Participant(s) as on **Friday, May 29, 2026.**
By order of the Board of Directors
RAGHURAM MALLELA
COMPANY SECRETARY & COMPLIANCE OFFICER

Place : Chennai
Date : 22.05.2026

ADMISSION NOTICE
POST GRADUATE ENTRANCE TEST- 2026
Applications (Online) are invited from the eligible candidates on prescribed form to appear Post Graduate Entrance Test (PGET)- 2026 for admission into following Post Graduate Courses & Institutes



SWAMI VIVEKANAND NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF REHABILITATION TRAINING AND RESEARCH (SVNIRTAR)
Olatpur, P.O: Bairoi, Dist-Cuttack-754010 (Odisha)
Website : <https://svnirtar.nic.in>, E-Mail: svnirtarpget@gmail.com
1. Master of Physiotherapy 2. Master of Occupational Therapy 3. Master in Prosthetics & Orthotics



PANDIT DEENDAYAL UPADHYAYA NATIONAL INSTITUTE FOR PERSONS WITH PHYSICAL DISABILITIES (PDUNIPPD)
4, Vishnu Digamber Marg, New Delhi - 110002
Website : <https://pdunipdpd.nic.in>, E-Mail: diriph@nic.in
1. Master in Prosthetics & Orthotics



ALI YAVAR JUNG NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF SPEECH AND HEARING DISABILITIES (DIVYANGJAN) (AYJNISHD)
K.C. Marg, Bandra (W) Reclamation, Mumbai – 400 050
&
REGIONAL CENTRE, SECUNDERABAD
Manovikas Nagar, Secunderabad-500009
Website: <https://ayjnishd.nic.in>, E-Mail: ayjnihh-mum@nic.in
1. Master of Science in Audiology (M.Sc. Audiology)

Institutes under DEPwD (Divyangjan), Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, Govt. of India
Eligibility: The Candidate should Pass Bachelor of Physiotherapy for MPT, Bachelor of Occupational Therapy for MOT, BPO/ B.Sc. (PO) for MPO and BASLP for M.Sc. Audiology Courses.
Starting of online publication of Information Brochure and Application form : 20.05.2026
Closing date of online receipt of Application form : 19.06.2026
Date of Post Graduate Entrance Test : 12.07.2026
For details Log on to: <https://admission.svnirtar.nic.in>
Sd/-
Director Cum Chairman, PGET- 2026

Government of India
Ministry of Ayush

Government of India, Ministry of Ayush Applications/nominations are invited from Ayurveda experts for the National Dhanwantari Ayurveda Award 2026. The award has been instituted by the Ministry of Ayush, Government of India, to be conferred on Ayurveda experts possessing recognized qualifications as per the provisions of the National Commission for Indian Systems of Medicine Act, 2020, or the Indian Medicine Central Council Act, 1970, and having a profound contribution in the field of Ayurveda. The awardees shall be felicitated with the award on the occasion of 11th Ayurveda Day to be celebrated on 23rd September 2026. The details may be accessed on the National Awards Portal, <http://awards.gov.in>, Ministry of Home Affairs. Accordingly, applications/nominations may be submitted by 30th June 2026.
CBC 17201/11/0003/2627

TORRENT PHARMA
CIN: L24230GJ1972PLC002126
Website: www.torrentpharma.com
Email: investorservices@torrentpharma.com

TORRENT PHARMACEUTICALS LIMITED
Registered Office: "Avirat", Thaltej Shilaj Road, Ahmedabad – 380059, Gujarat, India.
Ph.: + 91 79 26599000
Fax: + 91 79 26582100

Extract of Consolidated audited financial results for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026
[₹ in crores]

Particulars	Quarter Ended March 31, 2026 (Refer Note 2)	Year Ended March 31, 2026	Quarter Ended March 31, 2025 (Refer Note 2)
Total income from operations	4197	13980	2959
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax and exceptional items	595	2961	689
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax and after exceptional items	529	2872	665
Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax and exceptional items	364	2138	498
Total comprehensive income	278	1958	534
Paid up equity share capital	169.23	169.23	169.23
Other equity excluding revaluation reserve*		8220	
Earnings per share (Face value of ₹5 each) (Not annualised):			
Basic (in ₹)	11.51	63.92	14.71
Diluted (in ₹)	11.51	63.92	14.71

* Other equity excluding revaluation reserve as on March 31, 2025 was ₹7422 crores.

Notes :
1. Summary details of standalone audited financial results of Torrent Pharmaceuticals Limited : [₹ in crores]

Particulars	Quarter Ended March 31, 2026	Year Ended March 31, 2026	Quarter Ended March 31, 2025
Total income from operations	2735	10712	2433
Profit before tax	592	2897	622
Profit after tax	467	2192	474
Total comprehensive income	407	2045	469

2. Figures for the quarter ended March 31, 2026 and March 31, 2025 represents the difference between the audited figures in respect to the full financial year and the published figures of nine months ended December 31, 2025 and December 31, 2024 respectively, which were subjected to limited review.

3. The Board of Directors in their meeting held on May 22, 2026, proposed a final equity dividend of ₹ 9 per equity share.

4. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Financial Results for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026 filed with Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the same, along with the notes, are available on www.nseindia.com, www.bseindia.com and on the Company's website (URL: www.torrentpharma.com/investors/financial-info/quarterly-results/). The same can be accessed by scanning the QR code provided below.

For TORRENT PHARMACEUTICALS LIMITED


AMAN MEHTA
Managing Director
DIN: 08174906

Place : Ahmedabad, Gujarat
Date : May 22, 2026

Jawaharlal Nehru Krishi Vishwa Vidyalaya, Jabalpur
ADMISSION NOTICE
Admission to Master & Ph.D. degree programmes (2026-27) of Jawaharlal Nehru Krishi Viswa Vidyalaya, Jabalpur and Rajmata Vijayaraje Scindia Krishi Vishwa Vidyalaya, Gwalior will be through an Online Joint Entrance Examination to be conducted on 27.06.2026 by MP Online Limited, Bhopal. Candidates may apply online w.e.f. May 25, 2026 to June 10, 2026. Details available on www.jnkvv.org www.rvskvv.net and www.kvv.mponline.gov.in
IPRO/DI/2026-27/72
Director Instruction



ATAL BIHARI VAJPAYEE
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY AND MANAGEMENT GWALIOR
(An Institute of National Importance under MoE, GoI)
Morena Link Road Gwalior-474015 | Website : www.iiitm.ac.in

Advertisement no: 213 Date: 20.05.2026
Advertisement for the Full-Time/Part-Time Ph.D. Programme, July – 2026 (Non-GATE/Non-NET Applicants are also eligible)
Online applications are invited for admission to the Full-Time/Part-Time Ph.D. programme in Engineering/Technology (CSE/EEE/IT). Last Date for submission of online application form is 19.06.2026 upto 5.00 PM. For more details and application forms, please visit the institute website: <https://www.iiitm.ac.in>. For any query, dial 0751-2449704/720 or email to phdadmission@iiitm.ac.in.
Registrar



ONGC
Oil & Natural Gas Corporation

औद्योगिकी
औद्योगिकी



ONGC
Oil & Natural Gas Corporation



ONGC
Oil & Natural Gas Corporation

MEHSANA ASSET - EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)
ONGC, Mehsana Asset, intends to implement the Microbial based jobs for mitigating paraffin/wax deposition in oil wells. Accordingly, Mehsana Asset invites Expressions of Interest (EOI) from nationally / internationally reputed, technically competent, and financially sound business partners capable of providing cost-effective microbial treatment in the wells of Mehsana Asset.
Interested bidders are requested to submit their response/proposal to the following email address: davda_lk@ongc.co.in.
For further details, please visit <https://etenders.ongc.co.in>.



IRCON INTERNATIONAL LIMITED
NAVATNA COMPANY
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
Website : www.ircon.org CIN : L45203DL1976GO0098171



IRCON
International Railway Construction Corporation Limited

EOI Notice
1. EOI NO.: IRCON/INT/BDINER-LJN/IE/OI/26 Dtd.: 22.05.2026
Irrcon International Limited, A Navratna PSU Under Ministry of Railways, invites open Expression of Interest (EOI) from S&T experienced agencies for association as Pre-bid partner/Associate Agency/ sub-contractor for the following work: -"Design, Programming, Installation, Supply, Testing and Commissioning of Electronic Interlocking (EI) System Conforming to RDSO Specification No. RDSO/SPN/192/2019 or Latest (With Latest Amendment if any) as per SIP along with Indoor & Outdoor Work (Replacement and augmentation of outdoor signaling gears) Including Part Supply of Materials at (CRV, MND, ORW, BST, GOVR, TH, GAUR, BV, PATI, SNC, MSW, LKNR, JLHI, MOTG, BRCK, BUR & JBR) (Centralized Type) Stations and Mankapur Station (Distributed 1+2 Type) in between GKP-LJN Section, Automatic Block Signaling work in BBK-JBR-BUR-BUW Block Section with EI at huts (27.13 Km) and work for 2 OFC cables of 48 fibers (96 fibers) on each side of the track in between BBK-BUW section, GD-KLD Section and DMG-GKC Section in Lucknow Division of N.E. Railway".
Last Date and Time of e-Bid Submission of EOI : 28.05.2026 up to 10:30 hrs. (IST)
2. EOI NO.: IRCON/INT/BDINER-BSB/IE/OI/26 Dtd.: 22.05.2026
Irrcon International Limited, A Navratna PSU Under Ministry of Railways, invites open Expression of Interest (EOI) from S&T experienced agencies for association as Pre-bid partner/Associate Agency/ sub-contractor for the following work: -"Design, Programming, Installation, Supply, Testing and Commissioning of Electronic Interlocking (EI) System Conforming to RDSO Specification No. RDSO/SPN/192/2019 or Latest (With Latest Amendment if any) as per SIP along with Indoor & Outdoor Work including Part Supply of Materials at (SANR, CC, GB, BALR, DEOS, NRA, BHTR, BTK, HW, ZRDE, PCK, ODA, CW, ESM, DDP, and KPS) (Centralized Type) Stations and Siwan Jn. & CHPG Station (Distributed 1+2 Type) in between GKC-CHPG Sections, Automatic Block Signaling work in CPR Jn-CI-CHPG Block Section and work for OFC cables GKC-BTT and CPR Jn-CI-CHPG Sections in Varanasi Division of N.E. Railway".
Last Date and Time of e-Bid Submission of EOI : 28.05.2026 up to 11:00 hrs. (IST)
For further details and updates, please visit tender section on e-tender website <https://etenders.gov.in/nprocure/app> & <https://www.ircps.gov.in/irpsn/anonymousSearch.do#>.
Amendment/Corrigendum, if any, would be hosted only on the website.
Chief General Manager/S&T, C-4, District Centre, Saket, New Delhi-110017

F. No. 17/56/2022-FPD
Government of India
Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change Hazardous Substances Management Division
Indira Paryavaran Bhawan, Jal Block, II Floor
Jor Bagh Road, Aliganj, New Delhi-110003

Sub: Advertisement for hiring of Four (04) Research Associates on contractual basis in the 24x7 Crisis Control Room (CCR), HSM Division, MoEF&CC.
Applications are invited for Four (04) posts of Research Associate in the 24x7 Crisis Control Room (CCR) in the Hazardous Substances Management (HSM) Division, Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, New Delhi on payment of consolidated monthly fee of Rs. 40,000/- per Research Associate as per MoEF&CC Guidelines dated 15.04.2025. Full details of the vacancy circular are available on the Ministry website www.moef.nic.in under the link Recruitment.
The last date of receipt of application is 21 days from the date of publication of this advertisement on the website of the Ministry.
CBC-13101/11/0001/2627
Scientist E



TATA POWER
TATA POWER COMPANY LIMITED
Corporate Identity No. (CIN): L28920MH1919PLC000567
Regd. Office: Bombay House, 24, Horni Mody Street, Mumbai 400 001.
Tel: +91 22 66658282 E-mail: tatapower@tatapower.com Website: www.tatapower.com

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS
Investor Education and Protection Authority (IEPFA) has launched a Second 100-Day Campaign titled 'Saksham Niveshak', aimed at enhancing investor awareness, encouraging shareholders to update their KYC details and facilitating the claim of unpaid/unclaimed dividends and shares before their transfer to the Investor Education and Protection Fund (IEPF).
In line with this initiative, the Company through its various communications continues to urge the shareholders to claim their unpaid/unclaimed dividends by updating their KYC details (including PAN, bank account, contact information, nomination or signature). Shareholders are requested to complete the steps outlined below:

Shares held in	Required Action
Demat form	1. Update KYC details with your Depository Participant, including bank account number, bank name and branch, IFSC code, MICR, and nomination. 2. Submit a self-attested copy of the Client Master List (CML).
Physical form	Submit: 1. Forms ISR-1, ISR-2, ISR-3 or SH-13 (Nomination Form), duly filled as per instructions, along with supporting KYC documents available at KYC Downloads. 2. Original cancelled cheque bearing your name. 3. Other supporting documents, if applicable. These forms are also available at https://web.in.mpms.mufg.com/KYC-downloads.html

Documents may be submitted to the Company or its Registrar to an issue and Share Transfer Agent (RTA) at the addresses below:

Company	The Nodal Officer, The Tata Power Company Limited Bombay House, 24, Horni Mody Street, Mumbai 400 001 Tel No: +91 22 6665 8282 Email: investorcomplaints@tatapower.com / iepf@tatapower.com
RTA	MUFG Intime India Private Limited (Formerly Link Intime India Private Limited) C-101, 1 st Floor, 247 Park, Lal Bahadur Shastri Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai 400 083 Tel No.: +91 810 811 8484 Website: www.in.mpms.mufg.com Raise online service request at: https://web.in.mpms.mufg.com/helpdesk/Service_Request.html

For The Tata Power Company Limited
Sd/-
Place: Mumbai
Dated: May 22, 2026
Vispi S. Patel
Company Secretary

epaper.indianexpress.com



Global Acclaim

DAYS AFTER receiving a congratulatory call from Sri Lankan President Anura Kumara Dissanayake, Tamil Nadu's new Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Friday received another call from an overseas dignitary. Malaysian Prime Minister Anwar Ibrahim extended best wishes to Vijay and told him that he will try to visit Tamil Nadu and meet him in September during his India visit for the BRICS Summit.

Rupee & Rage

ALTHOUGH NOT attacking the government over the current economic crisis, Swadeshi Jagran Manch (SJM), the economic wing of the RSS, has been taking on economists who are arguing that the fall of rupee should not influence policy decisions. SJM leader Ashwani Mahajan recently criticised economist Gita Gopinath for arguing against RBI's intervention to check rupee devaluation. He said he was not able to "digest the argument of letting rupee have a free fall". The latest in his firing line was Arvind Panagariya, Chairman of 16th Finance Commission, who said "100 is just a number, like 99 and 101" in context of the falling rupee. Mahajan argued that "band-aid solutions will not work" and insisted that the government should take steps to protect domestic industry.

Wait for Date

AS CHIEF Ministers from BJP-ruled states meet senior party leaders in the Capital, BJP circles are abuzz with speculation about announcements related to Assam and West Bengal Cabinet, despite a known hitch. According to party insiders, the ongoing period of Adhik Maas (May 17 to June 15), considered auspicious for spiritual growth but not for matters of political decision-making, has traditionally been avoided by the BJP with regard to organisational announcements. However, given the time-bound nature of Cabinet formation in both states, it remains to be seen if the calendar will impact the oath-taking of ministers or not.

Centre asks district collectors to regularly review JJM works, address gaps

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 22

THE CENTRE has asked district collectors to regularly review the Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) works and address the gaps related to drinking water services, including regularity, adequacy, water quality, grievance redressal and Operation and Maintenance (O&M) of schemes.

During a review meeting with deputy commissioners, district magistrates and district collectors from across the country, Department of Drinking Water & Sanitation (DDWS) Secretary Ashok K K Meena said that the JJM and Swachh Bharat Mission-Grameen (SBM-G) have now reached a stage where the focus must move beyond infrastructure creation towards reliable service delivery, functionality, sustainability and community ownership.

The JJM 2.0 marks a transition from asset creation to sustained drinking water service delivery in rural India, he said during the meeting organised through video conferencing.

BREAKTHROUGH IN LADAKH TALKS

'Representative administration': Centre, Leh-Kargil groups reach broad agreement

Deeptiman Tiwary & Naveed Iqbal
New Delhi, Srinagar, May 22

IN A breakthrough after months of protests, negotiations, and political mobilisation in Ladakh, representatives of the Apex Body, Leh (ABL) and Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) on Friday said they had reached "in-principle understanding" with the Centre on "restoring democracy in Ladakh" and providing "Constitutional safeguards on the lines of Article 371 A, F, and G", following talks with senior Union Home Ministry officials.

These are provisions that are applicable in states such as Nagaland, Sikkim, and Mizoram. It also signals that the Ladakh civil society groups have agreed to compromise on their demand for Sixth Schedule status.

The understanding emerged during a meeting between the sub-committee on the Ladakh issue involving senior members of the ABL and KDA and senior officials of the Union Home Ministry. The sub-committee is tasked with preparing the groundwork for a larger high-level meeting of the High Powered Committee to be chaired later by Minister of

State for Home Nityanand Rai.

"In this model, the legislative, executive and financial powers will rest with elected representatives through a Union Territory-level legislative body," the ABL and KDA said in a statement. It added: "All bureaucrats of the UT, including the Chief Secretary, will come under the executive head of the UT level elected body (proposed to be Chief Minister)."

Sources said the government has refused to grant statehood or even UT-with-legislature status to Ladakh. However, it has agreed to give it an administrative system that will be akin to the latter and call the head of this administration the "chief minister". ABL co-chair Chherring Dorje Lakruk said, "A broad agreement has been reached on having a representative administration. It would have legislative and financial powers. The bureaucrats will work under the authority of the chief minister. Land, jobs and culture would be protected under Article 371. Finer details will be worked out in further meetings."

This will effectively be a better arrangement than Jammu & Kashmir, where services continue to be under the



KDA and ABL leaders after a meeting with MHA officials in New Delhi on Friday. X/SONAM WANGCHUK

Lieutenant Governor, leading to a dual power structure where the ministries are under the Chief Minister while the transfer and posting of secretaries are under the L-G.

The statement from ABL and KDA said both sides had held "detailed and constructive deliberations" on the "future administrative and political framework of Ladakh", during which the two outfits reiterated the "long-standing aspirations of the people of Ladakh regarding the restoration of democracy, constitutional safeguards, and the demand for Statehood and Sixth Schedule protections".

The two organisations said the discussions reflected a "shared commitment of all

stakeholders towards an inclusive and sustainable governance framework for the region".

On the issue of statehood, the statement said MHA officials had explained that "the only reason why Ladakh cannot be made a state at the moment is that it currently lacks adequate revenue generation to meet the revenue expenditures like salaries of employees". "However, this setup will lead Ladakh towards full statehood as and when it meets the revenue criteria," it added.

This could be a rather long shot for a region like Ladakh. J&K barely generates around 15% of its budget with its own revenues. When it was a full state, and included Ladakh, it

generated around 10% of its budget on its own revenue. The rest was met by central grants.

The ABL and KDA said they would continue consultations with the Centre to "work out the finer operational details with the MHA in consultation with legal and constitutional experts".

On the importance of Friday's discussions, Ladakh Chief Secretary Ashish Kundra said the Central government outlined the measures that had been taken up over the last couple of years for augmenting employment opportunities and reservation to local communities, among other things. "Now the time was ripe for moving towards the process of creating the right institutional frameworks for democratic representation (for Ladakh) and within that, Article 371 was brought up for discussion," Kundra said.

Friday's development marks the most substantive movement yet on Ladakh's political demands since the region was separated from the erstwhile state of J&K and made a Union Territory without a legislature in 2019. While the move was initially welcomed by many in Leh, concerns steadily grew in both Leh and Kargil

over the absence of Constitutional safeguards protecting land, jobs and cultural identity, as well as the concentration of administrative authority in the bureaucracy.

The ABL and KDA — umbrella groupings representing civil society, political and religious organisations from Leh and Kargil respectively — have since jointly spearheaded an agitation demanding statehood, Sixth Schedule status, constitutional protections, a separate Public Service Commission and enhanced parliamentary representation for Ladakh. The movement gained national prominence through activist Sonam Wangchuk, who was also present in Friday's meeting. Wangchuk had led fasts and public campaigns pressing the Centre to fulfil assurances made after the 2019 reorganisation of Jammu and Kashmir.

Last year, Wangchuk was arrested under the stringent National Security Act after a protest in Leh demanding the Sixth Schedule turned violent, leading to the killing of four youths in police firing. Wangchuk was released recently from Jodhpur jail, following which the Centre scheduled the meeting that happened on Friday.

Chandigarh challenges HC order quashing FIR against Mann, others

ENS & PTI
New Delhi, Chandigarh, May 22

THE CHANDIGARH administration has moved the Supreme Court challenging a Punjab and Haryana High Court order which quashed a 2020 FIR in an alleged rioting case against several AAP leaders, including Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann.

Though the plea filed came up for hearing before a bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and Vipul M Pancholi, the counsel appearing for the Chandigarh administration sought some time saying they would file a petition in relation to some other persons who were granted relief by the high court in the matter.

On November 29 last year, the HC had quashed an FIR, the chargesheet and all subsequent proceedings against Mann and AAP leaders holding that no prima facie case was made out.

The 2020 FIR, on the complaint of a woman constable, alleged that several AAP leaders, including Mann, incited party workers to surround the residence of the then Punjab CM. It was alleged that the leaders and workers started pushing and shoving the police force deployed on the spot.

BJP slams UP Cong chief for 'abusing PM', he says video fake

Express News Service
Lucknow, May 22

UTTAR PRADESH Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath and the entire BJP leadership on Thursday hit out at UP Congress president Ajay Rai for his alleged derogatory remarks against Prime Minister Narendra Modi, a purported video of which had gone viral on social media.

While Rai termed the video fake and "AI-generated by BJP men", and said he would lodge a police complaint, the chief minister said the Congress leader's abusive comment to the statement as the mark of "frustration" reflected his party's "frustration" and "mental bankruptcy".

In a strongly-worded post on X, the chief minister said the comments made against the Prime Minister reflected the "political misconduct and poor culture" of the Congress party.

"UP Congress president's indecent, unparliamentary and inexcusable remarks against Prime Minister Narendra Modi expose the political values of Congress," Adityanath wrote.

Targeting the Congress leadership further, he said that even the party's "Yuvraj" had previously displayed similar political behaviour, in an apparent reference to Rahul Gandhi.

"Congress has now reached the highest level of despair, frustration, and mental bankruptcy. They are no longer even in a position to apologise to the people of the country," he added.

The remarks came amid escalating political confrontation

between the BJP and Congress after Rai's recent alleged remarks targeting the Prime Minister sparked outrage within BJP circles.

BJP spokesperson Rakesh Tripathi said, "The Congress should be ashamed. The language being used by the Congress is deplorable. The party has crossed all limits of decency. There is a competition within the Congress to hurl abuses. The Congress will have to face the consequences of this."

BJP IT Cell chief Amit Malviya also targeted the Congress leadership, alleging that the party was increasingly resorting to "abusive and desperate politics" due to repeated electoral setbacks. He accused Congress leaders of deliberately lowering the level of political discourse and attempting to gain attention through controversial remarks against the PM.

BJP leaders across UP condemned Rai's alleged comments, calling them an insult to democratic values and constitutional institutions. The Congress leaders defended their criticism of the BJP government as part of democratic opposition politics.

Meanwhile, Rai told PTI that he is in Mahoba to meet a rape survivor. "I have come to know about the video. It is fake and AI-generated by the BJP men. I will lodge a police complaint once I reach Lucknow," he said.

The Congress workers also held a protest in Lucknow and burnt effigies of BJP minister Dinesh Pratap Singh for allegedly making objectionable remarks against Rahul Gandhi.



Union Home Minister Amit Shah being felicitated by DG BSF Praveen Kumar in New Delhi on Friday. ANI

Shah: Smart Border project soon to make frontiers impenetrable

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 22

UNION HOME Minister Amit Shah on Friday announced a major technological and operational push to strengthen India's borders, saying the government will soon roll out a Smart Border project to make frontiers with Pakistan and Bangladesh impenetrable and to eliminate illegal infiltration.

Addressing the Border Security Force's (BSF) Investiture Ceremony and the Rustamji Memorial Lecture, Shah said, "Border security can no longer rely solely on traditional methods."

He outlined a new approach that blends stronger inter-agency coordination with high-end technology.

"The Ministry of Home Af-

fairs will soon introduce a Smart Border Project equipped with drones, radars, modern cameras and other advanced technologies. Once this initiative begins, the work of the BSF will become significantly easier and stronger," he added.

"Since 2014, India's defence and border policies have seen a transformational shift under Prime Minister Narendra Modi," he said.

Cross-border responses, including surgical strikes and air strikes, marked the end of resolving terror attacks through negotiations, he added.

On Vibrant Villages initiative, he said, "Vibrant Villages-1 and Vibrant Villages-2 are development programmes being implemented in a democratic manner with the cooperation of the BSF. The BSF's jurisdiction

has been extended from 15 kilometres to 50 kilometres and decisions related to land allocation in West Bengal have also been finalised."

Highlighting contemporary threats on India's frontiers, Shah flagged illegal infiltration, narcotics, cattle smuggling, counterfeit currency and the increasing use of drones for smuggling weapons and contraband. "The government has resolved not only to stop infiltration but to identify and expel every infiltrator. It will not allow unnatural demographic change," he said, adding that the BSF must prevent conspiracies aimed at altering demographics through infiltration.

He said that governments in Tripura, Assam, and West Bengal now follow policies that clearly oppose illegal infiltration.

VB-G RAM G: States to get funds based on finance panel model

Harikishan Sharma
New Delhi, May 22

THE CENTRE is set to adopt the same "objective parameters" for normative allocation of funds under the Viksit Bharat — Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G) scheme, which will be rolled out from July 1 this year, bringing down the curtain on the two-decade-old MGNREGS.

The Ministry of Rural Development on Friday released the draft of Objective Parameters for Normative Allocation Rules, 2026, seeking public comments within 30 days. As per the draft rules, "The Central Government shall, for each financial year, determine the normative allocation of the funds for every State based on the objective parameters specified in these rules."

"For the purpose of determining normative allocation for each financial year, the Central Government shall adopt the objective parameters used for horizontal devolution among States as recommended by the Sixteenth Finance Commission and accepted by the Government of India," states the sub-rule 4(i) of the draft rules.

According to the draft rules, from the financial year immediately after the first year of commencement of the Act, a portion of the normative allocation, as may be determined by the central government, may also be determined on the basis of the following performance criteria — timely payment of wages; compliance with social audit requirements; the percentage of com-

E. EXPLAINED

Cost-sharing formula

Departing from MGNREGA, the VB-G RAM G Act proposes a higher share of states in its funding. As per Section 22(1) of the Act, the fund-sharing pattern shall be 90:10 for the 11 states, and 60:40 for all other states. Under the MGNREGA, the Centre paid the entire wage bill and shared 75% of material and administrative cost.

pletion of works in a financial year; such other performance-related indicators as may be specified by the central government from time to time.

In respect of Union Territories for which horizontal devolution is not applicable, the central government shall determine the normative allocation on the basis of the performance criteria specified in sub-rule (3) of rule 4 and such other criteria as may be considered appropriate by the central government, states the draft rules.

The formula for horizontal devolution recommended by the 16th Finance Commission is based on 6 parameters — population, with a weight of 17.5%, demographic performance (10% weight), area (10%), forest (10%) per capita Gross State Domestic Product Distance (42.5%) and contribution to GDP (10%).

As Owaisi takes on Rijiju over Muslim numbers, a question: What's a minority?

Apurva Vishwanath
New Delhi, May 22

A WAR of words has erupted again between AIMIM chief Asaduddin Owaisi and Union Minister for Minority Affairs Kiren Rijiju over the status of Muslims as a minority community.

In response to Rijiju's statement comparing the demographic size of Muslims with Parsis, a small minority group, Hyderabad MP Owaisi said the "minister is indulging in propaganda to deny Muslims their fundamental rights under Article 30".

Their sharp exchange puts the spotlight on a larger question: Who constitutes a minority in India?

In an interview to *The Indian Express* last year, Rijiju had said that "minorities receive more government support" than Hin-

dus. "The main point we have to understand is that minority communities are receiving more funds and support from the government than the majority community, the Hindus. Whatever the Hindus get, the minorities also do. But what the minorities get, the Hindus don't," the minister had said.

Earlier this week, addressing a conference of the State Minorities Commissions organised by the National Commission for Minorities in Delhi, Rijiju said, "... if we look at the Muslim population in India as a separate country, it could be the sixth-largest country", while Parsis with a population of about 52,000 would constitute a town or a village. Still, both Parsis and Muslims have the status of minorities in the country, he said.

Flagging Rijiju's statement, Owaisi, in an X post, posed a



In response to Rijiju's statement comparing the demographic size of Muslims with Parsis, Owaisi said the "minister is indulging in propaganda to deny Muslims their fundamental rights"

"simple math question" to him. Comparing the population of the Hindu community with Muslims, the AIMIM chief asked, "What is bigger? 79.8% or 14%? If Hindus are the majority community, then every non-Hindu group is a minority community."

Joining issue with Owaisi on



X, Rijiju replied: "You're the tallest Muslim leader in India as you always speak for Muslim rights. But remember, Congress has become a Muslim League party." This was a reference to the large number of Muslims elected on Congress ticket in the recent Assembly elections. He also said, "Every Indian is equal.

Even Parsis with around 53,000 population are as safe as the Muslims. Every religion has flourished in India. Only the population of Parsis and Hindus (in percentage) have come down (in) India."

The Constitution does not define a "minority" even when it offers fundamental protections to them. Articles 29 and 30 safeguard the protection of the interests of minorities and the right of minorities to establish and administer educational institutions of their choice, respectively.

The framers of the Constitution deliberately left it to the Executive to define who is a minority. However, the term minorities is constitutionally understood in two contexts: religious and linguistic.

Statutorily, the National Commission for Minorities Act,

1992 provides a definition: "minority" is a community notified as such by the Central government. This law empowers the government to notify "minority communities".

Currently, six religious communities are recognised as minorities at the national level. These are Muslims, Christians, Sikhs, Buddhists, Parsis, who were notified in 2013, and the latest one, Jains, who were added in this list in 2014. This is a Central notification that entitles communities to benefits under government welfare schemes, including scholarships, Waqf protections, and various Ministry of Minority Affairs programmes. Over the years, there have been various political and legal calls for determining the status of minorities state-wise, rather than nationally.

The argument from the right

is that in a state like Jammu and Kashmir, where Muslims form a majority, they should not be considered a minority at the Central level.

In the landmark ruling on minority educational institutions in TMA Pai v State of Karnataka in 2002, a Constitution Bench of the Supreme Court stated that linguistic minority status is to be determined state-wise. "Linguistic and religious minorities are covered by the expression 'minority' under Article 30 of the Constitution. Since the reorganisation of the State in India has been on linguistic lines, for the purpose of determining the minority, the unit will be the State and not the whole of India. Thus, religious and linguistic minorities, who have been put on par in Article 30, have to be considered State-wise," it ruled.

4 women killed in tiger attack in Maharashtra

Pratip Acharya
Mumbai, May 22

FOUR WOMEN were mauled to death by a tigress and her cubs in Maharashtra's Chandrapur district early Friday. The incident marks the seventh fatal tiger attack reported from the district this year. The state forest department said that the deceased were identified as San-geeta Choudhary (50), Kawdabai Mohurle (45), Anubai Mohurle (40) and Sunita Mohurle (38).

The women had entered the forest adjoining Gunjewahi village in Chandrapur to collect tendu leaves when they were attacked. Chief Conservator of Forests Ramanujam R M told *The Indian Express*, "The village adjoins Brahmapuri division of the forest where we have located the presence of a tiger family comprising one tigress and three cubs. We had told villagers not to go into the forest for the time being." He also said that three of the victims — Kawdabai, Anubai and Sunita — had earlier been intercepted by forest officials during patrols on May 14 after allegedly trespassing into the forest and were escorted home.

"The three cubs are presently in their adolescent stage, which means they are over two years old and about to get dispersed from their mothers — a dangerous age for tigers because at this point they act in an aggressive manner," Ramanujam said.

Following the incident, forest authorities announced immediate financial aid of Rs 25,000 each to the victims' families. Surveillance in the area has also been intensified, with three live-monitoring cameras and 30 camera traps installed in and around the forest. They have imposed a blanket ban on villagers entering the forest to collect tendu leaves until further notice.

IMD: Heatwave to prevail in northwest India next week

Express News Service
Bengaluru, May 22

FOR YET another week, many areas along the northwest India regions will continue to experience "severe" heat waves, with both day and night temperatures likely to remain significantly above normal.

Some areas in southern states like Telangana will also experience heatwave conditions till May 27, the IMD said Friday. "There is no large change expected in the maximum temperatures during the next 7 days over northwest India. 'Severe' heatwave conditions will prevail over east UP, east Madhya Pradesh till May 28," said the IMD.

On Thursday, heatwave conditions prevailed at a few places in Himachal Pradesh and Haryana and at isolated pockets in J&K, Uttarakhand, Punjab, Haryana, UP and west Rajasthan. "Severe" heatwave conditions were recorded at isolated places in eastern UP, where Banda continued to remain the hottest place in India at 47°C.

As per the latest forecast, heatwave conditions would sweep across Punjab, Haryana, Delhi, Chandigarh, Madhya Pradesh and UP till May 28. The Monsoon is likely to hit Kerala on May 26, the latest update added.

FACTS ON DEFENCE COOPERATION, CYBER SECURITY, COUNTER-TERRORISM INKED

India, Cyprus upgrade bilateral ties to Strategic Partnership

Cyprus keen to procure drones and missiles from India

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, May 22

INDIA AND Cyprus agreed to elevate their bilateral ties to Strategic Partnership, unveiled a 5-year roadmap for defence cooperation (2026-2031), decided to establish a cyber security dialogue and strengthen cooperation on maritime transport, space and health as Prime Minister Narendra Modi met visiting President of Cyprus Nikos Christodoulides in Delhi on Friday.

The two sides signed six pacts, including an MoU on establishing a joint working group on counter-terrorism, in the field of diplomatic training, on innovation and technology, establishment of official coordination and cooperation on Search and Rescue (SAR), on higher education and research and cultural cooperation from 2026-2030.

Top Cypriot officials said the two nations exchanged notes on Turkey's influence in the region as there is a shared "concern" — Turkey had backed Pakistan last year and it has a strained relationship with Cyprus. Officials said Cyprus is keen to procure



PM Narendra Modi and Cyprus President Nikos Christodoulides take a selfie at Hyderabad House, New Delhi, on Friday. PTI

military equipment from India, including drones and missiles, which "have been tested" last year during Operation Sindoor against Pakistan.

Modi said, "We are today elevating our trusted relationship to the level of a Strategic Partnership. And today, as India and Europe embark upon a new golden era in their relations, Cyprus is not only holding the Presidency of the Council of the European Union but is also emerging as a vital investment gateway between India and the entire European continent."

Christodoulides underlined "strengthening the longstanding bonds" and "deepening and expanding" strategic cooperation with India. "Today I'm not here only in my capacity as

President of the Republic of Cyprus, I'm also here in my capacity as a President of the member state of the European Union that proudly holds the presidency of the council, and so these paths cross at the juncture when both our bilateral relations and the European Union-India relations have made leaps of progress over the last year. We are here to put more building blocks to these two partnerships."

Positioning Europe as a factor of stability, he said, "In these times of growing geopolitical uncertainty, I firmly believe that the partnership between the European Union and India must become stronger, because this relationship is no longer driven only by economics... Together the European Union and India

E. EXPLAINED

Why Cyprus is important for India

Cyprus is located close to Turkey and Syria. It's a EU member despite being geographically in Asia. Its location makes it a crucial part of the IMEEC, an infrastructure project that India expects multiple benefits from. IMEEC is supposed to boost trade and connectivity between India and Europe via the Middle East, and Cyprus, in the Mediterranean, has an important role to play.

can play a defining role not only for our regions but also for global stability and prosperity."

Modi said, "...Today, we have also resolved to further strengthen our cooperation in the domains of cyber security, maritime security and counter-terrorism." About the investment target, he said they aim to double it once again over the next five years. "Cyprus ranks among India's top 10 investors; over the past decade, investment from Cyprus into India has nearly doubled. The level of trust between our two nations has deepened. The India-European Union Free Trade Agreement has opened up a host of

new possibilities. Capitalizing on this potential, we aim to double this investment once again in the next five years."

India and Cyprus also agreed to speed up negotiations on the mobility pact. "Indian professionals and students residing in Cyprus are further reinforcing the bonds between our peoples. To further consolidate these ties, we have reached a consensus to conclude, at the earliest, a comprehensive Migration and Mobility Partnership, alongside a Social Security Agreement," said Modi. The two sides are also working towards the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEEC) project. "We will work in tandem to ensure connectivity through key initiatives such as the Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative and the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor," the PM said.

Christodoulides said, "We have continuous conversations with the Prime Minister about regional connectivity initiatives, including, of course, IMEEC... I consider this a visionary initiative reflecting the growing importance of trusted interconnection between the Indo-Pacific, the Middle East, and Europe. And Cyprus, located at the crossroads of three continents and the gateway to Europe stands ready to contribute actively to this shared vision, a vision of connectivity, a vision of openness, a vision of partnership."

FOREST DEPARTMENT, POLICE DEMOLISH 25-30 HOUSES IN JAMMU'S SIDHRA AREA

Militants forced them to flee in 1997, govt razed house in 2026: Elderly couple left homeless again

Arun Sharma
Jammu, May 22

IT IS for the second time that 80-year-old Abdul Razak and 75-year-old Khatoon Bi have been forced to leave their home in the last 30 years. The couple's house in Jammu was among two dozen demolished in the Sidhra area by the J&K Police and Forest Department earlier this week, alleging that the structures were built on forest land.

Amid the scorching heat Wednesday, a day after their house was demolished, the elderly couple could be found taking shelter from the sun under a large tree. The temperature went up to 43 degrees Celsius Wednesday, nearly four degrees above the seasonal average. Sitting in the shade under the tree, Razak remembered the first time the couple, originally from South Kashmir's Koker-nag, were rendered homeless — in mid-1997, when militants threatened to kill them for providing information to security forces. "It was peak militancy in South Kashmir when an Army unit came to our village," recalled Razak, with Khatoon Bi sitting right next to him.

The Army unit stayed in a local school, and the next morning, they called the local residents. "A senior Army officer requested us to provide them information against militants in



Abdul Razak (80) and wife Khatoon Bi (75) now stay in a makeshift tent erected on the same land where their house was razed. EXPRESS

the area," he said, adding that based on the information they provided, several militants were killed. "During their stay, we worked for the security forces and even constructed bunkers for them, but when the area became militancy-free, the unit left," he said. After this, militants returned to the village and burnt houses and also the school building where security forces had set up camp, Razak said. "When militants asked the villagers to disclose the names of the people who had helped security forces. Some of them gave our names."

He recalled that the militants killed three persons in the village, including his brother-in-law, spreading fear among the family and leading them to flee to Jammu. Their latest displacement came Tuesday, when per-

sonnel of the Forest Department and police demolished 25-30 houses belonging to people from the tribal Gujjar and Bakarwal communities, including theirs. This time, they're not sure where to go. Currently, they are staying in makeshift tents erected on the same land where their houses were demolished. Razak and Khatoon are registered migrants from Kashmir, getting free ration and monthly cash relief of Rs 3,250 per person. Their son-in-law, Manzoor Ahmad, his wife Zareena Begum, and their children Sameer and Afsana, are also registered Kashmiri migrants. Their house was also demolished Tuesday.

While Razak said his migrants' ration card issued by the Office of the Relief Commissioner was buried under the

rubble of his house as officials allegedly did not give him time to bring everything out, Manzoor's ration card, issued on April 1, 2026, mentions the family as "KM" under the "Special Reservation Category".

The migration

In the years after the outbreak of militancy in Kashmir in 1989, nearly 40,000 Kashmiri Pandit families left their homes in the Valley and migrated to Jammu and other parts of India. After threats from militants, over 2,500 Muslim families also left the Valley. In Jammu, they were registered as migrants from Kashmir, just like Pandits. Abdul Razak said, "We initially stayed in a rented accommodation in Bhatindi, and after some time, local people, moved by our plight, advised us to settle at the present site, which was an open area." Successive governments in Jammu and Kashmir provided them with electricity and water connections, among other basic amenities.

Protest, demolition

However, in recent years, trouble arose with right-wing groups and the BJP demanding that people "illegally" occupying the land be evicted. Just a few days before the Tuesday demolition, BJP MLA from the Bahu constituency, Vikram Randhawa, led a protest on May 13 on

Sidhra road, demanding the immediate removal of encroachments on forest and state land in his constituency. Raising slogans, the protesters disrupted vehicular traffic on the road for nearly two hours and also warned of a major agitation if no action was taken in the matter.

Within a week, forest officials and police arrived with a JCB machine arrived at the forests near Mahamaya temple and demolished 25-30 houses, retrieving nearly 60 kanals of land.

Minister vows action

While Forest Department officials say the structures were illegally raised on demarcated forest land, Jammu and Kashmir's Forest and Tribal Affairs Minister Javed Rana has denied the claim, saying the people were staying on state land, not forest land. While visiting the affected families after the demolition, Rana assured them of action against the officers responsible. Also asked Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha to initiate action against police personnel involved in the demolition drive.

Later, the minister constituted a two-member fact-finding panel to inquire into the demolition of houses and report on any violation of the Forest Rights Act, 2006, which allows tribals to stay on forest land. The panel has been directed to submit its report in seven days.

BRIEFLY



Judicial officers pedal to court on bicycles on Friday. VISHAL SRIVASTAV

UTTAR PRADESH

Lucknow court staff pedal to court after PM's call for fuel conservation

JUDICIAL OFFICERS, including District and Sessions Judge Malkhan Singh, pedalled to the court on bicycles in Lucknow on Friday, following an appeal by Prime Minister Narendra Modi to save fuel. District and Sessions Judge Malkhan Singh said the decision was made in the national interest. "We will proceed to the court today by bicycle. Those officers who are unable to ride a bicycle will travel to the court via e-rickshaw," he said. "Furthermore, we pledge to use shared vehicles on every working day, and travel to the court by e-rickshaw or bicycle every Saturday." PTI

Odisha confirms three deaths due to heatwave

THE ODISHA government has confirmed three heatwave deaths as the state continues to reel under intense summer. Officials said one death each has been reported from Bolangir, Sundargarh and Sonepur. "We have received reports of 16 alleged deaths due to heatwave conditions. While three have been confirmed, four have been negated after receipt of post mortem reports. Other cases are being examined," said an official. ENS

NCB recovers 702 kg ganja; 2 held in Gondia

THE NCB has seized 702 kg of ganja worth Rs 3 crore and arrested two from Maharashtra's Gondia, an officer said Friday. Acting on intel, the NCB intercepted Prakash M D and Padamlal N M travelling in a truck, and found ganja concealed in 100 packets hidden among grocery items like detergent, toothpaste and hair dye. The contraband was sourced from Odisha and was meant for drug syndicates in Nagpur, Gondia, Pune and Mumbai. PTI

NEET-UG PAPER LEAK ROW

CBI arrests another Pune teacher; 'she had access to physics paper'

Mahender Singh Manral & Soham Shah
New Delhi, Pune, May 22

THE CBI on Friday arrested another teacher who was involved in NEET-UG 2026 and had complete access to the physics question paper set for the exams, officials said. This comes days after the agency arrested two teachers, appointed by the National Testing Agency (NTA), in connection with the alleged NEET-UG paper leak.

"The accused, Manisha Sanjay Havaladar, is employed at Seth Hiralal Saraf Prashala in Pune. She had been appointed by the NTA as an expert involved in the exam process. She had full access to physics question papers for NEET-UG 2026 and, during April 2026, she shared a number of physics questions with co-accused Manisha Mandhare, who was arrested earlier on May 16," a CBI spokesperson said. The CBI probe has revealed that physics questions shared by Havaladar matched those in the NEET-UG 2026 question paper.

Havaladar (58) is the principal of Seth Hiralal Saraf Prashala. She holds an MSc in physics. She joined the school as a physics teacher in 1992, said Satish Gavali, secretary of NGO

Vidya Prasari Sabha that runs the school. She has served as principal since 2023 and was set to retire on June 30, 2026. "There has never been any complaint against her..." Gavali said. "The organisation (Vidya Prasari Sabha) has no association with this (paper leak) incident. It's a 103-year-old organisation and provides education. We condemn the teacher's actions... We've suspended her and have constituted an inquiry committee to take action on her."

Arrested last week, Mandhare, a biology subject expert from Pune's Modern College of Arts, Science and Commerce, is learnt to have translated questions from both botany and zoology sections, giving her access to a wider portion of the paper than previously known. Another arrested expert, retired chemistry lecturer P V Kulkarni from Dayanand Junior College, Latur, was reportedly involved in translating the paper into Marathi.

The CBI has also alleged that Mandhare conspired with the other co-accused, beauty salon owner Manisha Waghmare and Kulkarni. So far, 11 accused have been arrested from several cities, including Delhi, Jaipur, Gurugram, Nashik, Pune, Latur and Ahliyanagar, it said.

First Friday after Bhojshala ruling: Prayers at home, maha aarti at site

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, May 22

UNDER THE watch of nearly 1,800 security personnel deployed across Dhar, the Bhojshala-Kamal Maula complex witnessed its first 'maha aarti' by Hindu groups, while Muslims who say their right to offer namaaz at the structure still stands chose to offer prayers in the confines of their homes as a sign of protest.

Barricades ringed approach roads to the complex from Friday morning, while RAF, QRF and STF personnel patrolled sensitive areas. Police conducted flag marches through Dhar, Madhya Pradesh, Thursday night ahead of the prayers and ceremonies, with officers monitoring social media and maintaining additional pickets

in Muslim-majority localities.

The maha aarti comes after the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) granted the Hindus unrestricted access to the monument at the Bhojshala complex in Dhar for worship and other purposes. The administration would permit only those rituals allowed under the Madhya Pradesh High Court order. "Only puja that has been permitted after the orders and orders of the honourable High Court will be conducted here. Apart from this, we have made adequate security arrangements within the premises, around the area, and across the entire city," Dhar SP Sachin Sharma said. "Discussions had been held with community representatives and all sides agreed to follow the court's directions."

The atmosphere inside the complex sharply contrasted

with the tension outside. Hindu devotees queued barefoot beneath the carved stone arches of the ASI-protected monument, reciting Hanuman Chalisa and offering prayers to Goddess Saraswati, whom they refer to as "Ma Vagdevi". Hindu organisations described Friday's event as historically significant, adding it was the first Friday maha aarti held at Bhojshala in 721 years. The Bhoj Utsav Samiti had earlier announced that devotees would take out a procession and conduct a "Vagdevi Maha Aarti" after the HC ruling altered the religious status of the site.

Until the Madhya Pradesh HC judgment on May 15, worship at the monument operated under a 2003 ASI arrangement that allowed Hindus to offer prayers on Tuesdays and Basant Panchami, while Muslims



People offer prayers at the Bhojshala complex in Dhar on Friday. PTI

offered namaz on Fridays. The arrangement had often led to tension when Basant Panchami coincided with Friday prayers.

The HC, however, held last week that the religious character of the disputed structure was that of Bhojshala — a temple dedicated to Goddess Saraswati.

The court said the site remained a protected monument whose preservation was the constitutional responsibility of the state.

Inside the complex Friday, petitioners offered prayers and called the verdict part of a wider resurgence of Hindu assertion. "Today, we are winning the fight

to reclaim symbols of Hindu faith, pride," petitioner Kuldeep Tiwari said. Referring to the legal challenge mounted by the Muslim side, he said that the matter could not be considered fully settled until the apex court pronounced its final verdict. Tiwari also demanded unrestricted access for Hindu devotees to the site, saying entry fees should no longer be charged as Bhojshala had been declared a temple.

The ruling has also triggered fresh demands from Hindu litigants over the physical structure of the monument. The petitioner, associated with the Hindu Front for Justice, has written to the ASI, seeking the immediate opening of a locked room in the south-eastern section of the complex, claiming it formed part of the original temple structure. In his plea,

Goyal demanded the removal of what he termed "unauthorised Islamic symbols" from the premises in view of the HC ruling. Even as Hindu groups celebrated the ruling, Muslim petitioners announced symbolic protests against the order, while emphasising they would remain within constitutional limits.

Maulana Kamal Welfare Society chief Abdul Samad, a petitioner, said members of the community would offer namaz at their homes and courtyards instead of gathering at the complex. Muslims would wear black bands, shut shops and upload photos and videos of prayers on social media to protest what they viewed as the loss of a mosque. "We want to send this message that our mosques are being snatched from us," Samad said. "The Constitution

guarantees us the right to worship. We will follow the Constitution and not play with other people's religious sentiments."

The protests came as the Muslim side formally moved the Supreme Court against the HC verdict. One Qazi Moinuddin has filed an appeal challenging the May 15 judgment that declared the religious character of the Bhojshala-Kamal Maula complex to be that of a Hindu temple. Friday's developments marked the latest chapter in a dispute that has shaped communal and political mobilisation in Dhar for decades. By Friday evening, the city remained tense but calm, with security forces continuing deployment across sensitive zones as both sides prepared for what is expected to be a prolonged legal battle before the Supreme Court.

OFFICE OF EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
WATERSHED DEVELOPEMENT &
SOIL CONSERVATION, SAMBHAR LAKE (JAIPUR)
Email:- aen.samber@gmail.com & AENWDSO.SAMBER@RAJASTHAN.GOV.IN
No.: 195 Date:- 18-05-2026

NOTICE INVITING BID
NIB No. 03/2026-27

Bids for Farm Pond Waters (70) value 205.98 Lakh (MUSA 2.2, Block Jobner) are invited from Interested bidders upto 6:00 PM 29.05.2026 Other particulars & Bids may be visited <https://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <https://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>, & www.watershed.gov.in.

UBN:-WSC2627A0264
UBN:-WSC2627WSOB00412

Sd/-
(Balbir Singh)
Executive Engineer
WDSO, Sambhar Lake, Jaipur

DIPR/C/8913/2026

SAMRAT VIKRAMADITYA VISHWAVIDYALAYA, UJJAIN
Serial No./store/Exam/Tender/2026/458 Dated : 22.05.2026

TENDER NOTICE FOR DIGITALIZATION & E-CATALOGUING OF OLD TABULATION CHARTS AND OFFICE RECORDS

E-tenders are invited for Digitalization & E-Cataloguing of Old Tabulation Charts and other office records as per actual/as verified by the concerned authority from turnkey solution provider. Tender document and other tender terms and conditions can be downloaded from the website of government of Madhya Pradesh tender portal (<https://mptenders.gov.in>) and (www.vikramuniv.ac.in) on the online payments of Rs. 3000/- (Non-Refundable) as cost of tender form and documents.

M.P. Madham/125961/2026 **REGISTRAR**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Letter No. : DRM/C/AGRA/NFR/E-AUCTION Dated : 21.05.2026

E-Auction Notice

On Behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager- North Central Railway Agra invites E-Auction as per category given as under:-

Category : ADVT Catalogue No. : NFR-AGRA-26-06

Asset Details : Commercial publicity via Vinyl wrapping/Board/Paint at Escalator & FOB area of Agra Cant. Railway station Zone IInd.

E-Auction Start Date and Time : 04.06.2026 Time : 11:00

E-Auction End Date and Time : 04.06.2026 Time : 11:30

Asset Details : Commercial publicity via LED Lollipop Flange at Platform & Concourse area of Mathura Jn. Railway Station.

E-Auction Start Date and Time : 04.06.2026 Time : 11:10

E-Auction End Date and Time : 04.06.2026 Time : 11:40

Category : Misc-Static-Services Catalogue No. : BOC-AGRA-26-02

Asset Details : Battery Operated Car at Idgah Jn. Railway Station.

E-Auction Start Date and Time : 04.06.2026 Time : 11:00

E-Auction End Date and Time : 04.06.2026 Time : 11:30

Note : Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 1167/26 (AS)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in CPRONCR

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY SUPPLY OF STORES ITEMS
"THROUGH E-PROCUREMENT TENDERS"
Tender Notice No. S/2026/21 Date : 20.05.2026

The Principal Chief Material Manager, North Western Railway, headquarter Jaipur, for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open E-tenders on www.ireps.gov.in site as follows.

Sr.	Tender No	Brief Description	Qty.	Unit	Due Date
1	30262166	Flexible hose- 650mm for bogie	8372	Nos	08.06.2026
2	10264753	Housing Axle Bearing	85	Nos	09.06.2026
3	30264767B	Flex Ball Cable (L-2197 MM) for LHB power car	167	Nos	09.06.2026
4	36262881	OVERHAULING KIT FOR LEVELLING VALVE C	1829	Set	09.06.2026
5	30264882B	One set consists 02 items (1) Top flange as per RCF	490	Set	09.06.2026
6	40260058	Self Priming Mono Block Pump	2683	Nos	09.06.2026
7	30263323	Hose connection 20 x 550 mm (with washer at both ends) for air spring suspension bogie	12874	Nos	10.06.2026
8	37262825	Bogie center pivot bottom	890	Nos	10.06.2026
9	40261772	POWER CONTACTOR [WITH DIODE] FOR COMPRESSOR UNIT OF LHB TYPE AC COACH	1765	Nos	11.06.2026
10	40260067	60 KVA, 750V/415V, 3 PHASE 4 WIRE, VECTOR CONFIGURATION	42	Nos	15.06.2026
11	40260002B	MOTOR PROTECTION CIRCUIT BREAKER	3917	Nos	15.06.2026
12	40261767	DISCONNECTING AND EARTHING DEVICE	185	Nos	16.06.2026
13	30262203	Set of 35 mm Non Asbestos based organic brake pads for LHB coaches	49433	Set	17.06.2026
14	40261884	Side Body Filter/Panel	3956	Nos	18.06.2026
15	30262195	Flex ball cable long length (L-4024 mm) with end connection	248	Nos	19.06.2026
16	37262088	Constant contact polyurethane side bearer pad assembly	1144	Nos	23.06.2026
17	6325ENG35	Manufacture and supply of over riding Derailing Switches	217	Set	08.07.2026

CORRIGENDUM

Tender No.	NIT No.	Description	Tender Opening date	Tender Qty		
				Existing	To be read as	
30260172	S/2026/20 Dated : 13.05.2026	Hanger for bolster suspension BG.	23.06.2026	5913	Nos	5907 Nos

Note : (1) Interested tenderers may visit the website ireps.gov.in for Full details/description/specification/EMD & tender cost etc. All tenderers are requested to obtain digital signatures and get them registered on above site and quote electronically only. (2) For viewing and participating in other tenders such as open tender costing below Rs. 50 Lakh, limited tenders, special limited tenders and low value tenders, please visit www.ireps.gov.in

758-DE/26

Please join us on [Facebook](https://www.facebook.com/NWRailways) [Twitter](https://www.twitter.com/NWRailways) [YouTube](https://www.youtube.com/NWRailways)

बिहार सरकार
नगर निगम, गयाजी
ई-पुनर्विनिर्माण आगमन की सूचना (ई-टेंडरिंग द्वारा www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in.)

संख्या- NIT No.- 11/2026-27

नगर आयुक्त, नगर निगम, गयाजी।
दिनांक-20.05.2026
दिनांक-10.06.2026 को समय 11:00 बजे पूर्वार्हण से 05:00 बजे अपराह्न तक।
दिनांक- 09.06.2026 के 10:00 पूर्वार्हण से (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
दिनांक-15.06.2026 समय 03:00 बजे अपराह्न तक (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
दिनांक- 15.06.2026 समय 03:30 बजे अपराह्न तक (तकनीकी बीड में सफल होने के उपरान्त निर्देशानुसार)

1. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं फार्मा
2. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्गत की तिथि -
3. प्री बीड मीटिंग की तिथि एवं समय एवं स्थान
4. परिणाम विपत्र प्राप्त करने की तिथि एवं समय
5. संवेदक द्वारा निविदा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि
6. तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि
7. वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि
8. कार्य की विवरणी-

क्र०	कार्य का नाम	प्रारंभिक राशि (रु. में)	अंतिम की राशि (अप्रतिवेद्य) को मूल्य (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)	परिणाम विपत्र (अप्रतिवेद्य) को मूल्य (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)	Bid Processing fee (Through Online Payment हेतु प्रोसेसिंग शुल्क)	कार्य समाप्ति की तिथि
1	गया नगर निगम क्षेत्र के वार्ड संख्या 36 अंगणवाड़ी बालिका बालक कोना स्थित शुभम स्टेमनरी से मनोज किराना दुकान होते हुए नुन नगर, पीएनएचबीडी बैंक तक पथ एवं नाली तथा फुल्लेक का निर्माण।	6150100	123000	10000	As per eproc 2.0	120 दिन

नोट:- Bidders Should submit Bid Processing fee thorough Online Payment as per Amount generated on Website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in
विस्तृत निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना विभागीय वेबसाइट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in अथवा www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर देखा जा सकता है।
नगर आयुक्त, नगर निगम, गयाजी
PR. No. 003882 (B&C) 2026-27

विस्तृत जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

यौन जनित रोग छुपाओ नहीं ईलाज कराओ, खुद के साथ अपने जीवन साथी को भी सुरक्षित करें।

Government of Rajasthan
Commercial Taxes Department
Kar Bhawan, Ambedkar Circle, Bhawani Singh Road, C-Scheme, Jaipur-302005

Commercial Taxes Department (CTD), Rajasthan invites online bids from the eligible bidders for the following work:-

NIB No./Date/Unique Bid No.	Particulars	Estimated Cost/ EMD	Start of Sale / Last Date
2216806/18.05.2026/ (CTO2627SLOB00001)	ATS of Orade products & Providing OEM Manpower Services under ITMS Project of CTD, Rajasthan	Rs. 10 Crore/ Rs. 20 Lakh	19.05.2026/ 08.06.2026

Details can be seen on the websites <https://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://rajtax.gov.in> and Bids are to be submitted through <https://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>.

Commissioner

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 356(2)(I) BHARATIYA NAGRIK SURAKSHA SANHITA

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rajesh Sharma** S/o Sh. Jugheshwar Sharma, R/o: H. No. C-372, Gali No-6, Medical Store Wall Gali, (National Medical Store) Pratap Nagar, Saboli, Harsh Vihar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence punishable under Sections 65(1)/75/208 of Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and Sections 4/8/12 of POCSSO Act, in FIR No. 536/2024, dated 29/09/2024, P.S. Harsh Vihar, Delhi. The accused **Rajesh Sharma** is hereby informed that in the above said case he has already been declared a Proclaimed Offender by the Hon'ble Court and proceedings under Section 356 (2) (i) of the Bharatiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023 have been initiated against him. Therefore, proclamation is hereby made that the accused **Rajesh Sharma** shall appear before this Court to answer the said complaint within 30 (thirty) days from the date of publication of this notice. If the accused fails to appear within the prescribed period, further proceedings of the trial shall be commenced in his absence as per the provisions of Section 356 of the Bharatiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023. The accused **Rajesh Sharma** is directed to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on the next date of hearing i.e. **03.07.2026**.

By Order: Dr. Himanshu Raman Singh
Additional District & Sessions Judge-01,
Special Judge (POCSO Act), Shahdara District,
Court No. 79, 6th Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/6554/NE/2026

GUJARAT MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Gujarat Undertaking)
Regd. Office: Block No. 14/1,
Dr. Jivraj Mehta Bhavan, Sector-10, Gandhinagar
Ph.079-23250767, 23250766, 23257698

TENDER NOTICE NO:GMSCL/D-27/2026-27

Tenders are invited online from reputed Manufacturers/formulators/ Direct importers for Tablet & Capsule, Injection and Miscellaneous Item on Rate contract basis and details of specification, quantity is available on <https://gmscl.gujarat.gov.in> All tender documents can be downloaded free on the website: <https://tender.nprocure.com> Interested bidders are requested to submit the tender through e-tender process.

Duration of downloading of tender document (online):-22/05/2026 to 06/06/2026 upto 18.00 Hrs

Last date for Submission (online): 06/06/2026 upto 18-00 HRS

Last date for submission of EMD/Tender Fee (Physical): 08/06/2026 upto 18:00 HRS

Opening of Technical Bid Date (online): 11/06/2026 At 15-00 HRS.

Pre-Consultation meeting (Pre-Bid)

Interested Manufacturers/formulators/Direct Importers are requested to remain present for pre-Consultation meeting to be held on 29/05/2026 at 11.30 am at Committee room at above mentioned address. Only one representative from each Manufacturer carrying authority letter would be allowed to participate in the pre-bid.

INF-385-2026-27 **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Open E-TENDER NOTICE

For and on behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (Chg.), Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites open e-tender on "SINGLE PACKET SYSTEM" for following work from experienced and capable tenderers.

Name of Work	Supply & installation of F-Type mounting bracket stand locking arrangement for S-Trap gripping & protection as per ICF drg. no.32963203 and Annexure-A, and SS cage/strainer in S-Trap (90-94 mm OD) as per Annexure-B of Railway Board L/No 2021/M(C)/141/2P12 dated 08.05.2025 in LHB coaches over Delhi Division.
Work Place	Delhi Division (ANVT, DLI, DEE, NDLS, NZM)
Period of Work	Three (03) Months
Advertised Value	Rs.47.30,172.60/- (including provision of GST)
Earnest Money to be deposited	Rs.94,600.00/-, through net banking or gateway only
Tender Document Cost	Nil
Date and Time availability of E-Tender Document	From 21.05.2026 to 12.06.2026 at 12:00 hrs
Date and Time of E-Tender Closing	12.06.2026 12:00 hrs
Date and Time of E-Tender Opening	On 12.06.2026 after 12:00 hrs; If the date of opening happens to be holiday then E-Tender shall be opened on the next working day
Place for opening E-Tender	Mechanical Department, Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi-55

Note: The complete particulars of the tender may be found in website www.ireps.gov.in

No: NRDL10CMNW912025RT Date: 22/05/2026 1733/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

VICTORIA HOSPITAL
Bangalore Medical College & Research Institute
Office of the Medical Superintendent, Victoria Hospital,
Bengaluru - 560002. Telephone: 080-26701150, Fax: 080-26703267

No: VH/Tender/06/2025-26 Dated: 22-05-2026

SHORT TERM RE-TENDER NOTIFICATION

Short Term Re-Tender has been invited as per Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 - 2000 for the Surgical Microscope for Department of ENT. Cold Storage Cabinets for Department of Forensic Medicine. Arthroscopy for Department of Orthopedic, Fractional Co2 Laser, ND YAG Laser, Diode Laser for Department of Dermatology at Victoria Hospital, Bengaluru.

The tender documents may be downloaded from E-Procurement Portal Website: <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> from 22-05-2026 and Last Date for Submission of Tenders through E-Procurement Portal is 30-05-2026 upto 4.00 PM. Those tenders which are not submitted with EMD will be rejected.

For further details contact Medical Superintendent, Victoria Hospital, Bengaluru. Sd/- Medical Superintendent
Victoria Hospital, Bengaluru.

DIPR/CP/753/Advt/2026-27

कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, संभाग प्रथम जोधपुर

क्रमांक: Raj Kaj Ref No.22295680 दिनांक: 18.05.2026

निविदा सूचना संख्या: 03 वर्ष 2026-27

NIB No. PWD2627A0589

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से विभिन्न सबक का निर्माण कार्य हेतु उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग राज्यपाल में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार के अधिकृत संवेदकों / केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग / डाक एवं दूर संचार विभाग / रेलवे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों को कि राज्यपाल सरकार के उपयुक्त श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हो, से निविदा प्रपत्र में ईप्रोसेसिंग प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑनलाइन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं।

निविदा एवं सम्बंधित विवरण वेब साइट <http://dipr.rajjasthan.gov.in> व <http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है। सम्पूर्ण निविदा प्रक्रिया <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर ऑनलाइन सम्पादित की जायेगी। कार्यवार वृत्तीय एवं संख्या निम्नानुसार है।

1. PWD2627WL0B02670	2. PWD2627WLOB02671	3. PWD2627WSOB02672
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ई-साईन
(नवी चन्द शर्मा)
अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता,
सार्वजनिक निर्माण प्रथम, जोधपुर

DIPR/C/8910/2026

OFFICE OF THE MUNICIPAL CORPORATION SAGAR
PHONE No. 07582-229454, Fax-07582-224553 E-mail:-commsagar@mpurban.gov.in

NIT No: NN/PWD/Sagar/e-tender/2026/10 Sagar, Date: 22/5/26

:: NOTICE INVITING ONLINE E-TENDER ::
(Second Call)

Online tenders are invited from contractors registered in the centralized system for the following work:-

Online Tender No	Name of Work	Probable Amount of Contract (In Rupees)	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (In Rupees)	Cost of Bid Document (In Rupees)	Category of Contractor	Period Completion
2026_UAD_509636_1	CONSTRUCTION OF 07 MANGAL BHAWANS AT SAGAR M.P.	7,63,85,492/-	3,81,928/-	20,000/-	Appropriate Category	12 Months
2026_UAD_509658_1	CONSTRUCTION OF MULTIPLE PARKS AND SPORTS FACILITIES AT SAGAR M.P.	5,06,51,936/-	2,53,260/-	20,000/-	Appropriate Category	12 Months

- Interested bidders can view the NIT on website <https://mptenders.gov.in> Under Directorate Urban Administration and Development Department.
- The Bid Document can be purchased and submitted only online from 22.05.2026, 10:30 am to 05.06.2026, 05:30 pm.
- Sagar Municipal Corporation, reserves all the rights to accept/reject any/all bid(s) without assigning any reason thereof.

Sd/-
Commissioner
Municipal Corporation Sagar
District Sagar (M.P.)

कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, संभाग-भरतपुर

क्रमांक: एस.सी./बी.टी.पी./निविदा/2026-27/बी-386 दिनांक 19/5/26

अत्युत्कृष्ट निविदा सूचना संख्या: 02/2026-27

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से भरतपुर संभाग के अंतिम जिला धौलपुर में कुल 01 सबक निर्माण कार्य के लिए उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार/केन्द्रीय सरकार के अधिकृत संवेदकों/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/डाक एवं दूर संचार विभाग/रेलवे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राज्यपाल सरकार के विभिन्न सचम श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हो, से निविदा प्रपत्र में ई-प्रोसेसिंग प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑनलाइन अत्युत्कृष्ट निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

निविदा एवं सम्बंधित विवरण वेबसाइट "www.eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in" एवं "www.sppp.raj.nic.in" पर देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाइट "www.eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in" पर रजिस्टर करवाना आवश्यक है।

NIB No. - PWD2627A0620

UDN No. PWD 2627WSOB02807

हस्ता/-
अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता
सार्वजनिक निर्माण भरतपुर

DIPR/C/8965/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) (1) Mr. Manish Kumar S/o Sh. Rajkumar R/o RZD-123, Vaishali, Dwarika, Delhi also at A-1 & 2, 3rd Floor, Chanakya Place, New Delhi and Plot No. 68, Sec-19, Dwarika also at H. No. 240, Dwarika Sec-19, Delhi also at H. No. 240, Dwarika Sec-6, Delhi and (2) Mr. Rakesh Kumar S/o Balwant Singh R/o H. No. 240, Sec-19 Dwarika, Delhi Also at H. No. 122, Pocket B-3, Sec-17, Dwarika Delhi also at Plot No. 68, Sec-19, Dwarika, Delhi Also at Flat No. 39A, DDA Flat, Sec 10 Dwarika, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 04/25, U/s 406/420/467/468/471/120B IPC, Date 16.01.2025, PS EOW Mandir Marg, New Delhi and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) (1) Mr. Manish Kumar, (2) Mr. Rakesh Kumar can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) (1) Mr. Manish Kumar, (2) Mr. Rakesh Kumar has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) (1) Mr. Manish Kumar, (2) Mr. Rakesh Kumar of case FIR No. 04/25, U/s 406/420/467/468/471/120B IPC, Date 16.01.2025, PS EOW Mandir Marg, New Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated 13.07.2026.

By Order
Sh. Mridul Gupta
Ld. Chief Judicial Magistrate
26, G.F. Annexo Building
Patiala House Courts, New Delhi

DP/6112/EOW/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	18250163	RATE CONTRACT FOR SUPPLY OF PRE-PRINTED CONTINUOUS (PERFORATED) COMPUTERIZED PARCEL WAY BILL	18404 REAM	12-06-26
02	10260022A	SUPERIOR QUALITY PILLOW	114966 NOS	15-06-26
03	18251272A	RATE CONTRACT FOR SUPPLY OF PRE-PRINTED CONTINUOUS (PERFORATED) COMPUTERIZED GATE PASS	16268 REAM	15-06-26
04	12261133	SINGLE CORE ELASTOMERIC CABLE SIZE 300 SQ MM	3990 MTR	15-06-26
05	08255576A	TRANSRECEIVER VHF RADIO 25 WATT	589 NOS	19-06-26
06	07261324	CUSHION FOR TRANSVERSE SEAT FOR GS COACH	9746 NOS	20-06-26

NOTE -1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained.

Tender Notice No. 14/2026-2027 Dated : 22.05.2026 1744/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Rajasthan State Hotels Corporation Ltd.
(A Govt. of Rajasthan Undertaking) Hotel These Kothi, M.J.Road, Jaipur
Tel. No. 0141-2372118, Email:-csd.rshc@rajjasthan.gov.in

No. :- F-21/Accnts./Bid/RSHCL/2026/142 - 46 Date :- 19/05/2026

E-BID NOTICE

E-Bids are invited up to 08.06.2026 from the eligible bidders for the procurement of various category of Human Resource services for the Hotels of Rajasthan State Hotels Corporation Limited (RSCL) for the period of one year. Detailed bid document can be downloaded from web site www.sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in and www.eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in.

UBN No. : CSH2627SLOB00019
Raj.Samwad/C/26/3358 **Executive Director (F&A)**

Classifieds

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that the original Sale Deed of House No. D-8, Meenakshipuram Colony, Revenue Village Kaseru, Buxar, executed by Mr. Bijendra Kumar Gupta in favour of Captain B.K. Bakshi vide Document No. 3326, Book No. 1, Volume No. 3830, registered on 12.05.1989, has been lost/misplaced in Delhi on 20.05.2026. A report regarding the loss has been lodged at P.S. Mandawali, Delhi vide LR No. 320741/2026 dated 22.05.2026. Any person having any claim, objection, or interest in respect of the said document/property may contact the undersigned within 15 days from publication of this notice, failing which it shall be presumed that no objection exists. The public is cautioned not to deal with the said lost document. If found, kindly return the same to the undersigned.

GOPAL BIHARI (Advocate)
SP-51, Panday Nagar
Delhi-110092

Telangana Renewable Energy Development Corporation Ltd. (TGREDCO)
(A State Government Company)
D No: 6-2-910, 2nd Floor, The Institution of Engineers (India) Building, Viveswara Bhavan, Khairatabad, Hyderabad - 500 004 TG INDIA
TEL: +91-40-2320 1502 / 03, FAX: +91-40-2320 1504 www.tgreco.telangana.gov.in
Mail: info@tgreco.telangana.gov.in, kusum@tgreco.telangana.gov.in

Online tenders are hereby invited from interested and eligible bidders for Design, Supply, Installation, Testing, commissioning of ground mounted Solar Power Plants with Remote Monitoring System with comprehensive warranty, guarantee for 5 years and Operation and Maintenance of the complete plant for 5 years from commissioning date with a cumulative capacity of 19 MW at 18 Sub-Stations located across 9 erstwhile districts in Telangana State through Rate Contract CAPEX Mode". Interested bidders can download the bids online from 22.05.2026 and submit the same, from 27.05.2026 to 10.06.2026 till 03:00PM through <https://www.tender.telangana.gov.in> For further details, please visit our website: <https://tgreco.telangana.gov.in>.
Date: 22.05.2026 Sd/-VC & MD, TGREDCO
DIPR R.O.No.161-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27, Dt: 22-05-2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Etesh Chawla**, S/o Vijay Kumar Chawla, R/o 1) H.No. 7717B, Moti Nagar, Delhi, 2) 7/27B, 2nd Floor, Moti Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 450/2022, U/s 498A/406 IPC, P.S. Rajouri Garden, New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Etesh Chawla** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Etesh Chawla** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Etesh Chawla** accused of FIR No. 450/2022, U/s 498A/406 IPC, P.S. Rajouri Garden, New Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 30.06.2026.

By Order - Ms. Chhavi Bansal
Judicial Magistrate First Class, West District
Mahila Court-04, Room No. 252
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/6677/WD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused namely: **Veena**, W/o. Sh. Naresh, R/o: H.No.C-81, Yadav Nagar, Samaypur, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide FIR No.151/2021 U/s 135 Electricity Act registered at P.S. Samaypur Badli, Outer North District, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said accused **Veena** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Veena** is absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Veena**, accused of FIR No. 151/2021 U/s 135 Electricity Act, P.S. Samaypur Badli, Outer North District, Delhi is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before 03.07.2026.

By Order, Sh. Prashant Kumar
Additional Sessions Judge (Electricity)
North West District, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/6689/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY
NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION

Senior

‘They were thrown out in the dark, now they will be brought back in broad daylight’

Centre tells SC it will bring back some of those deported to Bangladesh and determine their citizenship status here

Ravik Bhattacharya & Ananthakrishnan G
Kolkata, New Delhi, May 22

A LOT has changed in West Bengal since the summer of last year, including a contentious Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls that has spilled over into tribunal hearings, and the voting in of a government that has promised to go after “infiltrators”. Sweety Bibi has been watching, from afar.

She was deported as a Bangladeshi on June 26, 2025. On Friday, a relative called up to tell her what she had been awaiting for nearly a year – that the Centre had told the Supreme Court that it would bring back some of those deported to Bangladesh, and determine their citizenship status here; that it meant that she and her two children, 6 and 16, may finally return home to Dhitora village in Birbhum.

Breaking down while speaking to *The Indian Express* over the phone from Chapainawabganj, Bangladesh, over 220 km from Birbhum, Sweety said: “I had lost hope for myself and

my children... Finally the highest court of the country has delivered justice. Now all I want to do is to get back home safely.”

Appearing for the Centre before the Supreme Court Friday, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta told a three-judge Bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant: “My instructions are, the Government will bring them back, and thereafter will examine their status, and depending on the outcome, will take steps accordingly.” Mehta also urged the Bench to record that this step was being taken as regards this particular case and should not be treated as a precedent.

The Bench was hearing an appeal filed by the Centre challenging a Calcutta High Court order of September 27 last year asking it to bring back some persons deported to Bangladesh as the due process appeared to have not been followed in their case. The High Court passed the order on a habeas corpus petition by Bhodu Sheikh, whose daughter Sunali Khatoon and her family were deported along with Sweety Bibi and her family, after being



Sweety Bibi was deported to Bangladesh on June 26, 2025

picked up from Delhi, where they were working as daily wagers.

Sunali, who was pregnant then and has since delivered a boy, was brought back earlier in December to Paikar village, also in Birbhum, along with a minor son, 8, on humanitarian grounds. Her husband Danish continues to be in Bangladesh, and is expected to come back now along with Sweety Bibi.

At Friday’s hearing, Justice Kant sought to know how long

it would take for those deported to be brought back. The SG said it usually took 8-10 days and urged the Court to post the matter for further hearing after the summer recess starting June.

“I am physically and mentally sick,” said Sweety. “I am at the mercy of the kindness of a family here. They have been taking care of us. But how many days could this continue? I have not met my daughter who is in Birbhum for nearly a year.”

Danish spoke of the days spent lonely since Sunali and his son left. “I will finally meet my wife and my newborn.”

Faruk Hussain, whose family took in the deportees after they were released on bail by the Bangladeshi authorities, told *The Indian Express*: “We did what we could to help them. The court gave us their responsibility. Since then they have stayed at our house. Every day Sweety and her children would cry, they were broken. Danish too had lost hope... Today is a happy day for all of us.”

Recalling how they reached

Hussain’s house, Sweety said: “We were pushed out through the Assam border. For some time, we hid in the bushes along the border and tried to return, but failed. Then we spent days on the streets of Dhaka, before finally going to a relative’s house in Chapainawabganj. We were arrested from there.”

Police in Chapainawabganj booked them under the Passport Act and Foreigners’ Act in August last year. On October 3, the senior judicial magistrate of the District Court in Chapainawabganj, Bangladesh, declared both Sweety and Sunali’s families as Indian citizens based on their Aadhaar cards and residential addresses in West Bengal, ordering their “pushback” to India.

The families were released on bail on December 1.

Meanwhile, in the SIR exercise ongoing in Bengal, Sunali’s father made it to the voter list, while Sweety’s mother’s case is being heard by the tribunals.

Sweety’s brother Amir Khan, speaking on the phone from their home in Birbhum,

said: “We are grateful to everyone who helped. Her 10-year-old waits for her. Our family will be reunited.”

Trinamool Congress Rajya Sabha MP Samirul Islam, former chairman of the state’s migrants’ welfare board who helped Sweety’s and Sunali’s families, shared the news that they may all be back on his X account. “I hail the Indian judiciary, and we have full faith in our Judicial System,” Islam posted, while calling the government’s changed stand in the Court “a significant reaffirmation of constitutional accountability and the rule of law”.

Describing their deportation as “illegal pushback of Bengali-speaking persons”, the MP said: “Now, it is the turn of Sunali’s husband, as well as Sweety Bibi and her two minor sons, to return to their homeland.”

Mofizul Islam, a Birbhum-based social worker who has been helping Sweety and Sunali’s families said: “They were thrown out in the dark, but now they will be brought back in broad daylight.”

SC: Should those who moved up due to reservation continue to avail it?

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 22

HEARING A plea on the question of creamy layer for the purpose of quota, the Supreme Court on Friday again asked why children of those who had already scaled the economic and social ladder by availing the benefits of affirmative action should continue to claim reservation.

“If both parents are IAS officers, why should they have reservations? With education and economic empowerment, there is social mobility. So then again to seek reservation for the children, we will never get out of it,” Justice B V Nagarathna, presiding over a two-judge bench, said. The judge said that those who had prospered should opt out. “That is a matter we have to be concerned about. Also, what is the use then? You are giving reservation. The parents have studied, they are in good jobs, they are getting good income, and the children want reservation again. See, they should get out of reservation”.

The bench, also comprising Justice Ujjal Bhuyan, was hearing an appeal against a Karnataka High Court judgment which had upheld the exclusion of the appellant Raghavendra Fakeerappa Chandranavar from reservation saying he fell in the creamy layer as both his parents were state government staff.

Though he belonged to the backward class Kuruba community, the District Caste and Income Verification Committee refused to issue him a caste validity certificate after his family income was assessed at more than Rs 19.48 lakh annually – more than the threshold prescribed for creamy layer.

Appearing for the appellant, Advocate Shashank Ratnoo contended that for government servants, the creamy layer depends on the status of the parents, whether they belong to Group A

or Group B services, and not just the salary income.

Treating salary alone as the criteria would keep many low-ranking government employees out of the reservation net, he said.

But Justice Nagarathna pointed out that social mobility also comes with a rise in economic status.

She said, “There has to be some balance. Socially and educationally backward, yes, but once the parents have attained a level because of taking advantage of reservation, if they are both IAS officers, both are in government service, they are very well placed. Social mobility is there. Now they are questioning the exclusion. This also has to be kept in mind.” The court issued notice on the matter.

Ex-CJIB R Gavai, too, had expressed similar views wondering how his own children or those of an IAS officer can be compared with the less privileged among the backward classes. In a 6:1 ruling, an SC bench headed by the then CJ D Y Chandrachud, had, on August 1, 2024, held that Scheduled Castes can be sub-classified for the purpose of providing reservation to the less-privileged among them.

Justice Gavai (who subsequently went on to become the CJI), who was part of the bench, also ruled that creamy layer among SCs be kept out of reservation benefits.

Justice Gavai said in his ruling that “categories in the Presidential List who have already enjoyed a major chunk of reservation should not object to the State providing a special treatment to those who have been deprived of such a benefit and particularly when such a benefit is not being taken away from them. Only part of that benefit is being reserved for percolating the same to the more disadvantaged and less represented”.

of the Vejalpur police on Wednesday morning. The family has alleged that police assaulted him and gave him some pills, which led to the death.

The family has refused to accept the body until an FIR is registered against three policemen allegedly involved in the assault.

Shaikh suffered from severe diabetes, and had high blood pressure and cholesterol, a lawyer for the family said.

Police said preliminary findings of a forensic examination suggest death was caused by an overdose of prescription medical drugs.

Shaikh was arrested on May 16 after Vejalpur police re-

A fallout of Manipur’s hostage crisis: Stranded trucks, shrinking supplies

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, May 22

WITH SECURITY forces unable to find six Naga men nine days after they went missing, and 14 Kuki men still being held hostage, Manipur continues to remain on edge. Highway blockades have meant hundreds of trucks are stranded, paralysing everyday life.

Following the killing of three church leaders, tensions erupted between Manipur’s Kuki and Naga communities and dozens of villagers from both sides were abducted and held captive in Kuki-Zo-majority Kangpokpi district and Naga-majority Senapati district on May 13. After a day-long stand-off, both sides released 14 individuals each.

However, Naga groups in Senapati continue to hold on to 14 captives, demanding the release of six people who they claim were abducted by Kuki groups and are still missing. Kuki groups maintain they have released all hostages.

Nine days later, despite search operations undertaken by joint security forces in the hill ranges of Kangpokpi and neighbouring areas, the six men have not been located.

Meanwhile, the Kuki Inpi Manipur has maintained a shutdown across the state’s Kuki-zo majority districts, while the United Naga Council



Women take part in a protest rally demanding the safe release of six missing Naga civilians. PT FILE

has announced an economic blockade along national highways passing through Naga areas.

Since Manipur’s geography comprises a small Meitei-majority valley surrounded by hills where different Kuki-Zo and Naga tribes live, this effectively affects all the state’s key highways. The key highways through which goods enter the state include NH-02, a transit route from Nagaland’s Dimapur, and NH-37, a transit route from Assam’s Silchar.

According to All Jiribam Road Transport Union leader L Maniton Singh, trucks on the route from Silchar through Jiribam began moving earlier this

week with security cover. However, hundreds of trucks are stranded in the Senapati district because of the NH-02 blockade.

“They are stuck at different places. There are around 200 trucks stuck between Mao, where they enter Manipur from Nagaland, and Tadubi. There are over 150 at Makhana. The highest number, over 400, is stuck in the stretch before the Kangpokpi district. It has been nine days now,” said D B Mavio, who is part of the Senapati Truck Owners’ Association. He said that most of the stranded trucks are carrying goods such as potatoes, onion and construction material.

Ladakh DGP Mukesh Singh deputed to Manipur

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 22

THE CENTRE has approved inter-cadre deputation of Ladakh police chief Mukesh Singh to Manipur, according to an official order.

Singh, a 1996-batch IPS officer of AGMUT (Arunachal Pradesh, Goa, Mizoram and Union Territories) cadre, is likely to be appointed as Manipur police chief, officials said.

Earlier this year, Singh was appointed the DGP of Ladakh.



Mukesh Singh is a 1996-batch IPS officer of AGMUT cadre

“The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet has approved the inter-cadre deputation of Singh to Manipur for a period of three years as a special case in public interest,” an order dated May 21 by the Personnel Ministry said.

Singh was earlier posted in ITBP, NIA and J&K Police. He is originally from the Jammu and Kashmir cadre, which was merged with the AGMUT cadre after the abrogation of Article 370 in 2019. Before moving to the ITBP, Singh served as the

Inspector General and later as the ADGP for the Jammu range.

The vacancy was necessitated following the appointment of Manipur DGP Rajiv Singh as Secretary (Security) in the Cabinet Secretariat. The secretary (security) is the administrative head of the Special Protection Group (SPG) that provides security to the Prime Minister and members of his immediate family residing with him at his official residence.

Family of Gujarat man accused in cow-slaughter case protests his death in police custody

Brendan Dabhi
Ahmedabad, May 22

FOR THE last three days, a group of 15-20 men have been sitting on dharna outside Vejalpur police station in Ahmedabad’s Juhapura, gathered around a banner that reads in Gujarati, “Son made a video of police brutality; the result was the death of his father”.

The father is 70-year-old Zahiruddin alias Dabbo Gya-suddin Shaikh, who has been accused in a case of cow slaughter. His photo is on the banner, and his body has been lying in the mortuary of SVP Hospital about 5 km away.

Shaikh died in the custody

covered 520 kg of alleged cow meat and a live white calf on May 5. Nine individuals were arrested, and police accused Shaikh of being the leader of the alleged illegal cow slaughter ring.

According to advocate Nautman Ghanchi, who represents the accused, as well as Shaikh’s son Taufiq, Shaikh died in hospital around 8 am on May 20. Taufiq Shaikh has alleged that police brutality led to the death.

ACPA B Valand of ‘M’ Division of the Ahmedabad Police, whose jurisdiction includes Vejalpur, said, “The main allegations of the petitioner (Taufiq) are that the police assaulted his father and gave him some pills.

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Protest outside Vejalpur police station in Ahmedabad’s Juhapura. BHUPENDRA RANA

...The inquest panchnama of the body was carried out in the presence of a Sub Divisional Magistrate with videography, which shows zero injuries on the body of the deceased.”

“Secondly”, Valand said, “we have a report from the hospital where, when the doctor asked Zahiruddin Shaikh about his medical history, he said that he had consumed 90 tablets of his own accord.”

A 14-second video, allegedly made by Taufiq, purportedly shows Zahiruddin Shaikh on a stretcher, saying that his beard was pulled and that he was kicked in his private parts while in custody.

Valand said, “We have asked

Army cuts by half retired Colonel’s pension for acts of ‘grave misconduct’

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, May 22

IN A rare disciplinary action, the Army has cut by half the pension of a retired Colonel for allegedly engaging in multiple acts of “grave misconduct”.

The cut in pension of Colonel Amit Kumar (retd), with effect from April 2026, was preceded by a show cause notice issued to him in August 2025, *The Indian Express* has learnt. Brigadier Sumeet Kohli, Brigadier Officers Record Office (ORO), acting on behalf of the Adjutant General, had issued the show cause notice to Col Kumar, a former officer of the Judge Advocate General’s (JAG) Branch, who practices law after taking premature retirement from the Army.

Col Kumar has been raising the issue of alleged injustice to his wife, also a Colonel in the JAG Branch, who is facing disciplinary action and has raised serious allegations against senior Army officers.

The notice cited “threatening behaviour, unlawful entry into court of inquiry proceedings, defamatory public commentary against senior military officers and Army security protocols” as some of the reasons for taking action against the Colonel. The notice was issued under Para 9(b)(i) and 9(b)(ii) read with Para 26 of the Pension Regulations for the Army, 2008. The relevant paras deal with the Army’s right to withhold, suspend or discontinue pension.

The show cause notice cites two separate FIRs as key grounds for the action.

While the first FIR was registered on September 12, 2024 at Ambala Cantonment police



Colonel Amit Kumar (retired)

station, the second FIR was lodged on July 10, 2024 at Dharmsalala police station, Himachal Pradesh.

In his reply, Col Kumar submitted that the notice relied on unverified allegations and pending judicial proceedings and misinterprets Pension Regulations 2008 by bypassing mandatory checks. He added that it appears to support certain senior officers involved in “organised misconduct”, against whom complaints are already pending before the Punjab and Haryana HC and the District Court, Ambala.

“While custodial torture against my wife remains uninvestigated despite multiple complaints. Instead of addressing gross misconduct by senior officers, the Adjutant General’s Branch appears to be misusing its subordinate branches to suppress evidence and intimidate complainants,” Col Kumar submitted.

Efforts were made to elicit comments from HQs Western Command on the issue but no reply was received from them despite repeated reminders.

Chargesheet in TCS sexual harassment case submitted

Mohamed Thaver
Mumbai, May 22

THE NASHIK City police Friday submitted a 1,500-page chargesheet in the first of the nine FIRs that were registered by them in connection with the TCS sexual harassment and hurting religious sentiments case. The chargesheet was filed against Danish Ijaz Sheikh, Tausif Bilal Attar, Nida Ejaz Khan and Matin Majeed Patel in the first FIR registered at the Deolali camp police station on March 26 which eventually led to eight more FIRs being registered.

Patel, an AIMIM corporator from Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar, had been booked for allegedly giving Nida shelter when she was on the run.

As compared to the FIR where sections of rape and sexual harassment were invoked, in the chargesheet filed after police investigation, they have added Section 68 that deals with sexual intercourse by a person in authority as the accused was the victim’s senior. Section 46 that deals with abetment, 318(4) that deals with cheating and dishonestly including delivery of property for obtaining documents from the victim using which her name was to be changed.

Further, in case of Mateen, the police have added section 238 that deals with causing disappearance of evidence or giv-

ing false information to screen offenders and 249 that deals with harbouring offenders. “This chargesheet does not deal with much evidence against Mateen and we will be adding that in a supplementary chargesheet,” an official said. The police have also retained sections of the Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act.

As evidence, the chargesheet has contained statements of 17 witnesses under Section 183 of the Indian Civil Security Code (BNSS) which means their statements were recorded before a Magistrate and has a higher evidentiary value.

In addition to this, other evidence attached in the chargesheet includes medical examination reports of the victim and the accused, evidence that the victim was forcibly converted and religious sentiments were hurt, screenshots of the victim’s and the accused’s mobile phones, WhatsApp chats and seized email trails, police said.

Although a chargesheet has been filed in the court based on the evidence received during the investigation of the registered crimes, the investigation into the said crime will continue and after obtaining more evidence, a further charge sheet will be filed in the case.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Degree or no degree, let the cockroach be

EVER SINCE Chief Justice of India Surya Kant compared unemployed youth drifting into journalism and activism with parasites and cockroaches, his remarks have invited questions about the problematic language of dehumanisation and sparked a spiralling controversy. His subsequent clarification that he had specifically meant those who enter the legal profession, media and social media with “fake and bogus degrees” did not clear the impression of a repressive scolding not in keeping with the grace and generosity that remains the hallmark of his high office. The CJI’s remarks also contributed to an internet phenomenon, the formation, tongue firmly in cheek, of a meme party, the Cockroach Janta Party. That the X handle of the satirical collective has now been withheld, following a direction of the Centre, after inputs from the Intelligence Bureau, and that the government is now invoking national security, best makes the case that the CJI’s criticism was misdirected in the political context it comes in. The blocking of the CJP’s account points to where the real problem lies — not in the restless young of this country, employed or unemployed, with or without dubious degrees. It lies, instead, in the too-frequent resort by the state, strong-armed and hard-eyed, to weaponisation of the law to quell voices of satire and humour, difference and dissent.

The humble “cockroach” is part of an expanding lexicon. Undocumented immigrants have been called “termites”, “urban Naxal” is used to tar activists and critics, “anti-national” and “traitor” have become a stick to beat the political opponent with. The overuse of these terms shrinks spaces for political engagement with all points of view that is so necessary in a robust democracy. Amid this slide, however, the institution of the judiciary, and especially the Supreme Court of India, is — and it must be — the space where individual freedoms and liberties are restored and protected. The SC is, after all, the custodian of the constitutional guarantees for individual rights, including the right to free speech.

In recent times, South Asia has seen the sudden, and even violent, outbreak of movements led by Gen Z that have unseated governments, fuelled by disillusion and discontents over dwindling jobs, rising prices and corruption and inequalities. When the CJI speaks about youth who “attack the system”, he overlooks a crucial Made in India difference and USP: The young have often, from the JP upsurge of the 1970s to the Anna Hazare mobilisation more recently, participated in and led movements against corruption, for reform. But India’s democratic framework has proved itself to be capacious, and its young have taken a position inside it, as part of it, not outside of it. This is why the CJI’s comments are even more dispiriting. This is why he must, with due respect, reconsider their framing. As for the mandarins in the Intelligence Bureau who cited national security to get the account blocked, surely they know that cockroaches are hard to exterminate — as is the instinct to poke fun at power and hold it to account in a democracy.

Putin, Xi, and a growing asymmetry

LESS THAN a week after Xi Jinping hosted Donald Trump, Vladimir Putin arrived in Beijing for what was his 25th official visit in the 25th year since the signing of the Sino-Russian Treaty of Friendship. The summit celebrated a relationship with a long and turbulent past. Tsarist Russia was among the great predators of Imperial China’s “century of humiliation”. The Soviet Union became China’s patron after the 1949 communist revolution, only for the relationship to fracture in the Sino-Soviet split, leading Beijing to tilt towards Washington. Post-Cold War rapprochement occurred slowly, before deepening into a partnership that Xi and Putin have since elevated into one of “no limits”.

But cracks are bound to surface. China is a rising power, while Russia is not just in decline but also dependent on China. Xi holds significant leverage due to this asymmetry, visible nowhere more clearly than in Putin’s failure this week to secure a long-sought contract for a pipeline that would double Russian natural gas exports to China. The reality is that Putin needs Xi far more than the other way around, and unless Russia decides to enter into some form of reconciliation with the West, something Trump has expressed optimism about, Moscow’s dependence will deepen.

India has long bet on Russia. The military defeat to China in 1962 was a major driver of New Delhi’s tilt towards Moscow, as the US chose Pakistan as its frontline Cold War partner. The US-China rapprochement compounded India’s fears. But things are different now. A weaker Russia, a stronger China, and a mercurial US president wooing both should push India to strengthen its own capabilities. Cooperation with the US in technology and AI is a strategic necessity and India must build on that even as Russia remains a source of energy. As for China, India needs to manage a long border and a massive trade deficit. Alliances cannot substitute for the hard work of domestic reform and modernisation.

Together & apart, animals in human world

WHEN THE humans are away, the wolves, moose and bobcats will play. This much became clear during the Covid pandemic when lockdown measures across the world ensured *Homo sapiens*-free landscapes for other species to saunter through. Not only was the air cleaner and every outdoor space quieter, wild boars reportedly strolled through the boulevards of Barcelona in Spain. Nature, as the popular pandemic-era meme went, was healing.

A new study published in *Science* has now demonstrated just how much nature — or rather, wildlife — shapes itself around the presence (or absence) of humans. Using GPS tracking data from 37 species of wild birds and mammals along with cellphone location data across the US, a group of researchers has found that how these species use geographic spaces often depends on human activity in those same areas. The findings show a remarkable diversity of responses. For example, the areas covered by coyotes and wild turkeys shrank in response to human proximity while among grey wolves, the presence of people had the opposite effect of expanding their ranges — in all likelihood to put a greater distance between themselves and humans.

For ecologists, findings like this are invaluable, helping craft a more granular approach to complex questions of conservation and minimising animal-human conflicts. They’re a warning too, against the simplistic “we are the virus” takes — suggesting that eliminating humans will save the planet — that also, not coincidentally, surged in popularity during the pandemic. Healing nature and protecting biodiversity is long-haul work built on the painstaking accumulation of knowledge — not glib formulations.

Today, India and US interests are not easily aligned. Let’s confront this

AS UNITED States Secretary of State Marco Rubio begins an important visit, India needs to confront hard truths about the Indo-US relationship. Of late, India, like much of the world, gives the striking impression of a deer being caught in the headlights. The US is not just untrustworthy, it is currently the biggest wrecking ball to hit global stability. But dependence on China carries its own discomfort. There are no effective alternative coalitions yet to counteract these powers. Many of India’s wounds, however, are self-inflicted. India will have to wean itself away from its own delusions.

First, any dealings with the US have to account for not just bilateral considerations or worries about China, but the entire global context. Indian foreign policy has been hugely diminished because we now operate on the assumption that we should focus on our interests, narrowly understood, even if the world be damned. India is not uniquely at fault. But the idea that bilateral wins or very short-term tactical considerations alone can create the space for India’s rise is myopic. Given India’s history, it is absolutely astonishing that it is the one country that, in the international system is, for all practical purposes, condoning not one but two imperial projects. India was tepid in its defence of international law when Russia invaded Ukraine. Its near silence, and the open and practical embrace of Israel and the US’s strategic objectives on Iran, is damning. India talks the language of civilisation, sovereignty and multipolarity, but

is increasingly comfortable with imperial coercion. But these imperial projects directly harm India’s material interests as well. As we have belatedly acknowledged, the war in Iran will do more material damage to our economy than any adversary could. We have to return to thinking that what is good for the world will, in the long run, be good for us as well. This requires recognising the US, in the current form, for what it is — an imperial power unleashing a new and dangerous nihilism in the world order. It’s not a saviour, it is a threat.

It is often said that the US cannot deal with countries that are not allies, while India has tried to maintain strategic autonomy. But the present moment far supersedes this framing in two ways. The first is that the US betrays its allies and reduces them to a state of abject dependence. But India’s case is peculiar. Over the last couple of years, it has become entirely apparent that in India, the US has managed to achieve something more than an alliance. In superficial terms, India exercises the rituals of strategic autonomy. It purchases Russian oil, it is trying to achieve trade diversification, and it will even cast an occasional inconvenient vote at multilateral forums.

Yet beyond these gestures, something deeper has shifted. Significant sections of India’s foreign policy establishment, if not public opinion, have internalised the assumption that India’s rise should be irrevocably tied to American power. This internalisation matters



PRATAP BHANU MEHTA

We have to return to thinking that what is good for the world will, in the long run, be good for us as well. This requires recognising the US, in the current form, for what it is — an imperial power unleashing a new and dangerous nihilism

A pill is not a meal, and AI is not a writer



DEVAPRIYA ROY

A FEW months ago, I had invited my friend and colleague from Computer Science, Aalok Thakkar, to speak to my graduate students about AI and its limitations in higher research. This was a writing seminar for PhD scholars across disciplines, including STEM, Sociology, Anthropology, Psychology, and English Studies. Aalok and I — despite coming from very different disciplines and vastly different levels of expertise on the subject — are often in agreement about what indiscriminate AI use can do in the university. I was, thus, excited for his talk.

Aalok opened with a little game: A series of excerpts were placed side-by-side. The audience had to detect which were AI-generated. My students were pretty darn good at this; to my dismay, I was not (The extracts were short and AI-writing is apparently more difficult to detect in shorter pieces. The longer a piece, the papering-over begins to crack visibly). I was forced to admit, yet again, that AI-writing had been getting better and better while I was going about life. So much so that now we have a controversy of the sort that was unthinkable a few years ago: A short story, one of the winners of the prestigious Commonwealth Prize this year and subsequently published by *Granta*, has been accused of being written substantially by AI.

That the judges of a literary competition might fail to detect AI-writing does not seem surprising to me. Had I not been a teacher of writing in these imperilled times when one has to engage with this issue deeply — and daily — I doubt I’d have even thought about it much. Like many of my generation, class and educational background, I would have simply gone about my own reading and writing life as I always had, at a remove from the *afra tafrî* on the ground. I also doubt my own practices of reading and writing would have changed very much — and without that change, without actively educating myself on the process, I might have been fooled too. After all, the way AI overuses metaphors and stretches every sentence out can be mistaken for a certain kind of overblown style.

To me, ultimately, this controversy seems to be focussing on the wrong end of the stick. Sure, becoming judges of literary competitions will probably now

require going through a military-style training programme — but that is, in the end, a minor irritation. There are many kinds of writers in the world and their lived realities are diverse. In my writing class, there are brilliant scientists in the making. English is a language they came to late. They use AI-assist to polish their sentences as they write academic papers. How can I refuse to understand their context-specific AI-use?

The point of literary fiction, however, is not the communication of a result. A writer uses words to make visible that which is hidden deep within, to give form to what is formless. It is a *Hunger Games* type situation. You have to do it yourself — in order to save yourself (steps include: Delete, retype, lacerate, repeat). The writer who begins a piece is not the writer who finishes the piece. And the pleasure of the process is in the blood and gore involved in this very counter-intuitive-seeming deal (Of course, writers write for lesser goals too — to win prizes, to become famous. And exactly like students who turn in papers written using AI, the cost, most of all, is to themselves).

There’s a story I share with my students every semester, drawn from *The Magic of Oz*, from L Frank Baum’s wildly successful *Oz* series. A prolific inventor, Professor Wobblebug, creates a unique pill that mitigates hunger by providing the nourishment equivalent to a meal of soup, fried fish, roast, salad and dessert. The professor is very put out when his brilliant invention does not catch on in the market. Nobody, it seems, is willing to trade up a meal with a tablet.

The point of literary fiction, in the same way, is the process. Fame, while dazzling, has very little to do with the drudgery of daily practice. Its touch is as mystical and inexplicable as the business of loving and living: It is mundane, it is sublime. To outsource the former is to give up agency upon the latter. The writer who took the shortcut, whether detected or not, failed the story they were meant to write. AI can give a hundred clever versions. But in the vastness of the universe, the chink left by the author’s specific lost story does not go unrecorded, even if the writer himself does not register its loss.

Roy is a writer and assistant professor of writing at Ashoka University, Haryana

more than formal alliances. We can see this transformation most clearly in the framing of public discourse. It is astonishing, for instance, how quickly responsibility for instability in the Strait of Hormuz is displaced onto Iran alone, while the fact that the strait is closed due to the US is underplayed. Whatever one thinks of Iran’s regime, India’s open embrace of Israel, the US, and the UAE, in a war with extraordinary second and third-order effects for global order, reflects this ideological adaptation.

Nowhere is this blindness more visible than on the issue of Pakistan. It should always have been obvious that the US could never view Pakistan solely through Indian eyes. Our illusion was exposed repeatedly, especially in the political aftermath of Operation Sindoor. The US positioned itself as the indispensable external guarantor of subcontinental stability. India may reject the language of mediation publicly. But America rarely relinquishes the role of regional arbiter, and Pakistan has always been important to its imperial interests. Our interests will not align with America in the Subcontinent, so we have to find a way of dealing with it on our own terms. Another illusion that has been shattered is the idea that India will be indispensable to US strategy in Asia; the truth is, it is quite dispensable.

A deepening of the economic relationship with the US would be beneficial. However, the punitive

● **WORDLY WISE**
Leadership is not about the next election, it’s about the next generation. — *Simon Sinek*

tariffs imposed on India were not just about industrial policy, but about showing India its place. The US Supreme Court invalidated President Donald Trump’s tariffs, giving India a reprieve. But we should not be under any illusion about how extractive the US intends to be, and will remain so beyond Trump. Again, India could benefit from a deeper alignment with the US’s technology. But India should be well aware of the hubris the US brings to the table. It is convinced that India is far behind in technology and that China is not a serious technology option for India. So, it will come begging to the table. There is no easy short-term answer to this conundrum. But we have to resist the defeatism of the pro-America lobby in this regime, which throws in the towel whenever America is in question. It is also ironic that the US will measure success in this trip by how much Indian investment can get to the United States. Again, our political economy and the strategies of the Ambani and Adani groups make us vulnerable. At their best, India and the US’s affinity still lay in the fact that both aspired to be open and free societies. What ties the regimes now is a comfort with evil and transactionalism. But even in this moment of darkness, India needs to confront its own abjectness and give up its delusions about America and itself. Our interests are not as easily aligned. Let us start by confronting this truth.

The writer is contributing editor, The Indian Express

Bihar’s urban pivot — a necessity and a challenge



AVIRAL PANDEY

FOR DECADES, Bihar’s labour powered the farms of Punjab, factories of Gujarat, staffed the construction sites of Delhi, and sustained the informal economies of India’s largest cities, even as the state itself remained overwhelmingly rural and economically stagnant. Bihar remains India’s least urbanised major state, with barely 11-12 per cent of its population living in urban areas, compared to the national average of over 31 per cent. Now, Bihar appears ready to attempt something fundamentally different.

The cabinet’s recent approval of a \$500 million World Bank-supported Bihar Urban Transformation Programme, including 11 proposed greenfield satellite townships, marks perhaps the state’s most serious attempt at planned urbanisation. Colonial economic structures reduced Bihar to a supplier of agricultural output and migrant labour, while industrial investments concentrated around port economies such as Bombay and Calcutta. The bifurcation of Bihar further weakened its economic foundations by transferring most mineral-rich and industrial regions to Jharkhand. Bihar’s urban challenge cannot be understood merely as an infrastructure deficit. Its towns never evolved into productive centres capable of absorbing labour, attracting investment, and generating large-scale non-farm employment. The proposed satellite townships are intended to address this structural gap.

If implemented intelligently, planned urbanisation could help Bihar avoid the disorderly expansion that has overwhelmed many Indian cities. Bihar instead requires a network of regional growth centres linked to agro-processing, logistics, manufacturing, healthcare, and education. The expansion of the Patna Metro, Ganga Path, new Ganga bridges, freight-corridor connectivity, and the emergence of Darbhanga as an aviation hub suggest that Bihar’s infrastructure geography is gradually beginning to change. But infrastructure alone cannot guarantee successful urbanisation. The government’s decision to experiment with land-pooling mechanisms rather than aggressive land acquisition is also notable. A transparent land-pooling framework, if implemented credibly, could reduce conflict while making landowners stakeholders in urban expansion.

Three structural constraints remain especially serious. The first is land governance. Without transparent digital land records and credible planning institutions, even well-intentioned urban expansion could generate conflict and uncertainty. The second is environmental vulnerability. Large parts of north Bihar remain chronically flood-prone due to river systems such as the Kosi, Gandak, and Bagmati. Climate resilience cannot remain an afterthought. The third is institutional capacity. Municipal revenues in Bihar remain among the weakest in India, limiting planning capacity and urban service delivery.

Bihar’s future is unlikely to emerge from replicating the service-led urbanism of Mumbai or Bengaluru. Its more realistic pathway lies in agro-industrial urbanisation. The experience of states such as Tamil Nadu shows that dispersed urbanisation through multiple regional growth centres can often generate more balanced development than a single megacity.

Bihar’s urban experiment is therefore more than an infrastructure initiative. It is a test of whether India’s growth story can extend beyond its established metropolitan centres.

The writer teaches at Patna University

40 YEARS AGO

May 23, 1986



Nine terrorists held

THE POLICE caught nine suspected terrorists in Ferozepur and Jalandhar districts, as the death toll in the shootout at Amritsar mounted to 11 with two more succumbing to their injuries. In one of the worst killing sprees of its kind in the state, 18 persons had come under a hail of bullets fired from six Sten guns and revolvers wielded by terrorists, who reportedly came to the ill-fated locality on foot and escaped in a jeep.

Centre alarmed at killings

THE KILLINGS in Amritsar and the resultant panic among the minority community

have alarmed the central government. Arun Nehru, Minister of State for Internal Security, had a series of meetings with senior officials of the Home Ministry and intelligence agencies to review the situation and suggest steps to the Punjab government to control it. The Prime Minister has called for a meeting with his advisors including the Home Minister.

PM says SWAPO victory certain

THE PRIME Minister, Rajiv Gandhi, described the latest bombing of three southern African frontline states by the South African Government as “an extension of the dogma of racist arrogance”. Speaking at a banquet hosted by him in honour of

the visiting president of the South West African People’s Organisation (SWAPO), Sam Nujoma, the Prime Minister said that “a common thread of evil” ran through apartheid in South Africa, colonialism in Namibia, the occupation of parts of Angola and the “brutal state terrorism of Pretoria”.

Sri Lanka continues bombing

EIGHT PERSONS, including a one-year-old girl, were killed when the Sri Lankan air force strafed and bombed two villages in Jaffna peninsula as Tamil militants resisted attempts by a large number of troops to link up with their colleagues at Point Pedro on the northern coast.



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● **WHAT THE OTHERS SAY**
The rising number of grisly murders across Bangladesh is indeed creating a growing sense of fear and insecurity among citizens. — *The Daily Star*

We need to speed up economic reform, but pessimism obscures, doesn't illuminate



V ANANTHA NAGESWARAN

SURJIT BHALLA is one of India's most independent economic voices, and his pieces in *The Indian Express* are not to be dismissed with the customary official reflex of pointing to infrastructure spending and sunrise sectors. He asks hard questions, and hard questions deserve hard answers. This one ("The BJP is winning the election, but it's losing the economy", IE, May 20), however, contains enough analytical ambiguity to warrant careful examination before one arrives at whatever genuine policy concern remains.

Begin with the most arresting claim: India risks joining Turkey as a residual "Fragile Two." The original "Fragile Five" designation — coined by Morgan Stanley in 2013 — had a specific, operationalisable content: Large current account deficits, fiscal imbalances, and acute vulnerability to Federal Reserve tapering. India's macroeconomic architecture today is categorically different from 2013 on each of those dimensions: Its monetary policy framework is orthodox and inflation-targeting, its fiscal consolidation trajectory is credible, and its foreign-exchange reserves are among the largest in the world. Turkey's travails, rooted in a sustained period of deeply negative real interest rates and institutional subordination of monetary policy to political preference, belong to a different analytical category. The comparison generates a striking headline — not an illuminating analysis.

The piece is also silent on what is perhaps the single most consequential development in global capital markets since the Global Financial Crisis: The end of the era of quantitative easing and near-zero interest rates. The decade of extraordinary monetary accommodation that preceded 2022 produced an artificial compression of risk premia globally, flooding emerging markets with capital that was, in effect, seeking any yield whatsoever. UNCTAD documents that global FDI rebounded sharply to \$1.58 trillion in 2021, a 64 per cent increase over the previous year. What followed was an equally sharp reversal.



ILLUSTRATION: C.R SASIKUMAR

New investment project numbers — greenfield announcements, international project finance deals, and cross-border M&As — all shifted into decline after the first quarter of 2022, with project finance values falling more than 30 per cent as financing conditions deteriorated and interest rates rose sharply across the US, the eurozone, and — for the first time in a generation — Japan. UNCTAD's World Investment Report 2025 confirms that global FDI fell for a second consecutive year. In such an environment, virtually every emerging market has faced currency and capital flow pressures. To attribute India's investment trends primarily to domestic policy failure, while ignoring the most consequential shift in global monetary conditions in four decades, is to mistake the tide for the swimmer's effort.

On BITs, the empirical literature is far less settled than the piece implies. Bhalla treats the 2015 revision as a near-sufficient explanation for FDI trends. The academic record counsels more caution. Early papers — including Hallward-Driemeier (2003) and Tobin and Rose-Ackerman (2005) — found weak or no effects of BITs on FDI inflows. More recent work finds positive effects, but conditional on the quality of domestic institutions: BITs function as a commitment device that complements strong institutions rather than substituting for weak ones. Most pertinently, a study examining India — Singh, Shreeti, and Urdhwaresh (2022), published in the *Indian Economic*

The appropriate response to Bhalla's genuine concerns is to accelerate reform — not to dispute the imperative, but to reject the analytical scaffolding that obscures rather than illuminates it

Review — found that individual BIT signings do not influence FDI inflows; what matters is the cumulative stock of treaties, which signals an overall regime of investor protection. This finding, which the piece does not engage, considerably complicates the mono-causal story. Domestic institutional quality, regulatory predictability, and rule of law matter at least as much as treaty architecture — a conclusion that, if anything, broadens the reform agenda rather than narrowing it to a single legal instrument.

The FDI data itself tells a different story from the one the piece presents. Gross FDI inflows stood at \$88.29 billion through April-February of FY26, an 18 per cent jump over the previous year, and are on course to cross \$90 billion for the full fiscal year — well outside the \$70-80 billion range of recent years. India ranked fourth globally for greenfield project announcements in 2024, and its share of global FDI has roughly doubled over the past decade. Manufacturing FDI grew 18 per cent in FY25. These are not the indicators of investors leaving. Net FDI has been weaker, driven substantially by higher repatriation of profits and rising outward FDI as Indian companies themselves internationalise — a mark of corporate maturity, not economic distress. The piece collapses gross and net without acknowledgment, and that elision does considerable damage to the argument.

The growth ranking argument deserves similar care. Ranking India 16th in per capita GDP growth

in US dollar terms — behind Bangladesh at 8.3 percent and Ethiopia at 7.2 percent — is doing analytical work that the chosen denominator cannot support. Dollar-denominated per capita growth is a joint function of real growth and bilateral exchange rate movements. Currency appreciation or depreciation in Bangladesh or Ethiopia tells us something about their monetary and trade conditions; it does not constitute a welfare benchmark against which India's economic management should be evaluated. In purchasing power parity terms, which better captures actual improvements in living standards, India's performance across the BJP period looks materially different.

What Bhalla genuinely identifies — and what deserves acknowledgment — is that the investment climate requires continuous improvement, that the proliferation of quality control orders has at times crossed from quality assurance into protection, and that the BIT framework revision is incomplete. The government has recognised these issues. The Economic Survey and successive budgets have addressed deregulation, ease of doing business, and the need to signal regulatory predictability. The legitimate challenge is that the pace of reform must match the ambition. That is a fair demand. It is not, however, the same as the broader verdict the piece's headline announces.

None of this is to claim that the macroeconomic outlook for FY27 is without genuine difficulty. The Department of Economic Affairs's monthly economic reviews have not shied from saying so. The trade deficit will widen significantly in FY27, as will the current account deficit. Inflation risks are tilted to the upside. A below-normal monsoon adds an agricultural dimension to a complex supply shock. The task of attracting stable, long-term capital — through credible tax policy, regulatory predictability, and reduced friction for investors — intensifies in these conditions. These challenges have been acknowledged in official documents.

Elections can deliver mandates. Only policy delivers prosperity. Both propositions are true, and the government accepts both. The appropriate response to Bhalla's genuine concerns is to accelerate reform — not to dispute the imperative, but to reject the analytical scaffolding that obscures rather than illuminates it.

The writer is chief economic advisor, Government of India

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Animal slaughter ban

A SIGNIFICANT part of West Bengal's economy relies on cattle rearing ('Animal slaughter ban misreads farm economy', IE, May 22). Getting an animal certified as "fit for slaughter" is a tedious process, especially for small-scale or uneducated cattle rearers. Enforcing the Act would essentially render them helpless. While the government may seek to impose a law shaped by religious considerations, it should not come at the cost of people's livelihoods.

Abhay Negi, Dehradun

WEST BENGAL'S decision to strictly enforce the 1950 Animal Slaughter Control Act reflects a policy frozen in time ('Animal slaughter ban misreads farm economy', IE, May 22). Modern agriculture no longer depends on bullocks or manual labour, and farmers cannot afford to maintain unproductive cattle. The law's age and certification clauses make slaughter virtually impossible, forcing farmers to divert scarce fodder or abandon dairying altogether. Clinging to outdated laws undermines both livelihoods and efficiency. Governments must recognise that humane regulation and economic pragmatism can coexist.

K Chidanand Kumar, Bengaluru

Being a writer

MAITHREYI KARNNOOR articulates something many writers privately feel but rarely say aloud ('I want to daydream & write, not parade up the Instagram square', IE, May 22). The pressure to maintain a visible social media presence has redefined what it means to be a serious writer. Publishers expect it, festivals reward it, and readers increasingly confuse the performance with the work. Networking demands the very attention that writing requires. There is no easy solution, but the literary community could begin by consciously decoupling an author's platform size from assessments of their work's merit.

Swathi Senthilkumar, Coimbatore



RAM RAJYA

BY RAM MADHAV

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi's visit to the Nordic countries was marred by the unbecoming behaviour of a local journalist, Helle Lyng Svendsen. Svendsen's claims that it was a standard "confrontational" approach and the duty of a journalist representing the "freest press in the world" are laughable. Compared to Norway's less than 300 news outlets, India has more than 1.55 lakh publications, 17,000 newspapers, 900-plus satellite TV channels, of which around 400 are dedicated to news and current affairs, and more than 3,700 digital publications. This vast and varied ecosystem enjoys enormous freedom, with several organisations dedicated to criticising the government. Just as Mahatma Gandhi dismissed American journalist Katherine Mayo's negative portrayal of India in 1927 as "the report of a drain inspector", Svendsen's outbursts about the lack of media freedom and human rights in India, too, should be dismissed.

Beyond this headline-grabbing incident lies the importance of PM Modi's mission during the visit to the Nordic countries, Italy, and the Netherlands. In an article co-authored with his Italian counterpart, Giorgia Meloni, Modi highlighted the objective of his engagements

Nordic countries have investment potential running into trillions of dollars. India has engineering talent, scale, innovation and a start-up ecosystem

Alliances are key to Delhi's deep-tech ambitions

with various world powers. "Our cooperation mirrors our shared awareness," and "that prosperity and security in the 21st century will be shaped by the ability of nations to innovate, manage energy transitions, and strengthen sovereignty," they wrote. Our world is transitioning into a deep-tech order in which technologies like AI, semiconductors, biotechnology, robotics, and crypto will play a critical role. A few companies in the US and China mastering these technologies is leading to a new "tech-colonisation", posing a threat to many countries' sovereignty. Arthur Mensch, CEO of French AI firm Mistral AI, told the French national assembly recently that Europe has just two years to build an independent AI stack, failing which it will perpetually be at America's mercy.

It is this urgency that is propelling PM Modi to proactively engage with European and other powers. Under him, India has made commendable progress in digital public infrastructure. But more focus is needed on R&D and investment. India is facing headwinds in investing in the development of its AI stack and semiconductor infrastructure. The government has launched initiatives like the National AI Mission, National Quantum Mission and Anusandhan National Research Foundation. But

most are government-funded, with little interest from private investors. India's annual R&D investment is around Rs 1.25 lakh crore (roughly \$13 billion). American semiconductor giant Nvidia alone spends \$18.5 billion on annual R&D. India's capital expenditure budget for 2025-26 was around Rs 11 lakh crore, roughly \$130 billion. Alphabet CEO Sundar Pichai announced recently that his company plans \$190 billion in capital expenditure in 2026 to drive its AI infrastructure.

Nordic countries have investment potential running into trillions of dollars. India has engineering talent, scale, innovation and a start-up ecosystem. Modi is attempting to achieve "a co-creation of value where our respective industrial strengths amplify one another". He has pitched for greater investments from the Nordic countries in India's deep-tech sectors like green energy, AI, etc.

India needs such alliances to rise as a deep-tech power while safeguarding its digital sovereignty. Modi is working with that futuristic vision, something a mature leader in the Opposition, Sharad Pawar, understood when he said, "political differences should not come in the way when it comes to protecting India's prestige, and PM Modi is working to uphold the country's honour abroad".

The writer, president, India Foundation, is with the BJP

Don't brush the real Cannes story under the red carpet



GUNEET MONGA KAPOOR

THE PHOTOGRAPHS have been published. The jury decisions have been debated. The stars have flown home. And now, the real work of Cannes begins. At every corner of Cannes, there is an opportunity waiting to unfold. A single conversation with the right person can alter the course of a film's journey. From the Marché du Film to the Riviera cafés and the length of the Croisette, Cannes operates as much on chance encounters as it does on official premieres.

Having returned to Cannes year after year, I have come to believe that its most defining moments rarely happen in front of photographers. They happen in packed meeting rooms at the Marché du Film, in hotel lobbies between appointments, or over coffees that turn into collaborations months later. In 2024 alone, the market brought together nearly 14,000 film professionals from over 140 countries, producers, distributors, sales agents, streamers, and festival programmers all looking to discover films and build partnerships.

India makes more films than almost any other country, and yet our presence at markets like Cannes remains disproportionately small. The reason for this is structural.

Cannes operates on relationships built over years, on a shared vocabulary of global cinema, and on institutional support that many of our filmmakers simply do not have access to. A French filmmaker arrives with the backing of the CNC, a co-production treaty framework, and decades of cultural diplomacy behind them. A Korean filmmaker arrives backed by KOFC's aggressive international strategy and a wave of critical credibility that took 20 years to build. When an independent Indian filmmaker arrives, they often arrive alone.

This is what Cannes looks like beyond the screenings. The Producers Network brings together emerging producers from around the world for structured meetings, introductions, and conversations about how to build internationally viable careers. The Cinéfondation residency supports filmmakers in development. The co-production market connects projects seeking international partners with producers who can bring financing, expertise, and distribution access from their home territories. For many of the world's most interesting filmmakers, these are the primary reasons to be at Cannes at all.



They create relationships with sales agents and distributors who can actually get a film seen internationally. The paperwork is complicated and the conversations take time. But this is where the invisible economy lives.

Cannes is the most visible stop on a circuit that also includes Venice, Toronto, Busan, Berlin, and Sundance. Each festival has its own character, market, and relationships, and India has a presence at them all. What we lack is a strategy. For example, KOFC does not just fund Korean films. It actively markets them internationally, maintains relationships with programmers, and treats the festival circuit as an export industry.

India's institutional support for its independent cinema's international ambitions remains fragmented. There is no single body with the mandate, the budget, and the relationships to do for Indian cinema what KOFC did for Korean cinema over two decades. Building that is the work that needs to happen, not just in the years when an Indian film is in the Palme d'Or race, but every year, in the markets and meeting rooms the cameras never film.

When people ask whether Cannes is worth it, I always say the same thing: It depends entirely on what you come for. If you come for the red carpet, the return is a photograph. If you come for the market, the meetings, the relationships, the conversations that start in a lobby and find their way into a co-production agreement months later, the return can be a career.

Indian cinema has extraordinary stories to tell. We have filmmakers of remarkable vision and courage. What we need now is the infrastructure, the institutional will, and the strategic clarity to ensure those stories find a global audience. Cannes is not the answer to that. But for those willing to look past the red carpet, Cannes is one of the best places to begin.

The writer is an Academy Award-winning producer and founder, Sikhya Entertainment

Weak monsoon and fertiliser crisis, a double whammy

output had expanded for three consecutive months prior. The government has committed to absorbing the cost of guaranteeing supply, and if the Gulf conflict endures, that commitment may prove open-ended in ways the fiscal budget cannot easily accommodate. With the sowing season peaking in June, allowing farm input costs to rise visibly would risk both food price inflation and a damaging squeeze on agricultural incomes at precisely the wrong moment in the crop calendar. New Delhi's response was swift, and on April 8, the cabinet approved a roughly 12 per cent increase in the nutrient-based subsidy for the kharif 2026 season, while keeping the retail price of DAP (diammonium phosphate) flat.

India needs to source nearly four times its current urea opening stocks to meet kharif requirements, and that gap must be

bridged through imports purchased at crisis-level global prices. Each additional tonne represents a subsidy liability the exchequer bears. The subsidy mechanism, by design, converts this supply shock into a spending shock. A third of the world's fertilisers normally transit the strait, and unlike oil, there is no strategic reserve architecture or mature alternative routing. Compounding this is the monsoon outlook. On April 13, the IMD forecast below-normal rainfall for the 2026 southwest monsoon

India needs to source nearly four times its current urea opening stocks to meet kharif requirements, through imports purchased at crisis-level global prices

season at 92 per cent of the Long Period Average, the first such forecast in three years, driven primarily by the expected development of El Niño conditions between June and September. For kharif crops such as paddy, cotton, pulses, and oilseeds, the second half of the season is precisely when El Niño's effect is expected to be sharpest and when standing crops are most water-dependent. India is now navigating a fertiliser supply shock and a weakening monsoon in the same crop season.

Sustainable Development Goal 2, the UN's Zero Hunger goal, is a 2030 target the world is already struggling to meet. India's position on this goal is one of visible progress, shadowed by persistent vulnerability: It has reduced its undernourished population from 243 million in 2006 to around 172 million today, yet it still ranks 102nd out of

123 countries on the 2025 Global Hunger Index. For a country of India's scale, any season that compresses agricultural yields may not reverse the trajectory on SDG 2, but it makes the road towards sustainable development measurably harder.

Absorbing rising global fertiliser costs through the subsidy system is a well-established instrument of agricultural price stability in India, and its role in protecting farm incomes is not in dispute. The more pressing question is structural: How long can that absorption continue if the Gulf conflict persists, and what combination of supply diversification, demand-side efficiency, and domestic capacity expansion can reduce India's exposure over time?

The writer is a fellow at the Observer Research Foundation



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• POLICY

How new Odisha Bill aims to boost sustainable marine fishing

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, May 22

THE ODISHA government this week approved a proposal to enact the Odisha Marine Fishing Regulation Bill, 2026, to establish a robust, modern, and inclusive legal framework for the marine fisheries sector. The legislation will repeal a 44-year-old law. According to Odisha Chief Secretary Anu Garg, the Bill will ensure sustainable fisheries resource development clubbed with immense economic benefit, while protecting livelihood and safety of Odisha's fishermen as well as conservation of marine ecosystems.

The 1982 law

State government sources claimed that the existing Orissa Marine Fishing Regulation Act, 1982, was limited in scope and inadequate to address emerging challenges such as marine resource conservation, fishermen safety, coastal security, technological advancements, and prevention of unauthorised entry of foreign fishing vessels into India's border.

Odisha has a coastline of more than 500 km. Home to nearly 15 lakh fishermen, it ranks eighth among Indian states in terms of size of fishing communities.

The existing law only has basic provisions detailing the power to regulate, restrict, or prohibit marine fishing; licensing and registration of fishing vessels; and power to authorised officer(s) to enter and search vessels, impound such vessel(s) and seize any fish found in it.

The proposed law

The new law is to be placed before the Odisha Assembly in the forthcoming session, likely to be held in August-September. Its scope will include regulation of deep-sea fishing and the promotion of mariculture activities such as marine cage culture, seaweed culture, deployment of artificial reefs for rejuvenation of territorial waters, and many other economically viable ventures for sustainable development.

Officials said the Bill will serve as a catalyst to facilitate and scale Odisha's seafood exports up to Rs 25,000 crore by 2036 from the estimated Rs 5,000 crore a year currently.

Major global markets for such exports include China, the US, Japan, the European Union, and Gulf countries, among others.

The proposed law also paves the way for comprehensive smart green integrated infrastructure development, including the modernisation and management of fishing harbours and fish landing centres along Odisha's coast.

Coastal surveillance and national security

The legislation mandates the use of modern safety equipment and communication technologies for coastal surveillance. It also provides for mandatory biometric or QR-coded Aadhaar identification and enhanced insurance coverage for fishermen.

It provides for strict regulation of fishing vessels, fishermen, and related activities, along with provisions for licensing, fishing gear regulation, and prohibition of destructive fishing practices.

Although officials admit that illegal immigrants come via the sea route through fishing boats and settle in coastal districts like Kendrapada, Jagatsinghpur, and Bhadrak, they said the new law will check such infiltration.



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Centre	हिंदी माध्यम	English Medium
● Karol Bagh	17 मई शाम 6:00 बजे	27 May 6:00 PM
● Noida	9 जून सुबह 11:30 बजे	22 May 8:00 PM
● Indore	20 मई शाम 5:30 बजे	18 May 8:00 AM
● Lucknow	29 मई सुबह 8:00 बजे	25 May 8:00 AM
● Prayagraj	10 जून सुबह 8:00 बजे	1 June 5:30 PM
● Ranchi	9 जून शाम 5:00 बजे	29 May 2:00 PM
● Patna	21 मई शाम 5:30 बजे	25 May 8:00 AM
● Jaipur	26 मई शाम 5:00 बजे	4 June 11:00 AM

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• HEALTH

‘For Ebola, spillover risk doesn’t equal a pandemic’



EXPERT EXPLAINS

DR AMESH ADALJA

ASSISTANT PROFESSOR (ADJUNCT),
JOHNS HOPKINS BLOOMBERG SCHOOL
OF PUBLIC HEALTH

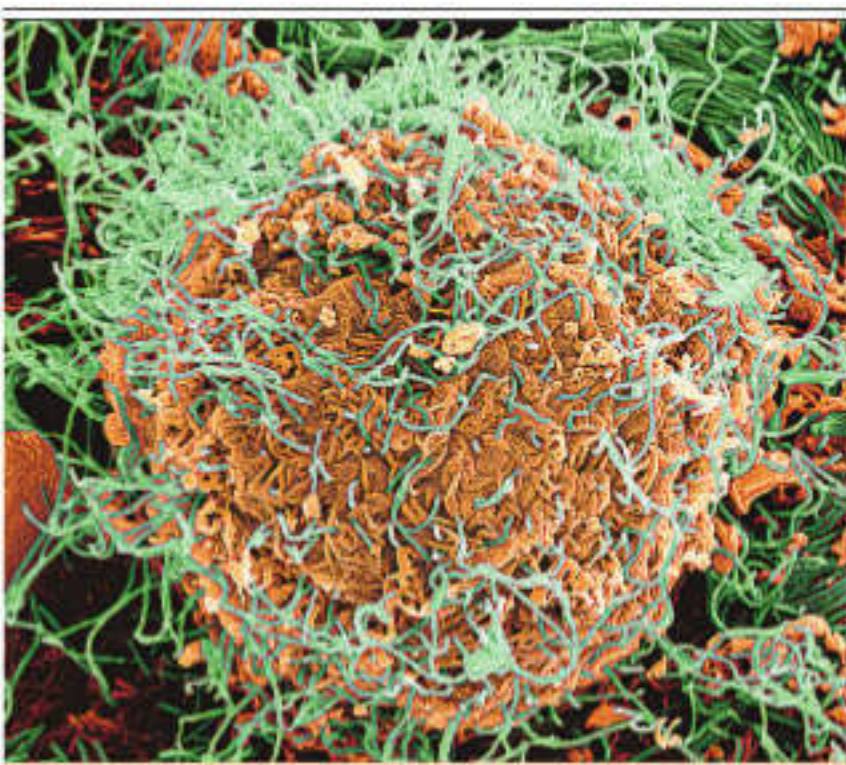
WITH THE World Health Organization (WHO) Director-General, Dr Tedros Ghebreyesus, expressing deep concern about the speed and scale of the Ebola outbreak, the Union Health Ministry has notified screening norms and vigilance at airports and ports for those travelling from or transiting through the Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC), Uganda and South Sudan.

Ebola is a zoonotic infection caused by the Orthoebolavirus family that can be extremely fatal in humans. It can spread from humans to humans through direct contact with infected fluids such as blood, saliva, sweat, tears, vomit, faeces, and breast milk among others. It can also be transmitted by touching contaminated surfaces and contact with dead bodies of those who have died of the infection. While most of the symptoms of the disease are like flu — fever, headache, muscle and joint pains — unexplained internal and external bleeding is one of the distinct features of the disease.

At the World Health Assembly in Geneva, Dr Ghebreyesus flagged how rapidly the virus had spread into major urban centres, including Kampala (Uganda) and Goma (DRC), the healthcare-associated transmission and the significant population movement across porous borders.

Most approved vaccines target the Zaire ebolavirus, not the Bundibugyo or Sudan strains. The WHO says vaccines require about 10 to 14 days to generate a complete immune response. So, those exposed just before or shortly after vaccination can still develop the disease.

Dr Amesh Adalja, however, says that “urban spread does not automatically mean sustained international spread”. A senior scholar at the Johns Hopkins Uni-



VACCINES: Two vaccines approved for use (Ervebo, Zabdeno and Mvabea) only offer protection from the Zaire strain. Vaccines for Bundibugyo still under development.

versity Center for Health Security in Baltimore (US), Adalja has been working on emerging infectious disease, pandemic preparedness and biosecurity. He spoke to Rinku Ghosh.

Ebola seems to have crossed into urban centres in Kampala this time. Will this outbreak spread beyond regional containment? What does this mean in terms of future viral spreads?

The fact that Ebola cases have occurred in urban areas like Kampala is concerning because cities increase opportunities for transmission, complicate contact tracing and place stress on healthcare systems. Urban outbreaks are harder to control than rural outbreaks but urban spread does not automatically mean sustained international spread.

Ebola transmission still depends on close contact with infected bodily fluids, contaminated materials, or unsafe healthcare and burial practices. That transmission pattern makes Ebola fundamentally different from airborne respiratory viruses like influenza or SARS-CoV-2, which spread much more efficiently. Historically, even large Ebola outbreaks have generally remained regionally concentrated, though international exportation of cases can occur.

•Ebola Fact Sheet

● Zoonotic infection caused by Orthoebolavirus. Fruit bats presumed to be natural hosts.

● Transmitted when people come into close contact with blood or body fluids of the infected.

● Six strains identified to date; three known to cause major outbreaks: Ebola (or Zaire), Sudan, and Bundibugyo. The Bundibugyo strain has caused the current outbreak.

INCUBATION PERIOD: 2 to 21 days from infection to onset of symptoms.

SYMPTOMS: Fever, fatigue, muscle pain, headache, and sore throat, followed by vomiting, diarrhoea, abdominal pain rash, and impaired kidney and liver functions.

MAJOR OUTBREAKS: First identified in 1976 in what is now South Sudan and DRC. Later, in Uganda (2000-01), West Africa (2013-16), DRC and Uganda (2018-20), and Uganda (2025).

Can existing health systems handle repeated Ebola outbreaks? Why despite pandemics and now repeated Ebola outbreaks, does health infrastructure remain fragile and vulnerable?

The reason infrastructure stays fragile despite all these crises comes down to what I call the panic-neglect cycle. When an outbreak ends, political attention and money evaporate. External responders flood in, contain the fire and leave without building anything durable.

Local hospitals, lab networks and contact-tracing systems remain exactly as fragile as they were before. Rinse, repeat. Covid-19 didn't break this pattern; it just illustrated it at global scale.

Will vaccines and treatments keep pace with emerging strains? Not all Ebola strains are equally covered by existing vaccines or therapies.

There is a need to make countermeasures that cover all filoviruses. While strain specific countermeasures are critical, ultimately universal filovirus medications and vaccines are needed. However, there is work ongoing on Marburg, Ebola Sudan, and Ebola Bundibugyo countermeasures, the latter of which may see use during this outbreak.

How AI can help

AI-supported autonomic surveillance can do massive amounts of data analysis.

It can inform medical countermeasure development, epidemiology, and overall surveillance.

• ECONOMICS

Why rising govt bond yields are bad news for people and businesses



GRAPHS,
DATA,
PERSPECTIVES
BY UDIT MISRA

WEEKLY ECONOMIC AND POLICY INSIGHTS USING DATA

IT IS becoming increasingly costly for governments across the world to borrow money. In many cases, the interest rates that lenders are charging are reaching their highest levels since the global financial crisis of 2008.

What's more, this upward shift has been quite sharp, which is a problem all by itself, regardless of the level of interest rates. Sharply rising borrowing costs for governments imply that borrowing costs for average consumers will also rise, possibly by a greater degree.

Why governments borrow money

In most countries, governments struggle to meet their expenditures just from taxation and other revenue sources. As such, governments have to borrow money to meet the gap.

This demand is typically higher in developing countries and lower in developed countries, simply because developed countries' governments are more capable and efficient at raising tax revenues. Poorer countries don't have enough people in the well-off bracket to tax.

Repeated crises have meant that even developed countries have struggled to grow fast enough to meet their expenses, thus resorting to higher levels of borrowing — not just in absolute amounts but also as a percentage of their GDP (or size of the economy).

How governments borrow money

In any economy, the government is the least risky borrower because it is least likely to fail in paying back. It is, after all, the government. In a crisis, it can even resort to printing money — a facility not available to businesses or households.

However, governments borrow in a different way. They float a bond — referred to as Treasuries in the US, Gilts in the UK, Bunds in Germany, G-Secs or government securities in India, and JGBs in Japan — essentially like an “I owe you” statement.

It states that the government borrows a particular sum (say \$100) for a particular

• It is getting costlier for governments to borrow

YIELDS FOR 10-YEAR GOVT BOND	DEC 2024	DEC 2025	MAY 2026
United States	4.581%	4.179%	4.560%
Japan	1.070%	2.079%	2.764%
United Kingdom	4.573%	4.474%	4.922%
Germany	2.362%	2.862%	3.060%
China	1.688%	1.850%	1.750%
India	6.870%	6.588%	7.085%

SOURCE: WORLD GOVERNMENT BONDS.COM

Government's guarantee

● The government is the least risky borrower because it is least likely to fail in paying back.

● Governments borrow by floating a bond, which is essentially like an “I owe you” statement.

period (say 10 years) and promises to pay a given return or coupon at the end of each year (say \$5) apart from paying back the principal at the end of 10 years. Unlike the annual interest rate (expressed in percentage) for home, car or factory loans, government bonds provide a predetermined exact amount. If all goes well, the annual interest rate (or yield) for this example will be 5%.

But imagine that the government decides to launch a war and, as a result, inflation starts rising and the government's demand for money also rises, while the economic prospects of the country decline. The government may be forced to borrow more money, but investors and lenders would now demand a higher rate of return

because they are wary of the increased risks. The government would have to promise a higher coupon, say of \$10, on the new bonds.

This will, in turn, make the old bonds (with an annual coupon return of \$5) appear sub-optimal. Holders will try to sell them, often at prices lower than \$100. How much lower? Anyone buying the old bond must have a yield or expected return of 10% from them, and as such, the old bond prices will have to fall to \$50 so that they can be sold in the markets.

Essentially, this is what is happening globally: government bond yields are rising sharply. It must be noted that countries borrow and refinance in trillions of dollars, as such, yield movements are tracked upto three decimal places (*see table*).

Broader impact

Higher yields for government bonds basically translate into even higher interest rates for people and businesses.

They also mean that governments will have to spend even more of their annual budgets towards paying back annual interest on bonds. That, in turn, can only happen either by spending cuts in other areas such as welfare schemes or defence or by higher taxation. In sum, a bond sell-off and rising yields are not good news.

• CULTURE

Behind Lahore bringing back Hindu names of localities, pride and practicality

Yashee
New Delhi, May 22

LAHORE, MUCH like New Delhi, is a palimpsest prepared over centuries, with several histories peeking over the shoulders of several presents. Recently, it has been in the news for turning back a comparatively recent page of its past — reverting to some pre-Partition Hindu and British names of its streets and localities.

Why is an Islamic country embracing Hindu names? Why is the change happening now?

What is the current name change project in Lahore?

The names coming back include Queen's Road, Jail Road, Davies Road, Lawrence Road, Empress Road, Krishan Nagar, Santnagar, Dharampura, Brandreth Road, Ram Gali, Tempbell Street, Laxmi Chowk, Jain Mandir Road, Kumharpura, Mohan Lal Bazaar, Sundar Das Road, Bhagwan Pura, Shanti Nagar and Outfall Road. Jain Mandir road, in fact, was renamed

after the Babri Masjid when the Mughal-era mosque was demolished in Ayodhya in 1992. The Lahore temple had been torn down in retaliation, but has been restored.

The latest initiative is part of a 50-billion Pakistani rupee project called Lahore Authority for Heritage Revival, or LAHR, initiated by the Maryam Nawaz government of Punjab. LAHR's patron is Maryam's father and former Pakistan Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif. The initiative aims to restore Lahore to its old glory, and conservation of history and heritage is one part of the process.

Is there no opposition to the name changes?

The politics of name changes has never been very strong in Pakistan. In the years after Partition, even when some names were changed officially, people still used the old names colloquially. The official page of the District of Lahore says that the city was founded by Luv, the son of Lord Rama.

Yaqoob Khan Bangash, historian who teaches at Institute of Business Admin-



The Lahore Fort. WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

istration, Karachi, told *The Indian Express*, “There are many government hospitals, like Sir Ganga Ram Hospital, which have retained Hindu names. In fact, there is a Nehru Park in Lahore, whose name has been changed, and I once asked people from three generations what they refer to it as. All three said they call it Nehru Park.”

Bangash puts it down to the fact that Lahore did not see “ideological migration” during the Partition. “The elite Muslims from Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, etc., went to Karachi and other cities. The migration in Punjab was not ideological, it was forced. The migrants in Lahore were mainly working class. It did not get a new elite who would want to re-shape the city. Lahore's existing elite were proud of their city, wanted to retain its multicultural and multi-religious past, and did not accept the monolithic identity the Partition brought. So even when names were changed at the government level, there wasn't much enthusiasm for it within the locals.”

The fact that refugees in Lahore blended in more easily than in other major cities both sides of the border has been written about elsewhere too. Ian Talbot, history professor at the University of Southampton, has written in a 2007 paper, “Tensions between refugees and locals often occurred either in situations of fear of a refugee takeover, as in Karachi, or of acute competition for resources.” In Lahore, the refugees were skilled craftsmen or traders, who “either filled niches in the labour market left by departing Hindus, or started new industries,” Talbot writes. He adds that many refugees had pre-Partition “brider” (community) ties with Lahore. Thus, the new Muslim population did not feel the need to erase the Hindu past.

Bangash said that in addition, Lahore was always a hub of education and culture, and this has played a role in the pride the city takes in its heritage.

If all of this is true for Lahore, would the reverting to Hindu and British names see protests in other parts of the country? Khuraja Shafique Ahmed, a public policy re-

searcher who hails from Sindh and lives in Karachi, said Sindh too has hospitals and buildings that have retained their names, giving the example of Rai Bahadur Udhavdas Tarachand Hospital in Shikarpur. “The politics of renaming is rooted in a tussle between two religions, and Pakistan, an Islamic state, doesn't really have that. Plus, the common people realise that Islamisation of everything has resulted in extremism. They want to reclaim their history and identity,” Ahmed said.

Why the change now?

What is driving the Maryam Nawaz government to spearhead this drive?

Bangash said. “The PMLN (the Sharifs' party), is not very ideologically driven. They are more a business-oriented party.” Pakistan has recently attracted positive international attention. Punjab wants to attract more tourism and investment, and the move is part of an effort to project an inclusive, vibrant image.

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Classifieds

PERSONAL

I,**hitherto** known as Vikram Singh,S/O-Ramesh Kumar,R/o-1,Kalka Devi-Marg,Main Market,Garhi, Delhi-110065,have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Vikram Singh Besoya.

0040856079-9

I,SHAIKH SHABANA AHMED,W/O-Shaikh Anis Ahmed,R/O-WZ-47,Budhella, Vikas-Puri,New-Delhi-110018,have changed my minor Son's name,from "REHAN AHMED ANIS AHMED SHAIKH to REHAN SHAIKH.

0040856079-5

I,**Uma** Rani Gupta W/o Satyadeo Prasad Gupta,R/o A-202 Riverview Apartment,Near Opp Fraser Suites,Mayur Vihar Extension,VTC:Mayur Vihar Ph-1,PO-Mayur Vihar Ph-1,Sub District-Preet Vihar,District East Delhi-110091 declare that Uma Devi, Uma Gupta and Uma Rani Gupta all names are one and the same person and I will be known as Uma Rani Gupta for all purposes.

0040856079-6

I,**Sweta,D/o** Satyadeo Prasad Gupta,R/o A-202 Riverview Apartment, Near Opp Fraser Suites,Mayur Vihar Extension, VTC:Mayur Vihar Ph-1,PO-Mayur Vihar Ph-1,Sub District-Preet Vihar,District East Delhi-110091 declare that Sweta and Sweta Gupta both names are one and the same person and I will be known as Sweta Gupta for all purposes.

0040856079-7

I,**SHIMPY GARG W/o**,PIYUSH BANSAL,H.No-1863,BANSAL BHAWAN MAMURPUR, NARELA North west DELHI-110040,have changed my name to SHIMPY BANSAL.

0040856087-6

I,**SANJAY S/O** CHARANJEET LAL R/o House No-2674, 1st Floor, Outram,Lines,G.T.B Nagar,Delhi-110009,have changed my name to SANJAY GOSWAMI.

0040856079-4

I,**Nikhat** Chaudhary,W/o Fakhrey Alam Chaudhary R/o-159/10,Third Floor,Mosque View Apartment,Zakir Nagar,Delhi-110025have changed my name to Nikhat parveen.

0040856079-3

I,**Nasruddin S/O** Abdul Aziz R/o D-20, Gali No-14 Ext.Old Mustafabad, Delhi-110094,Have Changed My Name To NASIRUDDIN Permanently.

0040856079-2

I,**Manoj** Kumar,S/o-Dharam Bir R/o-H.no-620/12,2nd floor, Dayanand-Nagar Bahadurgarh Hjaajar Haryana-124507 Have changed my name to Manoj Dangi for all purposes

0040856087-5

I,**KHUSHBOO SINGH W/o**NO. 15694692A RANK SIGMAN (LATE) PRASHANT KUMAR SINGH R/O PLOT NO. 40, FLAT NO.B-3, KH. NO. 139/2, MAHI APPARTMENT, SECOND FLOOR, NEAR SARSWATI HOSPITAL JAI VIHAR PHASE -1 NAGAFGARH, DELHI - 110043 have changed the name of my minor son from PRATYAKSH SINGH to KUMAR PRATYAKSH vide affidavit date 21-5-2026 before Delhi.

0071037307-1

I,**KHUSHBOO SINGH W/o**NO. 15694692A RANK SIGMAN (LATE) PRASHANT KUMAR SINGH R/O PLOT NO. 40, FLAT NO.B-3, KH. NO. 139/2, MAHI APPARTMENT, SECOND FLOOR, NEAR SARSWATI HOSPITAL JAI VIHAR PHASE -1 NAGAFGARH, DELHI - 110043 have changed the name of my minor son from PRAMAN SINGH to KUMAR PRAMAN vide affidavit date 21-5-2026 before Delhi.

0071037310-1

I,**Jishan S/o**,Mohd Ismail R/o-RZ-65,Deep-Enclave Part-4,Gali-No.1, Vikas-Nagar,Uttam-Nagar, New-Delhi-110059,affir m that my father's name Mohd Ismail and Israyal both names belong to one and the same person.

0040856087-2

I,**LILLIAN KRISHEN W/o** Late Sh.Navin Krishen R/o D-139 Saket Delhi-110017, have changed my name to LILLIAN AGNES KRISHEN

0040856079-1

I, **Faujiya, W/o** Mohd Muslim, R/o- C-114 Shaheen Bagh, Abul Fazal Enclave-2, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025, have changed my name to Fozia Choudhary.

0040856078-8

I,**Abhishek** Kumar Gailey S/o Vinod Kumar Gailey R/o-181/182,First-Floor, Block-A,DDA-Flats,Bindapur, Uttam-Nagar,West Delhi-110059,have changed my name to Abhishek.

0040856087-1

I,Varsha D/o Pratik Prakash R/o 639, BLK-GH, PK-1 Sector-28, Rohini, Delhi- 110042, have changed my name to Varsha Sawariya for all future purposes.

0040855960-1

I, Priyanka Kumari Agrawal, W/o Vikash Kumar, Resident of Qtr No-C229, NTPC Samridhi Township, Sector-33, Noida, UP-201301, have changed my name from Priyanka Kumari Agrawal to Priyanka Kumari. Henceforth, I would be known by the name of Priyanka Kumari for all future purposes.

0071037277-1

I, Jitender Verma R/o B-10, Gali No.3, Near Mangalam Hospital, West Vinod Nagar, Delhi-110092, have changed the Name of my minor boy child aged 15 years from Moksh to Moksh Verma.

0040855959-1

I, Israr S/o Ishaq Ahmed R/o, E-130, Jasola-Village, New Friends Colony, South-Delhi, Delhi-110025, have changed my-name to Israr Ahmed.

0040856087-3

I, GAGANDEEP SINGH S/o Surjeet Singh Chawla, S1/89, UGF, Old Mahavir Nagar, Delhi-18 have changed my name to GAGAN DEEP SINGH CHAWLA.

0071037350-1

I,Devi Singh S/o Chhattar Singh R/o Plot No. 630/2, Gali No. 627, Pana Ramayan, V& PO Tikri Kalan, Delhi-110041 have changed the name of my minor Son from Yash to Yash Sheoran for all purposes.

0071037297-1

I, Deepika Singhwaia W/o Deepak Pitambar Lal Manghani R/o B-502, Hari Icon Nr Jay Bhole Bunglows Nana Chiloda, Ahmedabad City, Gujarat -382330 have changed my name to Deepika Deepak Manghani for all further documentation and purposes.

0040855993-1

I, Debasmitha Nath, W/O Tathagatha Nath, resident of F-614, Jalvayu Towers, Sector-47, Noida-201301, UP, have changed my name from Debasmitha Nath to Debasmitha Chatterjee. Henceforth I would be known by the name of Debasmitha Chatterjee for all future purposes.

0071037295-1

I, BABITA W/o Umesh Kumar R/o D-320, Street No.11, Cr Road, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092, have changed my name to URVASHI permanently.

0040856078-6

I, A SANJAY s/o MUTTURASHN R/o G-985, Shakur Pur, Delhi-110034 have changed my name to SANJAY permanently.

00408559590-1

I Soumya Gupta alias Soumya Verma D/o Ashok Kumar Gupta W/o Shubham Verma R/o Plot No.34, Road No.61, West Punjabi Bagh, VTC Punjabi Bagh, Distt-West Delhi-110026 have changed my name to Soumya Verma for all purposes.

0040855949-1

I, Aslam S/o Bilal Ahmed R/o E-159-160, JJ Colony, Madipur, Delhi-63, have changed my name to Aslam Sheikh.

0071037346-1

I Sarvesh Mohan S/o Subhash Chand Gupta R/o D 181/C 323, Dabua Colony, Faridabad have changed my name to Sarvesh Mohan Agarwal.

0040856078-10

I SUGAN S/O JHARAN R/O C-507 Phase-2 Metro Vihar Holambi Kalan North West Delhi, Delhi-110082 have changed my name from SUGAN to SUDHAN MANDAL for all future purposes .

0050289873-1

I SHYAM SUNDER LAL DUBEY S/O SHRI GYAN NARAYAN DUBEY SINGH R/O H.NO -U173, GROUND FLOOR, UPADHAYAY BLOCK, SHAKAR PUR DELHI-110092HAVE CHANGED MY NAME SHYAM SUNDER LAL DUBEY TO SHYAM SUNDER DUBEY FOR FUTURE

0040856078-4

I Rajni W/o Akash Kumar R/o 212B, Munirka, New Delhi-110067 have changed my name to Rajni Mudgal for all purposes.

0040855949-2

I Nagaji Ram S/o Virma Ram R/o L-065, DLF CAPITAL GREENS, 15, SHIVAJI MARG MOTI NAGAR, Delhi -110015 have changed my name to Nagji Ram.

0040856078-3

I Manju Mishra W/o Pankaj Kumar Pandey R/o Flat No. E-802, Hawella Valencia Homes Plot.No. GH-078, Sector-1, Greater Noida,Gautam Buddh Nagar-201306 have changed my name from Manju Mishra to Manju Pandey. Henceforth I would be Known by the name of Manju Pandey for all future purposes.

0071037373-1

I MOHAMMAD ANAS S/O MOHD SUALEHEEN R/O H.NO-1033 MOHALLA KISHAN GANJ AZAD MARKET DELHI-110006 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MOHD ANAS FOR FUTURE.

0040856078-2

I MOHAMMAD AFNAN S/O MOHD ANAS R/O H.NO-1033 MOHALLA KISHAN GANJ AZAD MARKET DELHI-110006 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MOHD AFNAN FOR FUTURE.

0040856078-1

I Gurinder Singh Ghai S/O Karam Singh Resident 4-C/6,Old Rajinder Nagar,Delhi-110060 have changed my name to Gurinder Singh.

0040856087-4

I ADHIRAJ NAIN S/O AMIT CHAUDHARY R/O A-24,RAMPURI,NEAR SURYA NAGR, CHANDER NAGAR, GHAZIABAD UTTAR PRADESH-201011 changed my name to ADHIRAJ CHAUDHARY.

0040856078-5

I,hitherto known as Devanshu Jasrotia,S/O-Ajpal Singh,R/O-2643 Sainik-Okhla Sector-49, Faridabad,Haryana-121001, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Devansh Jasrotia

0040856079-10

PUBLIC NOTICE

To be known to all that my client Ms. Manju Gupta W/o Late Sh. Anil Gupta R/o Flat No. 32A, MIG Pocket-5, Mayur Vihar Phase-3, Delhi-96, is the owner of Flat No. 32A, MIG Pocket-5, Mayur Vihar Phase-3, Delhi-96, an original document issued by DDANOC in favour of Jagan Nath S/o Sh. Gyasi Lal dated 19.06.1997 for electric, water connection in his name has been lost, a FIR of this effect has been lodged vide LR.No.319744/26 dt.1.05.2026. Any person claiming any rights, interest or having any objections may right/contact my client at phone number 8960809875 within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice.

Tushar Upadhyaya, Advocate
E.No.-D-8211/23, Advt. Ch.F-212, K.K.D. Court-Delhi-32; M: 9899191671

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is hereby informed that general public that my client Anantjeet Kaur Makkar and Harpreet Singh, and Jyotsna Singh Flat No. D-53 Second Floor, Category-A, Suburban Delhi Colony Group Housing Society Limited, Plot No. 24, Sector-13, Rohini, Delhi, New Sangam Nagar S/o Ramesh Nagar and Khushboo Vijay Nagar W/o Sarpreet Nagar. If any person, bank, financial institution, or any other authority has any claim, objection, mortgage, deposit, or interest of whatsoever nature in respect of the aforesaid flat and/or proposed transaction, the same should be intimated in writing to Jyoti Singh, Advocate, 1224, 12th Floor, Lawyers Chamber Block, Haryana Court Complex, Rohini, Delhi, Mobile: 9811242793, along with supporting documentary evidence within seven (7) days from the date of publication of this notice, failing which it shall be presumed that no such objection or claim exists and the transaction shall be completed accordingly.

Vinod Singh, (Advocate)

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client Smt. Kesho Devi W/o Late Shri Parmal R/o H.No. 205, Ghoda Mohalla, Aya Nagar, South Delhi, Delhi 110047, has severed all her relations and disowned her son Gaurav and his wife Poonam with their children namely Garvik @ Shibu and Divyansh from her all movable-immovable properties due to their disobedience and cruel behavior. My client shall not be responsible for any of their legal, financial or social acts, deeds, and liabilities. Anyone dealing with them shall do so at their own risk and responsibility.

Jeet Raj (Advocate)
Ch. No. 648 Saket Court, New Delhi-17

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform you that My client Shri Sanjay Kumar Jan S/O Shri Satbir Singh Jan, R/O 1249, Prem Nagar, Uttam Nagar, D.K. Mohan Garden, West Delhi, Delhi-110059, lost certain Death Certificates i.e. previous owners namely (i) Shri Satbir Singh S/o Shri Mittal Lal Jan died on 07.06.2009, (2) Shri Suresh Jan S/O Shri Satbir Singh Jan, died on 09.12.2012, and (3) Smt. Kumar S/O Shri Satbir Singh Jan, died on 26.10.1995, issued by Govt. of NCT of Delhi, concerned with Property bearing No. 8, Block-Z, area measuring 125.00 sq. yds., situated W. H. S. Naraina, Loha Mandi, New Delhi, which has been lost by my client in the area Jalandhuri District Centre, Delhi, dated 05.05.2026, in this regard, my client lodged a Reports L.R. No. 202959/2026 dated 22.05.2026, through online. It is stated that he wants to mortgage the said property with BANK OF INDIA, Connaught Place, Delhi, if any litigation is pending or third party interest is on the mortgage property they may kindly contact in BANK OF INDIA Branch within 7 days from the date of publication of the said public notice.

SUNU GAUTAMA (ADVOCATE)
Ch. No. 754, W.W.Tis Hazari Court, Delhi-54

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
CORRIGENDUM

The critical dates and time as called vide this office Tender Notice No. PW/SR/J/TA/Publication/2026-27-826-30 dated 22.04.2026 for online Tenders and further this office corrigendum No. PW/SR/J/TA/Publication/2026-27-1299-1301 dated 29.04.2026 and 1536-38 dated 14.05.2026 are hereby extended as below due to some Administrative/ Technical reasons.

Sr. No.	Description	May be read as under
1.	Starting date for downloading bid	03.06.2026 at 11:00 AM instead of 22.05.2026 at 11:00 AM.
2.	Deadline for submission of bid	10.06.2026 at 09:00 AM instead of 29.05.2026 at 09:00 AM.
3.	Date of opening of bid	10.06.2026 at 11:00 AM instead of 29.05.2026 at 11:00 AM.

All other terms & conditions will remain un-changed.

Executive Engineer,
HPPWD Division
Seraj at Janjehli

No. 0778/H/P

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
CORRIGENDUM

The critical dates and time as called vide this office Tender Notice No. PW/ SR/J/ TA/Publication/2026-27-1140-43 dated 27-04-2026 for online Tenders and further this office corrigendum No.- PW/SR/J/TA/Publication/2026-27-1344-46 dated 04-05-2026, 1486-88 dated 11-05-2026 and 1539-41 dated 14-05-2026 are hereby extended as below due to some Administrative/Technical reasons.

Sr. No.	Description	May be read as under
1	Starting date for downloading bid	03.06.2026 at 11:00 AM instead of 22.05.2026 at 11:00 AM.
2	Deadline for submission of bid	10.06.2026 at 09:00 AM instead of 29.05.2026 at 09:00AM.
3	Date of opening of bid	10.06.2026 at 11:00 AM instead of 29.05.2026 at 11:00AM.

All other terms & conditions will remain un-changed.

Executive Engineer,
HP PWD Division Seraj at Janjehli

No. 0779/2026-2027/HP

कार्यालय कार्यपालन यंत्री लो.स्वा.यां. संधारण खण्ड नगर पालिक निगम उज्जैन
द्वितीय निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

लोक स्वास्थ्य यांत्रिकी संधारण खण्ड नगर पालिक निगम उज्जैन द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु ऑन लाईन निविदाओं का आमंत्रण केन्द्रीकृत प्रणाली में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से निम्नानुसार नगरीय प्रशासन एवं विकास विभाग द्वारा जारी एस.ओ.आर. दिनांक 02.06.2021 से लमसम आधार पर किया जाता है।

नि.स.क्र.	कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की अनु. लागत	प्रतिभुति राशि	ऑन लाईन निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य	समयावधि	निविदा क्रय एवं दर प्रस्तुत करने की अंतिम तिथि
2026 UAD 482406.2	Water Rejuvenation Project Including Ghat Redevelopment, Riverfront Development and Allied Infrastructure along the Kshipra River in Ujjain.	642484755/-	3212423/-	50000/-	15 माह	11-06-2026

निविदा संबंधित अन्य विवरण एवं विस्तृत निविदा सूचना की जानकारी वेब साईट <https://mptenders.gov.in> पर ऑन लाईन दर्शाई गई है।

कार्यपालन यंत्री लो.स्वा.यां.संथा. खण्ड न.पा. नि. उज्जैन

आयुक्त नगर पालिक निगम उज्जैन

**GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA****TENDER NOTICE**

SR NO.	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD BAR, AMBALA	CONSTRUCTION OF GOVT. VETERINARY HOSPITAL AT AMBALA CITY IN AMBALA DISTRICT. + 12 WORKS	19.05.2026 25.05.2026	118.11 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172977224 pwd-eeptl-ambala@hry.nic.in
2	PWD BAR, GURUGRAM	RENOVATION OF 4 NIOS. OFFICES AND WASHROOM, INCLUDING WALL PANNELING AND OTHER ANCILLARY WORK IN HUMAN RIGHT COMMISSION OFFICE AT PWD REST HOUSE AT GURUGRAM.	CLOSING DATE 28.05.2026	28.39 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01249322424 pwd-eeptl-gurgaon@hry.nic.in
3	PANCHAYATI RAJ, BHIVANI	PAVMENT OF 5 NOS KHET KHAJAN RASTA 1PB (CN ANNOUNCEMENT 24219) AT VILLAGE- TIGRANA GP	20.05.2026 27.05.2026	143.31 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01664243927 preveeng.bhv@hry.nic.in
4	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, BHIVANI	REWINDING OF 10 NO. 150 HP MOTORS OF SIWANI CANAL IN SIWANI WATER SERVICES MECHANICAL SUB DIVISION TOSHAM.	CLOSING DATE 01.06.2026	8.09 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9812364411 vermecbhivani@gmail.com
5	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, SIRSA	REPAIR THE DAMAGED PATCH LINING OF LOHGARH LINK CHANNEL FROM RD. 0 TO 13950 Tail + 3 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 01.06.2026	11.48 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666235426 xenororis@gmail.com
6	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, ROHTAK	RECLAMATION OF WATERLOGGED LAND AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE TECHNOLOGY PROJECTS IN THE VILLAGES JALULI,MARODHI JATTAN,MARODHI RANGARH (BLOCK-KALANAUJ)	20.05.2026 01.06.2026	456.35 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466723261 asco.rk2015@gmail.com
7	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, ROHTAK	RECLAMATION OF WATERLOGGED LAND AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECTS IN THE VILLAGES PATWAPUR,BALAB-II, JAKRANA, GARHI BALAB AND ANJAL(BLOCK-KALANAUJ) DISTRICT-ROHTAK	20.05.2026 01.06.2026	627.23 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466723261 asco.rk2015@gmail.com
8	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, ROHTAK	RECLAMATION OF WATERLOGGED LAND AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE TECHNOLOGY IN VILLAGE MAKROULI KHURD,MAKROULI KALAN,ROHTK (BLOCK-ROHTAK)AND BHARAN(BLOCK-MEHAM, DISTRICT-ROHTAK.	20.05.2026 01.06.2026	821.92 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466723261 asco.rk2015@gmail.com
9	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, ROHTAK	RECLAMATION OF WATERLOGGED LAND AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE TECHNOLOGY PROJECTS IN THE VILLAGE MADINA KORSAN AND MADINA GONDHRAN, BLOCK-MEHAM, DISTRICT-ROHTAK	20.05.2026 01.06.2026	815.30 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466723261 asco.rk2015@gmail.com
10	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, ROHTAK	RECLAMATION OF WATERLOGGED LAND AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT IN THE VILLAGES-BEHLA AND KHARKARA, BLOCK-MEHAM, DISTRICT-ROHTAK	20.05.2026 01.06.2026	763.61 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466723261 asco.rk2015@gmail.com
11	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, ROHTAK	RECLAMATION OF WATERLOGGED AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE TECHNOLOGY PROJECT IN THE VILLAGE- RITOL,PAHRANWAR,SAMARGOPALPUR KALAN ,SAMARGOPALPUR KHURD,NIDANA BLOCK AND DISTRICT-ROHTAK	20.05.2026 01.06.2026	684.15 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466723261 asco.rk2015@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No. 45523/HRY

FEDBANK FINANCIAL SERVICES LTD. AUCTION NOTICE

This is to inform the public at large that FEDBANK FINANCIAL SERVICES LTD. has decided to conduct Auction of Gold ornaments belonging to accounts (mentioned below) which are NPA (Non-performing Asset) or margin breach account/s or any account/s falling into the loan recall clause as specified in the **terms & condition** of the Loan. The Auction would be held as per the schedule provided below:

Loan A/c Number	Base Branch	District 1 Contact	District Auction Date
FEDBD04280000431	PANIPAT - 9034629873	Panipat - 9034629873	22/06/2026
FEDGLO4800007030	PALWAL - 9813879553	Palwal - 9813879553	22/06/2026
FEDGLO4650003317	NISSING - 9813491300	Karnal - 7015335053	25/06/2026
FEDGLO5270001133	JIND - HARYANA - 8607867675	Jind - 8607867675	25/06/2026
FEDGLO5350000444	GHAZIABAD RDC - 9925727854	Ghaziabad GT Road - 7351714849	22/06/2026
FEDGLO1170009889	BHANGEL - 9555984246	BHANGEL - 9555984246	24/06/2026
FEDGLO1170000892	BHANGEL - 9555984246	BHANGEL - 9555984246	24/06/2026
FEDBD0438000041	MATHURA - DELHI - 7037819412	Mathura - 7037819412	25/06/2026
FEDGLO5170003352	BULANDSHAHR - 9729972425	Bulandshahar - 9729972425	25/06/2026
FEDGLO1170009896	BHANGEL - 9555984246	BHANGEL - 9555984246	25/06/2026
FEDGLO5170003394	BULANDSHAHR - 9729972425	Bulandshahar - 9729972425	25/06/2026
FEDGLO1090012488	Khirki Village - 9555400035	Khirki Village - 9555400035	22/06/2026
FEDGLO1090012493	BARDARPUR - 9716913319	Khirki Village - 9555400035	22/06/2026
FEDGLO3610005571	ROHINI SECTOR 16 - 9315890305	Rohini Sector 16 - 9315890305	22/06/2026
FEDBD01440000641	KHIRKI VILLAGE - 9555400035	Khirki Village - 9555400035	22/06/2026
FEDGLO3260009691	NARELA - 8708765572	Narela Nagar - 9582229557	22/06/2026
FEDGLO3530007145	PANKHA ROAD - 8800379452	Patel Nagar - 7011407399	22/06/2026
FEDGLO3610005579	ROHINI SECTOR 16 - 9315890305	Rohini Sector 16 - 9315890305	22/06/2026
FEDGLO3710006437	UTTAM NAGAR - 9873133090	Patel Nagar - 7011407399	22/06/2026
FEDGLO4990005480	DEOLI - DELHI - 8512807540	Khirki Village - 9555400035	22/06/2026
FEDGLO5030030380	HASTAL VILLAGE - DELHI - 8588666172	Dwarka Mor - 8527739164	22/06/2026
FEDGLO3450008519	BHAJANPURA - 9504482802	Vishwas Nagar - 7838606648	24/06/2026
FEDGLO3460009541	CHANDERLOK - 9953244095	Vishwas Nagar - 7838606648	24/06/2026
FEDGLO0810008107	KHANPUR - 9911995078	Khirki Village - 9555400035	25/06/2026
FEDGLO3280001456	KARAWAL NAGAR - 9999416919	Vishwas Nagar - 7838606648	25/06/2026
FEDGLO4970004438	GEETA COLONY - DELHI - 9971702021	Vishwas Nagar - 7838606648	25/06/2026
FEDGLO1080013023	PALAM COLONY - 8448800976	Dwarka Mor - 8527739164	25/06/2026
FEDGLO1090012524	BARDARPUR - 9716913319	Khirki Village - 9555400035	25/06/2026

Change in Venue or Date, if any, will be displayed on our Website <https://www.fedfina.com/gold-loan/special-sections/auction-venue/>. Customer who want to release their ornaments shall visit any of the above branch/es or contact at the number mentioned above on/or before auction date subject to the terms and condition applicable. Auction will be conducted at respective Districts. In case the auction does not get completed on the given date due to any reasons, the auction in respect thereto shall be conducted on subsequent working days at district level as per above schedule. This would continue till the auction process is over. On failure of the first auction at District level, auction will also be initiated through the E-auction platforms of SAMIL <https://gold.samil.in> and/or e-Procurement Technologies Ltd. (AuctionTiger) - <https://egold.auctiontiger.net/>.

All participating bidders will be intimated subsequently with respect to acceptance or rejection of bids submitted by them.

Dated : 23.05.2026

Place : Delhi

For, sd/- Authorised Signatory
Fedbank Financial Services Ltd.,



epaper.indianexpress.com



ALIGARH SMART CITY LTD NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

Aligarh Smart City Limited (ASCL) invites online bids through a two-bid system from eligible bidders for the Selection of Concessionaire for Operation, Maintenance and Management of Lal Diggi Pond at Kalyan Singh Habitat Centre, Aligarh on a concession basis for a period of 15 (Fifteen) years, further extendable by 5 (Five) years, subject to terms and conditions of the RFP as per following schedule:

Minimum Reserve Concession Fee	Tender Fee	EMD	RFP Download Start Date	Last Date for Submission	Opening of Technical Bids
Rs. 30,00,000/- per annum (excluding taxes)	Rs. 4,500/- + GST	Rs. 1,50,000/-	22.05.2026	30.05.2026 03:00 PM	30.05.2026 05:00 PM

The detailed RFP document shall be available on the e-procurement portal: <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Interested bidders are required to submit their bids online only on the above portal within the stipulated time.

ASCL reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids without assigning any reason thereof.

Sd/-

Chief Executive Officer
Aligarh Smart City Limited

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, देवघर ।

पत्रांक 410 / देवघर, दिनांक 20.05.2026

शुद्धि-पत्र

एतद द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि इस कार्यालय द्वारा आमंत्रित पुनः ई निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या – RDD/SD/DEOGHAR/01/ RE1/2026-27, (देवघर जिला के देवीपुर प्रखंड अन्तर्गत भारतीडीह एवं मथुरापुर के बीच उच्चस्तरीय पुल निर्माण), जिसका PR No. 380098 Rural Development (26-27) #D है, को पहुँच पथ में स्थल विवाद के कारण निविदा को अगले आदेश तक स्थगित किया जाता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल,
देवघर

PR 380493 Deoghar(26-27)D

राजस्थान स्कूल शिक्षा परिषद्
भू- कल, बाली-4, ई.आर. हाउस, राजस्थान शिक्षा संघ, जयपुर, राजस्थान-302017
फोन: 0141-2708459, E-Mail: RAJMSA.CIVIL@RAJASTHAN.GOV.IN

अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या 02 (सिविल)/2026-27
(राजकीय विद्यालय/हॉस्टल के निर्माण कार्य हेतु)

राज्य एवं केन्द्र सरकार के राजकीय/अर्द्धशासकीय/स्वायत्तशासी निकायों में सक्षम श्रेणी में निर्माण कार्य हेतु पंजीकृत संवेदकों से समग्र शिक्षा वार्षिक कार्य योजना एवं बजट वर्ष 2024-25, 2025-26, राज्य मद 2024-25, 2025-26, 2026-27, DAJGUA 2024-25, DAJGUA 2025-26 PMSHRI 2025-26, DMFT, CSR एवं PMJKV इत्यादि योजनान्तर्गत स्वीकृत 40 राजकीय विद्यालय/हॉस्टल के निर्माण कार्य हेतु राशि रु. 7151.66 लाख (प्रति कार्य की राशि रुपये 3.65 लाख से 413.69 लाख के मध्य) बाबत कार्यवार ई-टेंडरिंग के माध्यम से अल्पकालीन ई-निविदाएं 25/05/2026 प्रातः 10.00 बजे से 03/06/2026 को सायं 6.00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती है।

- निविदा से सम्बंधित समस्त विस्तृत विवरण वेबसाइट <http://rajmsa.nic.in>, <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> एवं <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है।
- निविदा से सम्बंधित प्रक्रिया जिला परियोजना समन्वयक, समग्र शिक्षा कार्यालय सम्बंधित जिला के स्तर से की जाएगी।

UBN No.: RSE2627WSOB000291
राज.संवाद/सी/26/3338 राज्य परियोजना निदेशक, समग्र शिक्षा

Directorate of Town & Country Planning, Haryana

Nagar Yojana Bhavan, Plot no. 3, Sector-18 A,
Madhya Marg, Chandigarh

Web site: tpharyana.gov.in E-mail: tpharyana6@gmail.com

Memo No. LC-108/ATP(TK)/2026/17945 Dated: 21.05.2026

PUBLIC NOTICE

The State of Haryana in compliance of the order dated 18.05.2026 passed by Hon'ble Supreme Court in in M.A. No. 89/2026 in W.P.(C) No. 876 of 1996 titled Okhla Enclave Plot Holders Welfare Association Vs. Union of India & Others and connected matters, through this public notice designates Sh. Devender Pal, STP, Faridabad as a Nodal Officer for receipt of all applications representations, documents and communications relating to individual claims in respect of the project (License No. 1-3 of 1991) developed by Durga Builders Pvt. Ltd., Sector-91, Faridabad. The details of the Nodal Officer are as under.

Name : Sh. Devender Pal
Designation : Senior Town Planner, Faridabad
Office Address : Room No. 303, 2nd Floor, HSVP Complex, Sec-12, Faridabad
Telephone No. : 0129-2220705
Official E-mail ID : stpfbd.nodlofficer.tpcigmail.com

All the stake holders are hereby informed that

- The Nodal Officer shall be the single point of receipt for all applications, representations, documents and communications relating to individual claims in respect of the project in question.
- The Nodal Officer shall act in aid of the learned Special Committee and shall discharge his functions in accordance with the instructions, requirements and directions issued by the learned Special Committee from time to time. No claimant, association, representative body or any other person shall directly communicate with the learned Special Committee, unless specifically permitted by the learned Special Committee.
- Every claimant shall submit all relevant documents in support of the claim within the time and manner specified in the public notice issued by the Nodal officer in compliance of Point No. (iii) & (iv) of para 8 of order dated 18.05.2026.
- The Nodal Officer shall acknowledge, compile, index and digitize the applications, representations and documents received. The complete record shall be forwarded to the learned Special Committee in an organized manner within two weeks from the last date fixed for receipt of claims.
- The Nodal Officer shall not decide the eligibility or merits of any claim. The role of the Nodal Officer shall be administrative and facilitative. The scrutiny and consideration of claims shall be undertaken by the learned Special Committee in accordance with the judgment dated 03.10.2019, the report dated 16.01.2023, the order dated 25.04.2025 and the parameters already laid down in these proceedings.
- No application or representation submitted after the cut-off date notified under this order shall be entertained by the Nodal Officer, except pursuant to further orders of Hon'ble Supreme Court.

(Amit Khatri, IAS)

Director, Town and

Country Planning,

Haryana, Chandigarh.

Dated: 21.05.2026
Place: Chandigarh
No. 45474/HRV

DELHI ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION

Viniyamak Bhawan, C-Block, Shivalik, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi-110 017
Website: www.derc.gov.in | Telefax: 41080417

PUBLIC NOTICE

PETITIONS FOR TRUE-UP OF EXPENSES OF FY 2023-24 FILED BY GENERATION COMPANIES (IPGCL & PPCL) AND DISTRIBUTION COMPANIES (NDMC & TPDDL)

- The Generation Companies viz. Indraprastha Power Generation Co. Ltd. (IPGCL) & Pragati Power Corporation Ltd. (PPCL) and Distribution Companies viz. New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) and Tata Power Delhi Distribution Ltd. (TPDDL) have filed their Petitions for approval of True-up of expenses of FY 2023-24 before the Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission ("DERC") of "The Commission".
- The Petitioners have filed their respective Petitions under the provisions of the Electricity Act, 2003, DERC (Comprehensive Conduct of Business) Regulations, 2001, DERC (Terms and Conditions for determination of Tariff) Regulations, 2017 and DERC (Business Plan) Regulations, 2017, 2019 & 2023. The Commission has admitted the Petitions vide its Order dated 12/12/2025 and 23/04/2026 subject to clarifications/additional information, if any, that may be sought from time to time.
- The Commission has prepared and uploaded the Executive Summary of these Petitions on its website <https://www.derc.gov.in/>
- In accordance with the provisions of the DERC (Comprehensive Conduct of Business) Regulations, 2001, the Commission hereby seeks comments/suggestions from the consumers and other stakeholders on the above Petitions. The comments/suggestions may be sent to the Secretary of the Commission at the above office address latest by 5/06/2026. The comments/suggestions may be submitted personally or by post or through E-mail to the Commission. The comments/suggestions can also be E-mailed to the Secretary, DERC at the e-mail address secyderc@nic.in
- The Commission shall hold a Public Hearing on Hybrid Mode (Physically and Virtually) with the responding stakeholders on 5/06/2026 and the procedure of registration for Public Hearing is also uploaded on the website of the Commission.
- The Commission shall scrutinize the True-up Petitions and seek further clarifications from the Petitioners, if required. By way of an Order, the Commission shall approve the True-up of expenses of FY 2023-24 after prudence check. The Orders on the True-up Petitions shall be issued after

Rajasthan Co-operative Dairy Federation Limited
"SARAS SANKUL" J. L. N. MARG, JAIPUR - 302017 Ph. No. 2703501-08 : Dir.ckt. 0141-2702871
Website : www.sarasmilkfed.rajasthan.gov.in, E-Mail : managermarketingrcdf@gmail.com

No. :- RCDF/Mktg./F.6 (1102)/2026-27/9006 - 44 Dated :- 21/05/2026

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDERS

Single Stage Two Parts unconditional online e-Tenders/e-Bids are invited by Rajasthan Co-Operative Dairy Federation Ltd., Jaipur for 'Job work to Supply packed drinking water (Saras Neer)' at various milk unions and units of RCDF on F.O.R. basis. (UBN No. CDF2627A0226) as per details given in the respective bid document. The Complete Bidding Documents can be visited and downloaded from our website www.sarasmilkfed.rajasthan.gov.in, www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in and www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in. E-Bids shall be submitted only on <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>.

Raj.Samwad/C/26/3384

General Manager (Mktg.)
जिला की ओर से-अमर उपाय

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rahul Yadav, S/o: bhure Singh, R/o: Village-Katka, Narupura Katka, PS-Pali Mukh Pur Atroli Aligarh, UP** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 069/2023, U/s: 406 IPC, Police Station Sangam Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rahul Yadav** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rahul Yadav** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rahul Yadav of Police Station Sangam Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Chatinder Singh
Ld. JMFC-04, Room No. 211,
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/6667/SD/2026

UJVN LIMITED
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H. O. "UJJAWAL" MAHARANI BASH, ONE ROAD, DEHRADUN - 248006, CH. No. 140191UR29P1SGC28888
Tele. : 0135-2763506, 2763608, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvnl.com

Tender No.434 Date : 22.05.2026

NOTICE TENDER

Office of the Executive Engineer (Maint.), Chibro Power Station, Dakpathar (Dehradun), invites sealed tenders from interested parties Tender No:(1)CH (Maint.)-07/2026-27Safety audit of tools & equipment at different sites of Chibro Power Station.
(2) CH (Maint.)-08/2026-27 Cleaning of D&D pits, clean water tanks, and miscellaneous work at Chibro Power Station for year 2026-27 and Caulking of Surge Tank Gate and Draft tube gates of Chibro Power Station.
(3)CH (Maint.)- 09/2026-27 Providing the services of Divers at Chibro Power House, Ichari Dam & other Sites of Dakpathar.
(4)CH (Maint.)- 10/2026-27SITC of Submersible pump along with Pipeline and fabrication work at Chibro Power Station.
Estimated cost: (1) ₹ 2,52,578/- (2) ₹ 8,39,795/- (3) ₹ 9,42,000/- (4) ₹ 24,84,529/- (GST Extra)
Date of availability of bid on website: 22.05.2026, 18:00 hrs
Last date for submission of tender: 15.06.2026, up to 13:00 hrs
For further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com"
(Executive Engineer, Maint., Chibro)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

NOTICE OF INVITING TENDER

DRM (S&T) North Western Railway /Jaipur, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite E-Tenders from registered tenderer/bidders for the following work **E-Tender Notice No. SNT-JP-07-2026-27 Date: 20.05.2026**
1.Name of work with its location : Telecom work in connection with Provision of Data com Equipments for implementation of approved UTN topology and replacement of Overaged datacom equipments over JP division of NWR Zone. **2. Tender Value (Rs.) :** Rs. 31230555.61/- **3. Bid Security (Rs.) :** Rs. 6246000.00/- **4. Tender submission & closing Date & Time on website :** 11.06.2026, up to 15.00 hrs. **5. Website Particulars & Notice board location :** www.ireps.gov.in, DRM office/NWR/ Jaipur.

755-DE/26

Please join us on [Facebook](https://www.facebook.com/NWRRailways) [Instagram](https://www.instagram.com/NWRRailways) [LinkedIn](https://www.linkedin.com/company/NWRRailways) [YouTube](https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCNWRRailways)

COMPREHENSIVE ANNUAL MAINTENANCE CONTRACT

E-Tender Notice No. S&T/APDJ/ 05, dated: 20-05-2026. E-tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following work: **SN.1. E-Tender No.: AP-ST-05-2026-27. Name of Work: Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract of Siemens make Electronic Interlocking at 16 Stations for a period of Three (03) years i.e. 36 Months in Alipurduar Division. Advertised Tender Value: ₹5,06,98,414.08. Bid Security: ₹10,14,000.00.** E-tenders will be closed at 15:00 hrs. on 10-06-2026 and will be opened on 10-06-2026 after closing. The complete information with tender document of above e-tender will be available in website www.ireps.gov.in DRM (S&T), Alipurduar Jn. **NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY** "Serving Customers with a smile"

- considering the comments/suggestions received from various stakeholders.
- The Commission may extend assistance to consumers in understanding the True-up Petitions and may also help them to file their comments in this regard. Accordingly, the Commission has nominated the following officers to extend necessary assistance to all such consumers, who may so desire. Discussions may be held after seeking prior appointment.
 - Sh. Amit Arora, Joint Director (Tariff-Engineering), Ph. No. 41080417 Ext. 117
 - Sh. Kushalkumar Laxmanrao Bhosikar, Joint Director (PS&E), Ph. No. 41080417 Ext. 120
 - Sh. Abhishek Srivastava, Dy. Director (T&D), Ph. No. 41080417 Ext. 142
 - Sh. Shray Saxena, Dy. Director (Tariff-Engineering), Ph. No. 41080417 Ext. 127
 - Sh. Praveen Kumar, Manager (Technical), Ph. 41080417 Ext. 111
 - The complete Petitions filed by the utilities can be downloaded from the website of the Commission i.e. <https://www.derc.gov.in/> and the Petitioners. A soft copy of the Petition may be obtained in CD on payment of Rs. 25/- per CD or a copy of the Petition may be purchased from the respective Petitioner's Head Office on any working day till 5/06/2026 between 11.00 AM to 4.00 PM on payment of Rs. 100/-either by cash or by Demand Draft/Pay Order payable at New Delhi as per the details given below:

Indraprastha Power Generation Corporation Ltd. Himadri, Rajghat Power House Complex, New Delhi-110 002 Website: www.ipgcl-ppcl.gov.in Phone: 011-23273542/44	Pragati Power Corporation Ltd., Himadri, Rajghat Power House Complex, New Delhi-110 002 Website: www.ipgcl-ppcl.gov.in Phone: 011-23273542/44
New Delhi Municipal Council, Palika Kendra, Sansad Marg, New Delhi-110001 Website: www.ndmc.gov.in Phone: 011-23341605	Tata Power Delhi Distribution Ltd., Substation Building, Hudson Lines, Kingsway Camp, New Delhi-110 009 Website: www.tatapower-dcl.com Phone: 19124

Sd/-

Joint Director (Tariff-Engineering)
Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission

PRASHASTI DE
Deputy Director (Pers.)

Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission

C-Block, Shivalik, Malviya Nagar

New Delhi-110017

DIP/SHABDARTH/CLASSIFIED/0065/26-27

U.P. RAJYA VIDYUT UTPADAN NIGAM LIMITED OBRA - SONEBHADRA

E-Tender Notice

- Short term E-Tender No. OBR/6000011369/T-11/PD-I/26-27, Supply of Caustic Soda Lye for BTPS, Obra, Tender Cost: Rs. 2360,00, EMD-Rs. 40,000.00, Amount:-Rs. 28,36,000.00, Last Date of Uploading Bid : 26.05.2026**

For information regarding Addendum/Corrigendum/Rejection of Bids kindly regularly visit website <https://etender.up.nic.in>.

पत्रांक: 76/जससका0/निविदा दिनांक: 21/05/2026
"राष्ट्रहित में बिजली बचाये"

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY		Notice inviting E-Auction	
Sr. No.	Assets	Particular	e-Auction Notice Date
1	Advertisement	Advertisement Contract through Supply, Installation, Operation & Maintenance of a Closed Circuit Digital Display System integrated with a Public Announcement System, comprising of LED screens and speakers at Ajmer Railway Station	29.05.2026
2	Leasing of SLR	Leasing of SLR Train no.12978 (MARU SAGAREXP)	29.05.2026
3	Parking	Parking Lot for Two Wheelers, Three Wheelers and Four Wheelers at loc RANI 2nd Entry Gate	03.06.2026
4	Multi-Purpose Stall	Multi-Purpose Stall (MPS) at AJMER JUNCTION station on Platform No. 02/03, MARWAR JUNCTION station on Platform No. 01, ABU ROAD station on Platform No. 02/03, ABU ROAD station on Platform No.1	03.06.2026

वेबसाइट जहाँ से लोट बाईज ई-ऑक्शन प्रारम्भ होने के समय एवं अन्य जानकारी प्राप्त की जा सकती है। www.ireps.gov.in **760-DE/26**

Please join us on [Facebook](https://www.facebook.com/NWRRailways) [Instagram](https://www.instagram.com/NWRRailways) [LinkedIn](https://www.linkedin.com/company/NWRRailways) [YouTube](https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCNWRRailways)

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

Open E-Tender Notice

12.06.2026 SN : 2 NIT No. : EL-JP-05-2026-27 Name of work : JP Div- Electrical work in connection with [1] RPF Training Centre BK1: Provision of Administrative building, class rooms, Gymnasium, sports facility (Cricket), [1] NIT No. : EL-JP-03-2026-27 Name of work : Electrical work in connection with [1] Replacement of old/Dilapidated quarters at RGS, SIKR, JJJN stns Type-II (20units), [2] Construction of new quarters for staff/officers at NNL, NIPDBLA of Type-II (08 Units), Type-III (05 Units) & Type-IV (02 Building Units)=15, [3] Providing 15 units Type-I quarters in lieu of old abandoned quarters for Gang No. 27 & 8 in SIKAR - LHU section, [4] Providing 8 quarters in lieu of old abandoned quarters for Gang No. 39,40 & 42 in SIKAR - LHU section, [4] Providing 8 quarters in lieu of old abandoned quarters for Gang No. 27 & 8 in JP- RGS section, [5] Replacement of old/Dilapidated quarters at FL, NRI, KSG stns Type-II(13 units), Type-III(05Units)&Type- IV(02 Units) =20 units, [6] Provision of Staff quarters at old KSG Station Type-2 (08 Nos) Type-III(04 Nos) & Type-IV (01 Nos) Total=13 Nos NIT cost: 10855504.78 Earnest Money : 217100.00 Tender opening : 12.06.2026

2. Date & time of closing of e-tender : On tender opening date upto 15.00 hrs. **Date & time of e-tender Opening :** On tender opening date after 15.00 hrs. **Complete details of tender can be seen on website No. :** <http://www.ireps.gov.in>

764-DE/26

Please join us on [Facebook](https://www.facebook.com/NWRRailways) [Instagram](https://www.instagram.com/NWRRailways) [LinkedIn](https://www.linkedin.com/company/NWRRailways) [YouTube](https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCNWRRailways)

CENTRUM Corporate & Registered Office : Unit No. 801, Centrum House, CST Road, Vidyanageri Marg, Kalina Santacruz (East), Mumbai - 400098, CIN No. U65922MH2016PLC273826

POSSESSION NOTICE

(As per Appendix IV read with rule 8(1) and rule 8(2) of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002)

Whereas, the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Centrum Housing Finance Ltd under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002 and in exercise of powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. Demand Notice(s) issued by the Authorised Officer of the company to the Borrower(s) / Co-Borrower(s) mentioned herein below to repay the outstanding amount mentioned in the notice along with contractual interest, penal interest, charges, costs etc. within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice, the borrower having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s) / Co-Borrower(s) / Guarantor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken **Possession** of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of Centrum Housing Finance Ltd for an amount of along with the contractual interest thereon and penal interest, charges, costs etc.

The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets

Sr No	Loan Account No./ Name Of The Borrower(S)/ Co-Borrower(S)	Description of secured assets (Immovable property)	Date of Demand Notice & Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.)	Possession Taken Date
1	MTCSR22009741 Gaurav Kumar / Arti Suraj / Suraj Mal	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel of Immovable Property Bearing Residential Building situated at Part of Plot No.13, Kh. No. 194, admn. 61.01 sqmts Wake Noorpur, Berun Hadud (Maharana Pratap Colony), Pargana & Tehsil-Deoband, Distt.- Saharanpur-247001,Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : Plot of Sushil West : Remaining plot of seller North : Prop. of sugar mill South : 20 wide Road	01-Oct-25 / Rs. 3,67,378/- (Rupees Three lakh Sixty Seven Thousand Three Hundred Seventy Eight Only)	19-05-2026
2	MTCSR23013069 UPDESH KUMAR / Komal Devi	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel Of Immovable Property Situated at Kharsa No. 60 M, admn. 310.06 sqmts., Wake Abadi Gram Muradkheri Pargana Tehsil Nakur, Distt. Saharanpur-247340, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : Plot of Donar Nitin Kumar West : H/o Vinod Kumar North : Rasta 10ft wide South :Plot of Donar Nitin Kumar South : Rasta 30' wide	07-May-25 / Rs. 11,87,551/- (Rupees Eleven lakh Eighty Seven thousand Five Hundred Fifty One Only)	20-05-2026
3	MTCSR23013213 Sachin Kumar / Poonam Devi / Roshan Lal / Sidharth Kumar	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel Of Immovable Property Bearing House No. 2037, admn. 165.7 sqmts., Wake Mohalla Afganane East Sarsawa, Tehsil -Nakur, Distt. Saharanpur-247232, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : Pvt. Rasta & H/o Chanduram West : H/o Pratap North : 8 wide Rasta South : H/o Kaluram	05-Sep-25 / Rs. 19,57,738/- (Rupees Nineteen lakh Fifty Seven Thousand Seven Hundred Thirty Eight Only)	20-05-2026
4	MTCSR24014718 Mahafiz Singh / Suresho Devi / Vishal Kumar	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel Of Immovable Property Bearing Kh. No. 177, admn. 478.75 sqmts., Village Maynagar Fugana, Pargana Nagal, Tehsil- Deoband, Distt. Saharanpur-247551, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : H/o Sanjay West : H/o Azad North : Property of Donar South : Rasta 30' wide	05-Sep-25 / Rs. 4,67,638 /- (Rupees Four lakh Eighty Seven Thousand Six Hundred Thirty Eight Only)	21-05-2026
5	MTCSR23012225 Yudhisther Singh / Suman Devi / Santosh Devi	In The Rights, Piece And Parcel Of Immovable Property Bearing Kh. No. 698, admn. 149.46 sqmts., Gram Shabbirpur Mushthakam, Pargana Deoband, Tehsil Rampur Maniharan, Distt. Saharanpur-247452, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East : H/o Karan Singh West : H/o Sutesh North : H/o Anun Kumar South : Rasta 15' wide	01-Oct-25 / Rs. 6,01,445/- (Rupees Six lakh One Thousand Four Hundred Forty Five Only)	19-05-2026

Date : 23.05.2026 / Place : Meerut (Uttar Pradesh)

Sd/-, Authorised Officer, For Centrum Housing Finance Ltd

85-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27

Electrical work in connection with "Augmentation of infrastructural facilities renovation and allied works to improve maintenance facilities at Various Outlets location under Electrical RSO DLI (at ANVT, NDLS, GZB, DLI Main & TKD)

Name of work and its location :-

Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi, 110055

Approx. cost of the works in :-

Rs. 5614097.00/-

Address of the office :-

Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi, 110055

Earnest Money :-

Rs. 112300.00/-

Last Date & time of submission of tender :-

15/06/2026, 16.00 Hrs.

Opening of tender :-

15/06/2026, 16.00 Hrs.

Website & notice board :-

www.lreps.gov.in & Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi, 1741/2026

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कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

बागमती प्रमण्डल, सीतामढ़ी।

(Email- eebd1s@gmail.com)

अल्पकालीन कोटेशन आमंत्रण सूचना सं0 02/2026-27

सेवा प्रदाता से टेंडर के साथ पोर्टेबल जेनरेटर जोड़कर लाईट के साथ बाढ़ अवधि 2026 के दौरान तटबंध की सुरक्षा हेतु अल्पकालीन कोटेशन आमंत्रित की जाती है जिसका उपयोग विभिन्न अति आकाम्य, अति संवेदनशील स्थलों पर आवश्यकतानुसार जरूरत पड़ने पर खाली बैग, नायलॉन कंट, खाली जियो बैग, बालु गिट्टी इत्यादि के साथ मजदूरों को रखकर क्षेत्रान्तर्गत ले जाने एवं वहाँ आवश्यक कार्य करने हेतु 24 घंटे तैयार रहना होगा एवं निर्देशानुसार कार्यस्थल पर तत्क्षण प्रस्थान करेगा। टैंडर, जेनरेटर एवं हैलोजन निम्न प्रकार होना चाहिए-

1. विवरण:-

(क) टैंडर- 35 HP का च्यूनतम

(ख) पोर्टेबल जेनरेटर- 02 K.V.

(ग) हैलोजन- कार्य के लिए पर्याप्त रोशनी होनी चाहिए कम-से-कम 500 Watt का 04 अद्द, एवं प्रत्येक रोशनी हेतु 30 मीटर लम्बाई की तार सहित।

सेवा प्रदाता से आईडिल अवधि एवं कार्यकारी अवधि के दर की अपेक्षा की जाती है।

(अ) आईडिल दर-

(ब) कार्यकारी दर-

2. अल्पकालीन कोटेशन प्राप्ति की तिथि:- 01.06.2026 से 06.06.2026 समय अपराह्न 03:00 बजे तक।

3. अल्पकालीन कोटेशन प्राप्ति का स्थान:- कार्यपालक अभियंता, बागमती प्रमंडल, सीतामढ़ी /अधीक्षण अभियंता, बाढ़ नियंत्रण अंचल, सीतामढ़ी।

4. अल्पकालीन कोटेशन खोलने की तिथि एवं समय:- दिनांक 06.06.2026 अपराह्न 03:30 बजे।

5. विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु अयोहरताक्षरी के सूचना पट्ट एवं कार्यालय कक्ष में सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

विरुत्त जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर देखी जा सकती है।

PR- 003972 (W R D) 2026-27

कार्यपालक अभियंता

बागमती प्रमण्डल, सीतामढ़ी।

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

AXIS FINANCE

(CIN U59521MH1995PLC212675)

Axis House, C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025

Under Section 13 (2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules"). Whereas the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Axis Finance Limited (AFL) under the Act and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Rules already issued detailed Demand Notice dated below under Section 13(2) of the Act, calling upon the Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) (all singularly or together referred to "Obligors")/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) listed hereunder, to pay the amount mentioned in the respective Demand Notice, within 60 days from the date of the respective Notice, as per details given below. Copies of the said Notices are served by Registered Post A.D. and are available with the undersigned, and the said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s), may, if they so desire, collect the respective copy from the undersigned on any working day during normal office hours.

In connection with the above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Obligor(s) /Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) to pay to AFL, within 60 days from the date of the respective Notice/s, the amount indicated herein below against their respective names, together with further interest as detailed below from the respective dates mentioned below in column (d) till the date of payment and / or realization, read with the loan agreement and other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Obligor(s). As security for due repayment of the loan, the following Secured Asset(s) have been mortgaged to AFL by the said Obligor(s) respectively.

Sr. No	Loan Account No.	Name of Obligor(s)/ Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s)	Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.) as on below date	Date of Demand Notice	date of NPA
1	0456MMA00013354	Rakesh Gulati, Gulati Sales Corporation, Usha Gulati Kumar	INR 1,47,06,786/- (Rupees One Crore Forty Seven Lakh Six Thousand Seven Hundred And Eighty Six Only) due as on 05 th May, 2026	19.05.2026	06.05.2026

PROPERTY NO. 10 – A, UPPER GROUND FLOOR, KHASRA NO. 29/25, 33/10, 33/2, 33/1, 34/5, 34/6, 30/22, 30/21, GAGAN VIHAR EXTENSION, VILLAGE KHUREJI KHAS, ILLAWA SHAHDARA, DELHI – 110051 ADMESURING 1571 SQ. FT.

*with further interest, additional Interest at the rate as more particularly stated in respective Demand Notices dated mentioned above, incidental expenses, costs, charges etc incurred till the date of payment and/or realization. If the said Obligor(s) shall fail to make payment to AFL as aforesaid, then AFL shall proceed against the above Secured Asset(s)/Immovable Property (ies) under Section 13(4) of the said Act and the applicable Rules entirely at the risk of the said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) as to the costs and consequences. The said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) are prohibited under the said Act to transfer the aforesaid Secured Asset(s)/Immovable Property(ies), whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of AFL. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the Act or Rules made thereunder shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.

For Axis Finance Limited
Sd/-
Authorised Officer

Date:19.05.2026
Place: New Delhi

AXIS FINANCE

(CIN U59521MH1995PLC212675)

Axis House, C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025

Under Section 13 (2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 ("Act") read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 ("Rules"). Whereas the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Axis Finance Limited (AFL) under the Act and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Rules already issued detailed Demand Notice dated below under Section 13(2) of the Act, calling upon the Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/Guarantor(s) (all singularly or together referred to "Obligors")/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) listed hereunder, to pay the amount mentioned in the respective Demand Notice, within 60 days from the date of the respective Notice, as per details given below. Copies of the said Notices are served by Registered Post A.D. and are available with the undersigned, and the said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s), may, if they so desire, collect the respective copy from the undersigned on any working day during normal office hours.

In connection with the above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Obligor(s) /Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) to pay to AFL, within 60 days from the date of the respective Notice/s, the amount indicated herein below against their respective names, together with further interest as detailed below from the respective dates mentioned below in column (d) till the date of payment and / or realization, read with the loan agreement and other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Obligor(s). As security for due repayment of the loan, the following Secured Asset(s) have been mortgaged to AFL by the said Obligor(s) respectively.

Sr. No	Loan Account No.	Name of Obligor(s)/ Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s)	Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.) as on below date	Date of Demand Notice	date of NPA
1	0456MMA00014147 0456MMA00021045 0456MMA00018212	Sangam Education Society, Nahni Chander, Rajesh Kumar, Sunita Singh, Ramesh Kumar, Anil Kumar, Hardeep Kumar, Pawan Kumar 011@gmail.COM Mob: 9671999599	INR. 4,88,29,292/- (Rupees Four Crores Eighty Eight Lakhs Twenty Nine Thousand Two Hundred and Ninety Two Only) due as on 05 th May, 2026	19.05.2026	06.05.2026

ALL THE PIECE AND PARCEL OF LAND MEASURING 10 KANAL 6 MARLA COMPRISED IN ARAGI KEHWAT NO. 375 MIN KHATONI NO. 501 MIN KHASRA NO. 352/6(8-0) AND ARAGI KEHWAT NO. 1753 KHATONI NO. 2279, KHASRA NO. 352/14/2 (4-12) TOTAL 10 KANAL 6 MARLA SITUATED AT MAUJA TOSHAM TEHSIL AND DISTRICT BHIWANI, HARYANA – 127040.

*with further interest, additional Interest at the rate as more particularly stated in respective Demand Notices dated mentioned above, incidental expenses, costs, charges etc incurred till the date of payment and/or realization. If the said Obligor(s) shall fail to make payment to AFL as aforesaid, then AFL shall proceed against the above Secured Asset(s)/Immovable Property (ies) under Section 13(4) of the said Act and the applicable Rules entirely at the risk of the said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) as to the costs and consequences. The said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) are prohibited under the said Act to transfer the aforesaid Secured Asset(s)/Immovable Property(ies), whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of AFL. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the Act or Rules made thereunder shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.

For Axis Finance Limited
Sd/-
Authorised Officer

Date:19.05.2026
Place: Bhiwani, Haryana

GOVERNMENT OF HIMACHAL PADESH

PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT

NATIONAL HIGHWAYS PROJECTS

e-Procurement Notice

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING

No: PW/SE/NHCS/CTR (R) (NT) STMC at km. 0/00 to 23/00 -NH-305/ 2025-26- 601-06

Dated:-21-05-2026

1. The Superintending Engineer, National Highway Circle, HP,PWD, Shimla hereby invites Bid for Short Term Management Contract on NH-305 Sainj Lohri Aut Road between Km 0/00 to 23/00 in the state of Himachal Pradesh through e-tendering from experienced firms/organizations for Construction of works detailed in the table:-

Sr. No.	Name of work	Name of NH Division	Approximate value of work (exclusive of GST) (Rs.)	Bid Security (Rs.)	Cost of Document (Rs.)	Contract Duration (month)
1.	Short Term Management Contract (STMC) on NH-305 Sainj Lohri Aut Road, between Km 0/00 to 23/00 in the state of Himachal Pradesh)	NH Division Rampur	3,12,01,554/-	6,25,000/-	12000/-	12 Months

* The Estimated Project Cost is the Civil Cost exclusive of GSTand inclusive of all other taxes.

The period of availability of online bid/date and time of Pre-bid meeting/date and time of on-line bid submission and date and time of opening of bids are given below:-

Availability of tender on-line for bidders	Date and time of pre bid meeting	Start and end date and time for on-line submission of bid	Technical Bid	Financial Bid.
From 26-05-2026 (1800 Hrs. IST). To 25-06-2026 (1100 Hrs. IST)	05-06-2026 (1100 Hrs. IST)	05-06-2026 (1130 Hrs. IST) To 25-06-2026 (1100 Hrs. IST)	27-06-2026 (1130 Hrs. IST)	Date to be announced.

3. Bidding documents can be downloaded from the web site :https://procure.gov.in/procure/app the documents downloaded from the web site should not be tampered, and if any such tampering is detected before or after the opening of bids, the bidder shall be penalized and black listed. Please note that the Authority reserves the right to accept or reject all or any of the BID without assigning any reason whatsoever.

Other terms and conditions shall remain same as given in the bid document which can be seen on the web site.

Supertending Engineer, NH Circle, HPPWD, Shimla-04, Telephone:- 0177-2657551 | E-mail:- senb-seni.sps@nic.in

No. 0780/2026-2027/HP

AXIS FINANCE

(CIN U59521MH1995PLC212675)

Axis House, C-2, Wadia International Centre, Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025

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In connection with the above, Notice is hereby given, once again, to the said Obligor(s) /Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) to pay to AFL, within 60 days from the date of the respective Notice/s, the amount indicated herein below against their respective names, together with further interest as detailed below from the respective dates mentioned below in column (d) till the date of payment and / or realization, read with the loan agreement and other documents/writings, if any, executed by the said Obligor(s). As security for due repayment of the loan, the following Secured Asset(s) have been mortgaged to AFL by the said Obligor(s) respectively.

Sr. No	Loan Account No.	Name of Obligor(s)/ Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s)	Total Outstanding Dues (Rs.) as on below date	Date of Demand Notice	date of NPA
1	0456MMA00016890	Aqueel Monazir, Md. Zafir Akhtar	INR. 35,50,147/- (Rupees Thirty Five Lakh Fifty Thousand One Hundred and Forty Seven Only) due as on 05 th May, 2026	19.05.2026	06.05.2026

ALL THAT PIECE AND PARCEL OF LAND MEASURING ABOUT 1197 SQ. FT + 95 SQ. FT. TOTAL AREA = 1274 SQ. FT. MORE OR LESS, TOGETHER WITH TWO STORIED RESIDENTIAL BUILDING HAVING BUILT UP AREA 1536 SQ. FT (GROUND FLOOR 1116 SQ. FT. + FIRST FLOOR 420 SQ. FT.) BEARING M.S. PLOT NO. 1098 (PART) & 1100 (PART), SITUATED AT MOHALLA UMAR DARAZ LANE, LODIKATRA P.S. KHAJEKALA, WARD NO. 31, 63(NEW), 24(OLS), SHEET NO. 223, CIRCLE NO. 152, OLD HOLDING NO. 116/2, NEW HOLDING NO. 128, PROPERTY NO. 2021027, PATNA CITY, DISTRICT PATNA, BIHAR – 800008.

*with further interest, additional Interest at the rate as more particularly stated in respective Demand Notices dated mentioned above, incidental expenses, costs, charges etc incurred till the date of payment and/or realization. If the said Obligor(s) shall fail to make payment to AFL as aforesaid, then AFL shall proceed against the above Secured Asset(s)/Immovable Property (ies) under Section 13(4) of the said Act and the applicable Rules entirely at the risk of the said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) as to the costs and consequences. The said Obligor(s)/Legal Heir(s)/Legal Representative(s) are prohibited under the said Act to transfer the aforesaid Secured Asset(s)/Immovable Property(ies), whether by way of sale, lease or otherwise without the prior written consent of AFL. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the Act or Rules made thereunder shall be liable for imprisonment and/or penalty as provided under the Act.

For Axis Finance Limited
Sd/-
Authorised Officer

Date:19.05.2026
Place: Patna, Bihar

WHILST care is taken prior to acceptance of advertising copy, it is not possible to verify its contents. The Indian Express (P) Limited cannot be held responsible for such contents, nor for any loss or damage incurred as a result of transactions with companies, associations or individuals advertising in its newspapers or Publications. We therefore recommend that readers make necessary inquiries before sending any monies or entering into any agreements with advertisers or otherwise acting on an advertisement in any manner whatsoever.

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

बागमती प्रमण्डल, सीतामढ़ी।

(Email- eebd1s@gmail.com)

अल्पकालीन कोटेशन आमंत्रण सूचना सं0 02/2026-27

सेवा प्रदाता से टेंडर के साथ पोर्टेबल जेनरेटर जोड़कर लाईट के साथ बाढ़ अवधि 2026 के दौरान तटबंध की सुरक्षा हेतु अल्पकालीन कोटेशन आमंत्रित की जाती है जिसका उपयोग विभिन्न अति आकाम्य, अति संवेदनशील स्थलों पर आवश्यकतानुसार जरूरत पड़ने पर खाली बैग, नायलॉन कंट, खाली जियो बैग, बालु गिट्टी इत्यादि के साथ मजदूरों को रखकर क्षेत्रान्तर्गत ले जाने एवं वहाँ आवश्यक कार्य करने हेतु 24 घंटे तैयार रहना होगा एवं निर्देशानुसार कार्यस्थल पर तत्क्षण प्रस्थान करेगा। टैंडर, जेनरेटर एवं हैलोजन निम्न प्रकार होना चाहिए-

1. विवरण:-

(क) टैंडर- 35 HP का च्यूनतम

(ख) पोर्टेबल जेनरेटर- 02 K.V.

(ग) हैलोजन- कार्य के लिए पर्याप्त रोशनी होनी चाहिए कम-से-कम 500 Watt का 04 अद्द, एवं प्रत्येक रोशनी हेतु 30 मीटर लम्बाई की तार सहित।

सेवा प्रदाता से आईडिल अवधि एवं कार्यकारी अवधि के दर की अपेक्षा की जाती है।

(अ) आईडिल दर-

(ब) कार्यकारी दर-

2. अल्पकालीन कोटेशन प्राप्ति की तिथि:- 01.06.2026 से 06.06.2026 समय अपराह्न 03:00 बजे तक।

3. अल्पकालीन कोटेशन प्राप्ति का स्थान:- कार्यपालक अभियंता, बागमती प्रमंडल, सीतामढ़ी /अधीक्षण अभियंता, बाढ़ नियंत्रण अंचल, सीतामढ़ी।

4. अल्पकालीन कोटेशन खोलने की तिथि एवं समय:- दिनांक 06.06.2026 अपराह्न 03:30 बजे।

5. विशेष जानकारी प्राप्त करने हेतु अयोहरताक्षरी के सूचना पट्ट एवं कार्यालय कक्ष में सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

विरुत्त जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर देखी जा सकती है।

PR- 003972 (W R D) 2026-27

कार्यपालक अभियंता

बागमती प्रमण्डल, सीतामढ़ी।

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER

HEAD WORKS DIVISION, BIRPUR

Email id - eehwdbirpur@gmail.com Mobile no -7463889427

NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING

SHORT TENDER INVITATION NOTICE

NIQ – 02/2026-27

(Through e-Procurement mode Only www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

1. Details of work :-

Gr. No.	Name of work	Estimated cost (In ₹ Lakh)	Earnest Money (e-payment mode / Bank Guaranty) (In ₹ Lakh)	Cost of B.O.Q. Non- Refundable) (Payable only online mode) (In ₹)	Bid Processing Fee: Payable to Belton (Non-Refundable) (Payable only online mode) (In ₹)	Date of Completion
01	Supply, Installation & Training of Hydro-meteorological, Geo-technical instruments & Seismic instruments at Koshi Barrage under Head Works Division Birpur, Supaul	403.453	8.07	10000.00	As Per EPROC 2.0	Supply, Installation, Testing - 02 Month After LoA

02. Officer Inviting Tender : Executive Engineer, Head Works Division, Birpur. Email id - eehwdbirpur@gmail.com Mobile no -7463889427

03. Date of issue of Notice Inviting Tender : 21.05.2026

Date and time for Download/Upload of : From 01.06.2026 of 10.30 AM to 08.06.2026 of 3:00 PM (only on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

04. Tender Document (Bid) : 10.06.2026 at 2:00PM in the office of the Chief Engineer, Flood Control & Drainage, Water Resources Department, Birpur.

05. Time, Date and Place of Pre-Bid Meeting: 02.06.2026 at 2:00PM in the office of the Chief Engineer, Flood Control & Drainage, Water Resources Department, Birpur.

06. Time and Date of Opening of Technical Bid: 10.06.2026 at 3:30 P.M. (only on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

07. Time and Date of Opening of Financial Bid: Date will be announced later by the competent authority only on website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in

08. Place of Opening of Bids: Through website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in only

09. Period of Bid Validity: 120 Days.

Executive Engineer
Head Works Division, Birpur

PR- 003969 (WRD) 2026-27

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

बिहार सरकार

स्थानिक अभियंता का कार्यालय

भवन प्रमंडल, नई दिल्ली

अति-अल्पकालीन कोटेशन आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या 02/2026-27

बिहार भवन, बिहार निवास, चाणक्यपुरी नई दिल्ली हेतु निम्नलिखित कार्य के लिए बिहार राज्य अंतर्गत भवन प्रमंडल में कार्यरत चतुर्थ श्रेणी में निर्वाचित संवेदक बिहार लोक निर्माण विभाग में होने वाले कार्य के लिए मुहर बंद कोटेशन आमंत्रित की जाती है।

1. विज्ञापनदाता का नाम एवं पता :- स्थानिक अभियंता, भवन प्रमंडल, नई दिल्ली।

2. परिमाण विषय के बिंदु की तिथि :- 04-06-2026 (अपराह्न 1:00 बजे तक)

3. निविदा प्राप्त करने की तिथि एवं समय :- 05-06-2026 (अपराह्न 3:00 बजे तक)

4. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :- 05-06-2026 (अपराह्न 3:30 बजे तक)

5. परिमाण विषय बिंदु का स्थान : (1) स्थानिक अभियंता कार्यालय बिहार निवास चाणक्यपुरी, नई दिल्ली। (2) सहायक अभियंता कार्यालय बिहार सदन, द्वारका नई दिल्ली। (3) अधीक्षण अभियंता कार्यालय पश्चिम बिहार अंचल, भवन निर्माण विभाग बिहार पटना।

6. निविदा प्राप्ति का स्थान :-स्थानिक अभियंता कार्यालय, बिहार निवास चाणक्यपुरी, नई दिल्ली।

अधिक जानकारी हेतु अयोहरताक्षरी कार्यालय/सूचना पट्ट में संपर्क करेंगे स्थानिक अभियंता

PR. No. 003813 (BCD) 2026-27

विरुत्त जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

यौन जनित रोग छुपाओ नहीं ईलाज कराओ, खुद के साथ अपने जीवन साथी को भी सुरक्षित करें।

बिहार सरकार

बिहार शहरी आधारभूत संरचना विकास निगम लिमि

Bihar Urban Infrastructure Development Corporation Ltd.

(बिहार सरकार का उपक्रम)

परियोजना निदेशक का कार्यालय बुडको, नालन्दा।

E-mail : eebuidcobiharsharifnn@gmail.com Contact:- 9546703210

निविदा आमंत्रण की सूचना (ई-टेंडरिंग द्वारा www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in.)

निविदा संख्या- NIT No-39/2026-27/NALANDA

1. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम एवं पता :- परियोजना निदेशक, बुडको, नालन्दा।

2. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना निर्यत की तिथि :- दिनांक-20.05.2026

3. परिमाण विषय प्राप्त करने की तिथि एवं समय- दिनांक-05.06.2026 से दिनांक-19.06.2026 के 3:00 बजे तक (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

4. प्री बीड मीटिंग की तिथि एवं स्थान:- दिनांक-08.06.2026 समय 12:00 बजे स्थान:- परियोजना निदेशक, बुडको, नालन्दा।

5. संवेदक द्वारा निविदा अपलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि :- दिनांक-19.06.2026 समय 3:00 बजे तक (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

6. तकनीकी बीड खोलने की तिथि :- दिनांक-20.06.2026 समय 4:00 बजे

7. वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि:- तकनीकी बीड में सफल होने के उपरान्त निर्देशानुसार

8. कार्य की विवरणी-

क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (रु. में)	अंशुपन की राशि (online के माध्यम से) Website:- www.Eproc2.bihar.gov.in	परिमाण विषय का मूल्य (अप्रतिदंग) (online के माध्यम से) Website:- www.Eproc2.bihar.gov.in	Bid Processing fee (Through Online Payment हेतु प्रोसेसिंग शुल्क)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	वार्ड नं०-29 में खदकमोड़ से बरबीधा पब्लिक बस स्टैंड तक बढ़ा माला का निर्माण।	1,44,25,336.00	2,89,000.00	17,700.00	As per Beltron	6 माह
2	सोहरसराय चौक से पुर्व की ओर जाने वाला पथ में प्रायम से रचना नदी की शाखा पर पुल का निर्माण करते हुए खारामाज लोहगनी होले बिहार फ्लोड कंट्रोल एवं सड़क का निर्माण।	1,67,88,879.00	3,36,000.00	17,700.00	As per Beltron	6 माह
3	वार्ड नं०-08 में पटना रोडी रोड से हथियपुरा की ओर जाने वाली सड़क में ग्राम से हथियपुरा होले आशानगर लोहा पुल तक आवश्यकता अनुसार नाला व पीप लीड रोड पथ का निर्माण।	1,38,43,122.00	2,77,000.00	17,700.00	As per Beltron	6 माह

नोट:- Bidders Should submit Bid Processing fee thorough Online Payment as per Amount generated on Website www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in

9. विरुत्त निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना विभागीय वेबसाईट www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in अथवा state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar में देखा जा सकता है।

PR- 003893 (B & C) 2026-27

परियोजना निदेशक, बुडको, नालन्दा।

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।

DELHI BUILDING & OTHER CONSTRUCTION WORKERS WELFARE BOARD

GOVT. OF NCT OF DELHI

‘A’ WING, 7TH FLOOR, VIKAS BHAWAN-II, CIVIL LINES, DELHI-110054

Email id: bocwhq.delhi@gov.in Phone: 011-23813846, 23813773

NOTICE INVITING e-TENDER

RFP Reference No.: RFP/DBOCW/Kits/2025-26

(Tender ID: 2026_DBCWB_291547_1)

Delhi Building and Other Construction Workers’ Welfare Board (DBOCWW Board) invites online Request for Proposal (RFP) from eligible Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs) for “Supply of Summer Kits to Delhi Construction Workers under Labour Welfare Initiative”. The project involves procurement, packaging, transportation and distribution of Summer Kits to registered construction workers across Delhi.

The online bid submission process shall commence from 18.05.2026 and the last date for submission of proposals shall be 08.06.2026 up to 05:00 PM through the e-Procurement Portal of the Government of NCT of Delhi.

Interested eligible agencies may download the detailed RFP document from the e-Procurement Portal: <https://govtprocurement.delhi.gov.in>. The DBOCWW Board reserves or reject any or all bids without to the right accept assigning any reason whatsoever.

Sd/-
Secretary
Delhi Building and Other Construction Workers’ Welfare Board

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0067/26-27

epaper.indianexpress.com

INDIA'S PEAK POWER DEMAND HIT FRESH HIGHS OVER PAST FOUR DAYS

Grid strains to meet peak daytime power demand; govt says conserve

For the first time this summer, grid struggled to meet daytime peak electricity demand

Pratyush Deep
New Delhi, May 22

THE COUNTRY'S power grid struggled to fully meet peak daytime electricity demand for the first time during this summer, prompting the government on Friday to urge citizens to use electricity "wisely and judiciously".

The appeal comes amid reports of power cuts from several parts of the country as India recorded a peak daytime shortage of 188 megawatts (MW) for the first time this summer when electricity demand touched a record 270 gigawatts (GW) on Thursday, according to data from the Grid Controller of India (Grid India).

The shortfall was roughly equivalent to the peak electricity demand of a state like Manipur. But any slight mismatch in demand and supply can cause extreme strain on the system, leading to fluctuation in grid frequency and can risk grid stability.

Power cuts usually occur when demand exceeds supply of electricity and grid operators resort to load shedding.

Peak demand figures, whether daily or monthly, are largely statistical reference points, as they reflect the highest load recorded at any moment during a given period on a particular day, often for a brief duration.

Maximum temperatures ranged between 40°C and 47°C on Thursday across large parts of northwest, west and central India, as well as adjoining eastern and northern peninsular regions, and southeast coastal India, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said in its bulletin.

While power shortages have been a regular feature during the night, daytime supply has so far remained largely stable, aided by abundant solar generation.

"Although we are prepared to supply electricity as required, due to the intense summer, let us all try to use electricity wisely and judiciously," the power ministry said in a post on X, adding that electricity demand is rising sharply because of the ongoing heatwave conditions.



Night time strain

The strain on the power system has been significantly more acute after sunset, when solar generation drops sharply while cooling demand remains elevated.

Shortages were reported during night-time peak hours on all four days. On Thursday, night-time electricity demand touched a record 251 GW, with the country facing a shortfall of 2.5 GW, equivalent to the peak demand of a state like Jharkhand. On Wednesday, when the overall peak demand reached 265 GW and night-time demand again hit 251 GW, the grid recorded a shortage of 1.6

• POWER CRUNCH

POWER SHORTAGES have been a regular feature during the night, but daytime supply has so far remained largely stable, aided by abundant solar generation

THE STRAIN on the power system has been significantly more acute after sunset, when solar generation drops sharply while cooling demand remains elevated

THE SHORTFALL has also been exacerbated by outages at thermal power plants, which continue to form the backbone of India's night-time electricity supply

GW during night time peak hours. On Tuesday, when daily peak demand touched 260 GW, the night-time shortfall stood at around 698 MW.

Similarly, on Monday, when electricity demand reached 257 GW, the night-time shortage was about 1.3 GW.

Notably, on all four days, the daily peak demand was recorded during the afternoon between 3:40PM and 3:45PM — a period when solar generation remains high and helps support the grid. A similar pattern had emerged in April as well, when night-time power shortages had climbed to as

high as 5.4 GW, underscoring the growing challenge of meeting evening demand in an increasingly renewable-heavy power system.

Thermal power outages

The shortfall has also been exacerbated by outages at thermal power plants, which continue to form the backbone of India's night-time electricity supply. As of May 20, at least 23 GW of coal- and nuclear-based capacity was under forced outage, according to data from the Central Electricity Authority (CEA). Forced outages refer to unplanned disruptions caused by technical faults, equipment failures, or fuel constraints.

Experts maintain this highlights the growing need to expand firm baseload generation alongside large-scale deployment of energy storage systems as renewable energy capacity continues to rise rapidly.

Additions to baseload capacity have lagged far behind the pace of renewable energy deployment.

Between April 2025 and January 2026, India added around 43 GW of renewable energy capacity, while thermal capacity additions stood at only 16.5 GW between April 2023 and November 2025.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

FY26 gross FDI at record \$95 bn, but net inflows only \$7.7 bn: RBI data

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, May 22

INDIA SAW gross foreign direct investment (FDI) inflows rise to a new record high of \$94.53 billion in 2025-26, up 17% from the previous year, although the net figure was a mere \$7.65 billion, data released on Friday by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) showed.

At \$94.53 billion, the gross FDI inflows last year comfortably exceeded the previous record of \$84.84 billion posted in 2021-22. And while the net FDI inflow in 2025-26 was higher than the \$959 million received in 2024-25, it remains below previous years.

Net FDI is calculated after adjusting gross FDI for investments that are repatriated by foreign companies and overseas investments made by Indian companies. Despite record gross FDI inflows, the net figure has been low in the past two years due to foreign investors taking back money.

This repatriation can be in the form of profits, dividend, or sale of assets. Meanwhile, Indian companies have also invested more abroad.

In 2025-26, foreigners' repatriations stood at \$53.58 billion, up from \$51.49 billion in 2024-25 and \$44.47 billion in 2023-24. Meanwhile, overseas FDI by Indian companies rose to \$33.29 billion last year.

In 2024-25 and 2023-24, it was \$28.17 billion and \$16.68 billion, respectively.

The weak net FDI inflows have contributed to the ongoing pressure on the rupee's exchange rate, which came close to breaching 97-per-dollar earlier this week. It ended at 95.69 per dollar on Friday, appreciating sharply thanks to the RBI's interventions in the forex market. The rupee is down 5% since the war in West Asia started.

Data released on Friday showed the extent of the central bank's intervention in March was almost \$30 billion on a gross basis, the most since it sold \$46.65 billion in February 2025. In 2025-26 as a whole, the RBI sold \$195.38 billion of foreign currency on a gross basis, less than half the \$398.71 billion it had sold in 2024-25. However, in net terms, the RBI's forex sales in the last fiscal were to the tune of \$53.13 billion

as against \$34.51 billion in 2024-25. In addition, the central bank also intervened far more heavily in the forward market last year. The RBI's gross forex sales of \$29.6 billion in March was the highest in 13 months and occurred even as net FDI during the month was in positive territory for the second month running.

After net FDI inflows in February had surged to a near four-year high of \$4.44 billion — revised down from \$4.62 initially — following six consecutive months of net FDI outflows, March saw the net figure declining to \$1.57 billion, dragged down by a 31% month-on-month fall in gross FDI inflows to \$6.23 billion. Compared to the final month of 2024-25, gross FDI inflows in March were up 6%. Inflows had risen sharply in February on the back of global investor sentiment reversing in the wake of the signing of an interim trade deal between India and the US early that month, which eliminated the penal 25% tariff and reduced the reciprocal tariff to 18% from 25%.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

RBI'S STATE OF ECONOMY REPORT

Near term outlook clouded by supply side pressures

George Mathew
New Delhi, May 22

THE NEAR-TERM outlook for the economy is "somewhat clouded by supply side pressures" even as domestic demand continues to be the main driver of economic growth, the Reserve Bank of India said in its State of the Economy article.

The central bank noted that while headline inflation remains comfortably within its tolerance band, the pass-through of underlying cost pressures to domestic prices requires close and ongoing monitoring.

"The financial conditions, crude oil prices and capital flows continue to pose chal-

lenges to the external sector outlook," the report authored by RBI researchers and economists said. "Views expressed in this article are those of the authors and do not represent the views of the Reserve Bank of India," it said.

It said global economic conditions remained fragile, shaped by heightened geopolitical tensions, elevated energy costs and persistent uncertainty surrounding the growth and inflation outlook.

"The conflict in West Asia continued to exert pressure on commodity markets, global trade flows and supply chains, contributing to the volatility in financial markets," the article, published in the RBI Bulletin,

said. "India has entered this phase from a position of macroeconomic strength. Nevertheless, robust services exports, positive net FDI flows, foreign exchange reserve buffers and a number of proactive policy measures undertaken by the government and the Reserve Bank of India are likely to cushion the Indian economy against external headwinds," it said. It said the global economy continued to be shadowed by uncertainties in West Asia. Domestic economic activity exhibited resilience in April, with industrial and services sectors maintaining strength across several segments, the article said.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Why India is becoming 'egocentric' data hotspot

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, May 22

THE NEXT big raw material in the global artificial intelligence (AI) race may not be chips or compute power, but human actions themselves.

Across factories, warehouses, kitchens and retail floors in India, workers wearing head-mounted cameras are recording hundreds of thousands of hours of "egocentric" or first-person data that is increasingly being used to train robotics and embodied AI systems.

But as companies race to build smarter humanoid robots, concerns are mounting among workers that the very data they are helping create could eventually automate their own jobs. Egocentric data refers to video and sensor recordings captured from the perspective of the person performing a task.

Typically collected using cameras mounted on the head, chest or wrist, the footage shows exactly what a human worker sees while carrying out an activity — picking up an object, assembling components, navigating cluttered spaces or stocking shelves.

Unlike traditional robotics datasets captured from static third-person cameras, egocentric datasets are designed to mimic the visual viewpoint a robot itself would have during deployment.

For robotics firms, this first-person perspective is critical

because it captures fine-grained hand movements, object interactions and real-world environmental complexity that conventional video often misses.

Owing to cheap labour availability and weak worker protections, India is emerging as a hub for such data collection. The demand for it stems from the lack of point-of-view human data, a core challenge in robotics, which prevents them from being able to manipulate their systems in a similar way as humans.

Egocentric data reduces this gap by allowing AI systems to learn directly from the perspective they will later operate in.

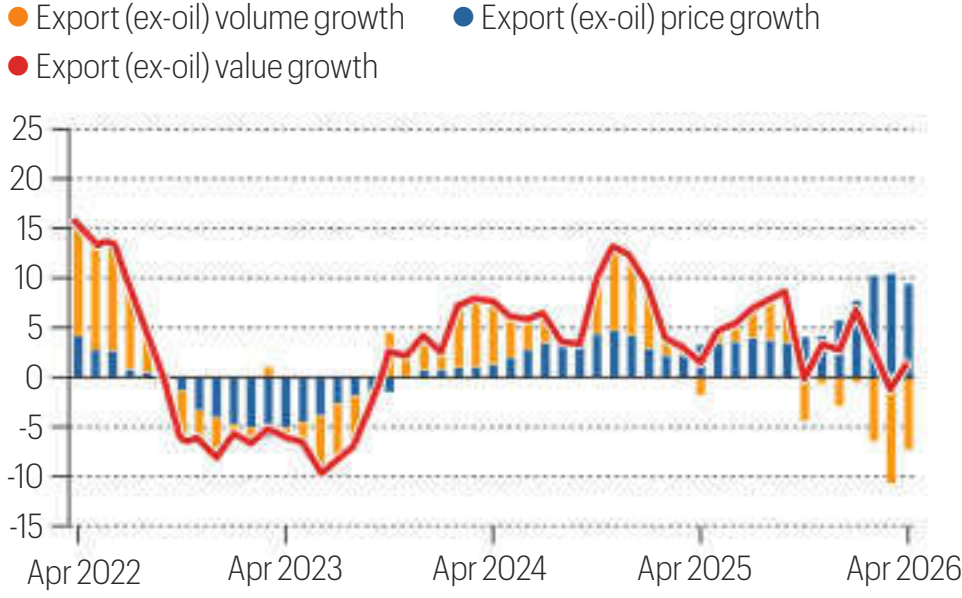
The datasets are particularly valuable for training Vision-Language-Action (VLA) models, which are AI systems that combine visual understanding, language instructions and physical movement. Such models are seen as foundational for future humanoid robots capable of performing household chores, warehouse operations and industrial assembly tasks.

As is the case with any training dataset, real-world diversity matters enormously. Controlled laboratory settings often fail to capture the unpredictability of actual workplaces, changing lighting conditions, cluttered spaces, interruptions and partial object visibility.

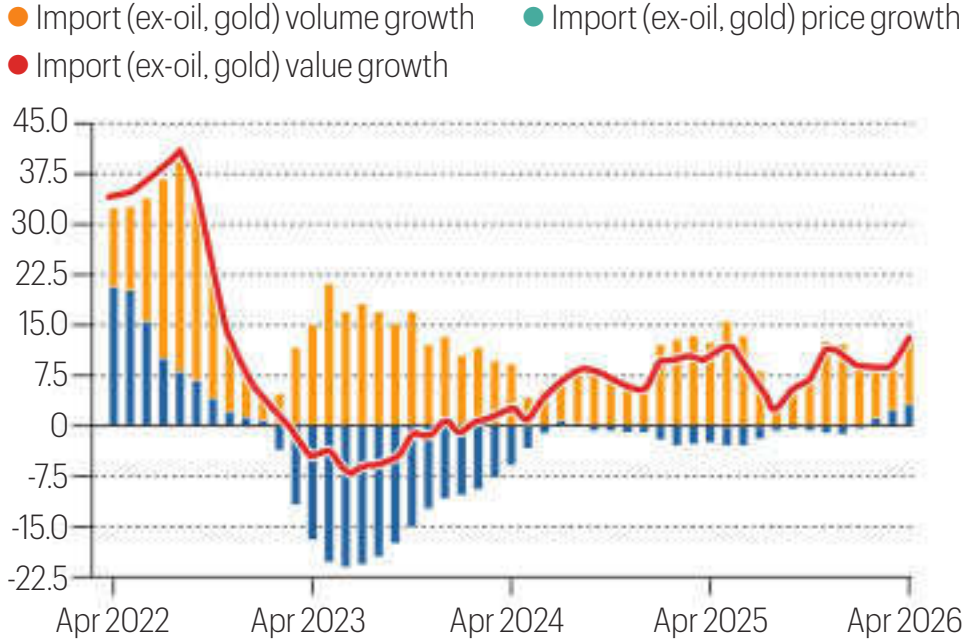
FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• Price or volume? What drove India's April trade deficit

Core export growth: price versus volume



Core import growth: price versus volume



India's trade deficit in April
\$28.38 billion

India's trade deficit widened to \$28.38 billion in April. While exports rose sharply by 14% in April, driven by a 40% upswing in electronics and 35% increase in petroleum products whose prices are on the rise because of the war, imports tell an interesting story. A rise in imports is generally seen as an indicator of strong domestic demand, and core imports (non-oil, non-gold imports) were 15% higher on account of both higher volumes as well as prices, although "price effects could be exaggerating the rise", Nomura economist said in a note. "It seems that the pick-up in core import growth has been primarily driven by consumer goods, particularly electronics, while investment/industrial goods growth continued to moderate," they added.

SOURCE: THE WORLD BANK, MINISTRY OF COMMERCE, CEIC, AND NOMURA GLOBAL ECONOMICS

RBI must hold rates, says ASSOCHAM

New Delhi: India is better placed to manage retail inflation among the top 10 economies, according to an analysis by industry lobby ASSOCHAM unveiled on Friday, amidst the ongoing disruptions caused by the West Asia conflict.

It further suggested the RBI to maintain the status quo on

the repo rate, while introducing liquidity, interest subvention, and moratorium support measures for export-oriented and energy-intensive MSMEs in the forthcoming review of monetary policy in early June.

India's inflation stood at 3.2% in February 2026 and rose to 3.5% in April 2026, a 0.3 per-

centage-point increase. This performance is better than the significant increase in the US, where inflation rose from 2.4% in February 2026 to 3.8% in April 2026, according to ASSOCHAM. "Inflation still prevails in the benign conditions, we suggest the RBI to maintain a status quo," it said. PTI

• CRITICS SAY ANY CORPORATE MAKE-UP THAT GIVES ONE CLASS OF INVESTORS MORE RIGHTS THAN OTHERS CONCENTRATES POWER IN THE HANDS OF A FEW

Meta to SpaceX: How dual-class shares keep founders in control

Reuters
Bengaluru, May 22

THE DUAL-CLASS share structure outlined in SpaceX's IPO filing, which grants CEO Elon Musk outsized control, has revived one of Wall Street's oldest debates — that of corporate governance.

While such structures are hardly unusual in corporate America, particularly among founder-led companies, few issues are so fiercely criticized by governance watchdogs.

Supporters argue visionary founders should be insulated from short-term market pressures, while critics warn that concentrating power in the hands of insiders weakens accountability.

For many investors, Musk's track record of building com-

panies and his enormous public following make the governance concerns feel like a price worth paying as long as returns follow.

Some others, however, have questioned whether Musk can devote sufficient time and focus to several of his high-profile ventures.

WHAT IS THE DUAL-CLASS SHARE STRUCTURE?

Simply put, shares are divided into two classes under this framework. One class gives its holders greater voting power than the other, and these high-vote shares are typically held by founders or insiders.

In SpaceX's case, Class B shares carry 10 votes per share, while Class A shares carry one



Supporters, however, argue visionary founders should be insulated from short-term market pressures. REUTERS

vote each. Musk will own a majority of the Class B shares after the share sale, giving him significant control over shareholder decisions.

Critics say "one share, one vote" is the cornerstone of shareholder democracy, and any cor-

porate make-up that gives one class of investors more rights than others, even if they hold the same number of shares, concentrates power in the hands of a few. "Over time, this founder-knows-best approach can entrench management and blind-

side executives to a need for change in strategy," according to the Council of Institutional Investors, a major investor group which has long fought against dual class shares.

A 2024 study published in the Harvard Law School Forum on Corporate Governance showed that on average companies in the Russell 3000 index with dual or multi-class share structures outperformed those with a single share class, over five and 10-year periods.

However, a separate paper from the European Corporate Governance Institute found that the valuation premium enjoyed by dual-class firms tends to diminish over time, with such companies trading at a discount to their single-class peers roughly seven to nine years after their IPOs.

DO INVESTORS CARE?

"Most investors have thrown out the idea that voting rights are valuable anymore," said Brian Jacobsen, chief economic strategist at Annex Wealth Management. Besides, for companies such as SpaceX that are built around a popular founder, investors may be even more willing to trade voting rights for exposure to the business. "Some investors may view that as a serious governance trade-off, while others may decide it is the price of access to one of the few companies with SpaceX's scale and positioning," said Lukas Muehlbauer, IPOX research associate. Google parent Alphabet, Meta Platforms and Berkshire Hathaway are among companies with two or more classes of shares.

• BRIEFLY

Sun Pharma net profit rises 26% in Q4FY26

New Delhi: Sun Pharma on Friday reported a 26.2% increase in consolidated net profit at Rs 2,714.03 crore in the fourth quarter of financial year 2026 (Q4FY26), on the back of strong formulation sales growth in India. The company has posted a consolidated net profit of Rs 2,149.88 crore in corresponding period of previous year, Sun Pharmaceutical Industries Ltd said in a regulatory filing. Total revenue from operations in Q4 stood at Rs 14,611.79 crore as against Rs 12,958.84 crore in the year-ago period, it added. PTI

Steel ministry pushes to end metallurgical coke tariffs

New Delhi: India's Ministry of Steel has asked the finance ministry to withdraw anti-dumping tariffs on low-ash metallur-

gical coke imports, citing inadequate domestic supplies and higher prices, according to a government document reviewed by Reuters. India, the second-largest crude steel producer, imposed a provisional anti-dumping duty on imports of low-ash metallurgical coke, known as met coke, in December. REUTERS

S&P flags pressure on Indian Oil Corp

New Delhi: S&P Global Ratings on Friday said state-owned Indian Oil Corporation (IOC) faces rising pressure to balance fuel affordability with profitability as prolonged tensions in West Asia increase crude oil prices and squeeze marketing margins. The ratings agency said disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz and elevated crude prices could widen the gap between domestic retail fuel prices and raw material costs, potentially hurting the IOC's earnings, cash flow and liquidity position over the next 12 months. REUTERS

• MARKETS

 Sensex 75,415.35 231.99 0.31%	 NIFTY 23,719.30 64.60 0.27%	 Gold ▼ ₹1,58,117	 US Dollar ▼ ₹95.69
		 Silver ▲ ₹2,66,000	 Oil ▲ \$109.31

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIAN BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF MAY 21, 2026

Shalini Langer

ROMANCE, THEY say, dies in the first chapter of marriage. In what passes for an “adult romance” in *Chand Mera Dil*, marriage dies in the first chapter of marriage.

Or, does it? You can’t be sure. Never mind their previous productions, director/co-writer Vivek Soni (*Meenakshi Sundareshwar*) and writers Tushar Paranjape (*Killa*), Akshat Ghildial (*Badhaai Do*) don’t seem to know where or whether they are coming or going in this one.

Their lead pair, untested in the adulting department, just don’t have it in them to steer through this mess.

Aarav (Lakshya) and Chandni (Panday) meet at an aesthete engineering college in Hyderabad. To attract her, he “twins”, that is, wears the same colours as her, every single day. When he doesn’t go further than that, she takes the initiative and, soon enough, they are a couple.

Chandni, in this film’s mixed-message imagination, can dance the classics, top her classes, seem engrossed in experiments in a lab coat, and be bold enough to take the lead in love and sex, and in deciding she wants to keep their baby, despite everyone’s objections. The boring, pastel *churidar* suits and Kolhapuris she wears at all times may be incongruous but, as you go on to realise, there is more where that comes from.

For example, take Aarav. He takes his shirt off to flex his six-pack with almost as much regularity as he takes out a pack to smoke, with cigarettes getting this much love (and for no particular reason) after a long time on screen. Aarav is, of course, a “topper” too, not just here in Hyderabad’s ‘Hy-Tech University’ but also at a college in Michigan, US, which is where the film starts, by way of telling us that his love story with Chandni has ended.

If *Chand Mera Dil* had stuck to one thing, it could still have made something of it, given at least the rarity of the story in Bollywood. Like being reluctantly thrust into fatherhood. Like pressures of parent-hood, and making ends meet. Like discord over child care. Like the fear of being left behind, in this case faced by the father, as his college mates bag lucrative placements. Like the intervention of parents when things go quickly south, only making



Shotgun Wedding is a Misfire

things worse. Like the baggage Chandni carries from the failed marriage of her own parents. Like sharing custody.

However, the Dharma Production is too squeamish about getting the hands of its lead pair dirty — from diapers to dishes to that big ‘d’ word, divorce. So just when they are hovering on the brink, *Chand Mera Dil* pulls back to bung in a soulful song that is as soulless as that next Insta picture — of which too there are several — or takes another of its quicksilver diversions. Trains and SRK’s arms-wide-open, Dharma’s other fallbacks, are also invoked.

CHAND MERA DIL

★★★

DIRECTOR: Vivek Soni

CAST: Ananya Pandey, Lakshya, Aastha Singh

So promising in his previous outings (*Kill, Ba***ds of Bollywood*), Lakshya sheds a copious amount of tears, and screams his heart out here but never really connects as either hopelessly in love or in despair, not the least because of an unclear dialogue delivery and the lacklustre chemistry between him and Panday.

She fares better, but only slightly, with the film putting the bigger weight of its contradictions on her frail frame. Panday struggles to balance it all, and it’s not just on account of the baby.

Coming to that, rarely have two parents

been so uncomfortable around their newborn. There appears to be little love lost there, and every time Lakshya is carrying their daughter, on trains, terraces or autos, you fear all the ways that things could go wrong.

Hyderabad, that city which rarely makes it to mainstream Bollywood, fares the best, with its wide streets, lavish greens and shiny complexes. Plus, it comes with frequent mentions of biryani, and at least one person speaking the distinctive Dakhani.

At least someone is having a honey-moon period.

•STREAMING WATCHLIST



The Boroughs

NETFLIX

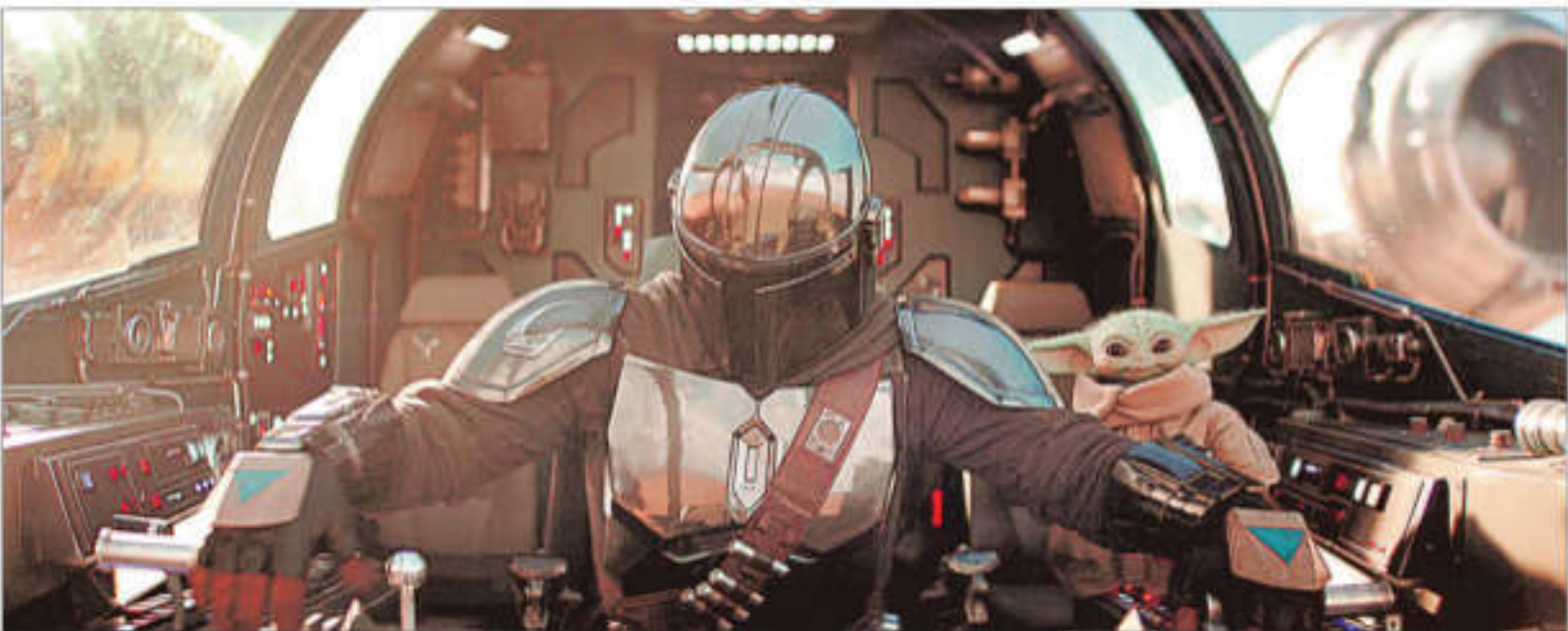
IN A seemingly perfect retirement community in the New Mexico desert, a grieving newcomer’s monstrous encounter inspires him to join a misfit crew of unlikely heroes who uncover a dark secret that proves their “golden years” are more dangerous, and they are more formidable than anyone expects. The cast features Alfred Molina, Geena Davis, Alfre Woodard, Clarke Peters and Bill Pullman, among others.



Jack Ryan: Ghost War

PRIME VIDEO

IN TOM Clancy’s *Jack Ryan: Ghost War*, Jack Ryan is reluctantly thrust back into the world of espionage when an international covert mission unravels a deadly conspiracy, forcing him to confront a rogue black-ops unit. Jack reunites with battle-tested CIA operative Mike November and former CIA boss James Greer, making this the most personal, high-stakes mission they have ever faced. The movie features John Krasinski, Wendell Pierce, Michael Kelly, Betty Gabriel and Abbie Cornish.



Yoda, Yoda, Yoda

Shalini Langer

JON FAVREAU has a knack for lending a certain levity to the most grave of things. In the *Star Wars* universe that is largely unnumbered by gravity, Favreau’s vision (he has also co-written the film) is unwaveringly and dourly solemn. But, rescued just in time by the effervescence of the being that is Grogu.

You can say there is a *Star Wars* link because the title says so, and the two main characters, the Mandalorian (Pedro Pascal) and Grogu (who is Baby Yoda), trace their origins back to that mammoth franchise. However, after dispensing with the topic of the Empire in the first few minutes, and the Rebellion in the next few, *The Mandalorian and Grogu*, which began life as a TV series, settles down to its own pace and narrative.

And, it’s a frenetic one. A warrior for hire, the Mandalorian has now sworn loyalty to the New Republic and its Colonel Ward (Sigourney Weaver). Accompanied by the tiny Grogu, wrapped in a monk-like oversized robe attesting to his wisdom and powers, Mandalorian travels the universe taking out the New Republic’s enemies as directed by Ward. From the get-go, Manda-

STAR WARS: THE MANDALORIAN AND GROGU

★★★

DIRECTOR: Jon Favreau

CAST: Pedro Pascal, Sigourney Weaver, Jonny Coyne, Voices of Jeremy Allen White, Martin Scorsese

lorian and Grogu are doing that, hopping planets and vanquishing hordes of enemy soldiers who cross their paths, with Mandalorian’s helmet with its shiny visor never moving an inch.

Hidden beneath that helmet, with his face unseen for almost the length of the film, Pascal is efficient and business-like, except when it comes to Grogu. The enemies whom the two — who are described as father and son more than once — do away with come in some really imaginative shapes and sizes, and wage battles everywhere from an arena to under water.

The most incredible are the Hutts, a sea-lion-like lumps of flesh and muscle — many sizes multiplied — who have been “head of criminal enterprises across the universe for hundreds of years”. One of them, Rotta (Jeremy Allen White), is described as a “beast” but turns out to have a heart of gold.

Mandalorian and Grogu are led to Rotta by a many-armed vendor (an unmissable Martin Scorsese, in a cameo).

The Mandalorian and Grogu really comes alive though when it takes a pause after Mandalorian gets injured and Grogu must look after and nurse him back to health. It is a surprisingly moving interlude, stripped of almost all dialogue, and driven solely by the expressive big eyes of Yoda.

A movie can be spun around this alone. But never mind. You can be sure they will be back.

She Says What He Said

Alaka Sahani

FIRST THINGS first. This comedy drama about a misogynistic corporate honcho being made to navigate sexist treatment and mindset when he finds himself in a set-up that is ruled by women is not new.

What adds spark to the remake of the French title, *I Am Not an Easy Man*, is the presence of Rosamund Pike as Alex Fox, a hardworking and talented executive who is picked as one of the company’s creative directors because it looks good for the optics.

Some minutes into the movie, things seem to have turned upside down. Sacha Baron Cohen, who plays Alex’s boss Damien Sachs, finds himself in a parallel world dominated by women. He struggles to adapt to this new world order, where he is objectified and not given opportunities to be heard. Somehow, being a man works as an impediment for him in getting promoted.

As the bro vibe is replaced in the movie with feminine toxicity, which can be equally discriminatory, Cohen grapples to find his place in this comedy.

Cohen plays a suave man with perfect biceps and looks dapper. But the *Borat* actor fails to make the misadventures of a man trapped in women’s world funny. Even when he is trying to entertain a predatory older woman at a high post by dressing up as a fetching cowboy, it does not get the laughs.

On the other hand, Pike, who has proven in David Fincher’s *Gone Girl* and *I Care a Lot* that she can be inscrutable, puts up an impressive act as his formidable adversary as they fight tooth and nail for the post of CEO.

While the performances of this impressive ensemble cast remain compelling,



Ladies First could have benefitted from some more lighter moments added to this battle-of-the-sexes drama.

The French original was written and directed by Éléonore Pourriat. This remake should have gone for some fresh approaches to look at how the patriarchal mindset is difficult to dislodge. The answer to this age-old problem can’t lie in making women behave exactly the same way men do.

The prevalence of patriarchy or misogyny can’t be countered by showcasing women as clones of men. It is also churlish to think that men will have a change of heart when they are subjected to the

similar sexist attitude that they are known to dole out.

Years after the Mel Gibson- and Helen Hunt-starrer *What Women Want* (2002) was released, such a wishful narrative about fixing gender-based discrimination at workplace should have factored in contemporary realities instead of packaging old wine (or, should we say Guinness) in a new bottle.



Goat

NETFLIX

THE TYREE Dillihay film follows Will, a small goat with big dreams, who gets a once-in-a-lifetime shot to join the pros and play roarball — a high-intensity, coded, full-contact sport dominated by the fastest, fiercest animals in the world. Will’s new teammates aren’t thrilled about having a goat on their roster but Will is determined to revolutionise the sport. It will stream from May 24.



Who's Your Gynac? S2

AMAZON MX PLAYER

THE SHOW returns with Saba Azad leading the cast as Dr Vidushi Kothari. Vidushi has taken the bold leap of opening

her own clinic. Between managing day-to-day operations, keeping up with the rent and quietly battling her own personal insecurities, Vidushi has her hands more than full. As always, it is her patients and her friends, Swara (Karishma Singh) and Mehr (Aaron Arjun Koul), who keep her anchored.

ALAKA SAHANI

When Convenience Trumps Conviction

Shubhra Gupta

SYSTEM IS a legal drama bookended by two women, separated by class but united in their zeal for justice. Neha Rajvansh (Sonakshi Sinha) may be a struggling public prosecutor (*sarkaari vakil*) but she comes from privilege. Her wealthy father (Ashutosh Gowariker) is a top defence lawyer and her brother (Adinath Kothare) is following in his footsteps: Dad wants his rebellious *beti* back where she belongs but she has to prove her mettle. If she wins 10 cases in a row, he declares, she will get entry into his hallowed chambers.

At the opposite end of the spectrum is the much-lower-on-pecking-order Sarika Rawat

SYSTEM ★★★

DIRECTOR: Ashwini Iyer Tiwari

CAST: Sonakshi Sinha, Jyotika, Ashutosh Gowariker, Adinath Kothare, Vijayant Kohli, Aatm Prakash Mishra

STREAMING ON: Prime Video

(Jyotika), a court reporter who has learnt enough law to be able to give tips to Neha, especially when she sees the latter fumble. Sarika has a husband who is a wheelchair user, and a school-going daughter, and she could do with a bit extra on the side, and so, the women come to an understanding. It’s pragmatic: Neha needs the help, and Sarika needs the money, so why should anyone have any



objections? The fact that it’s not exactly kosher is brushed under the carpet.

The strength of Iyer’s film is just this, showing the two women bent upon earning their living their way, and making their choices, right or wrong. The fact that they are sexually independent is also a plus: When Neha tells her lover that he makes her very happy, you are startled because this is not a statement one comes across in too many mainstream Hindi films. That Sarika has her own little physical fiddle on the side is also a surprise, especially because she handles the trysts in the most matter-of-fact of manner.

But the good things don’t last. Confusion arises soon enough when Neha, who seems perfectly happy trying her hand at defending people who do need help, as opposed to the wealthy who hide under the convenient loophole — it’s not just enough to be guilty but proven to be guilty beyond reasonable doubt — suddenly seems to want to be part of daddy’s camp. Whatever happened to the vaunted independence?

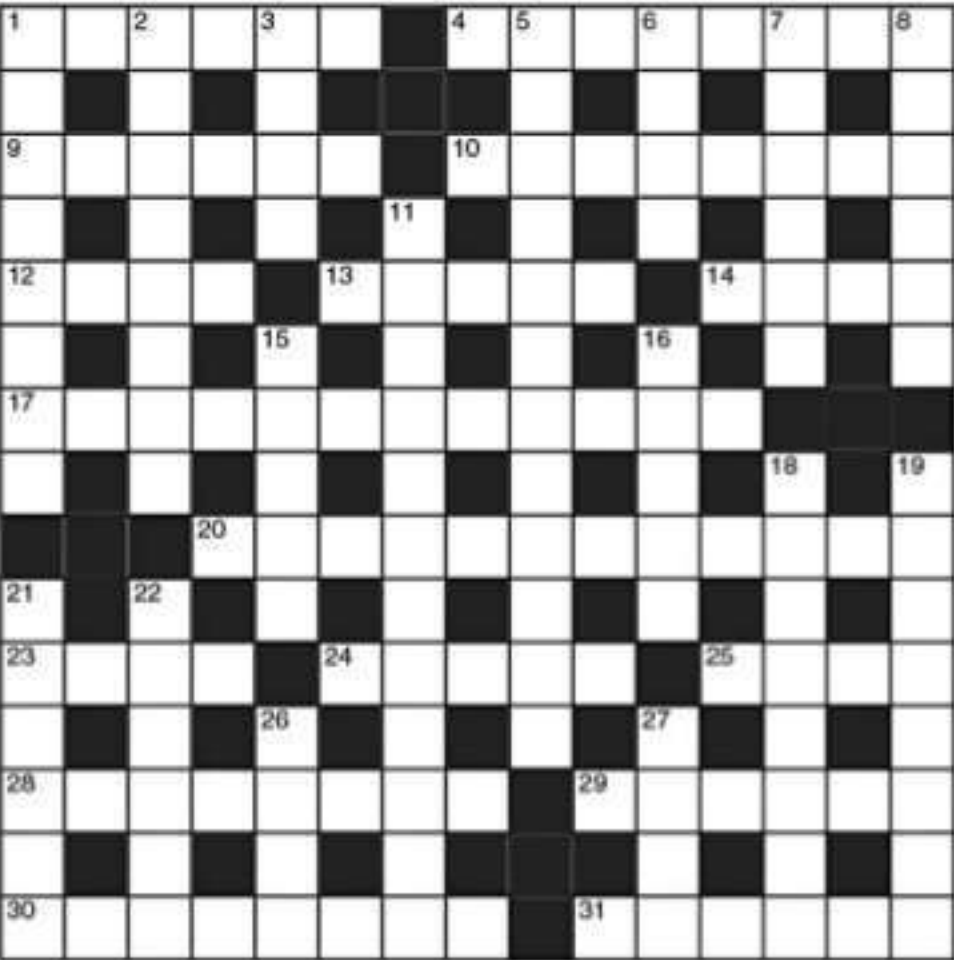
The cases also seem to be summarily

fought and disposed off, from a fire in a restaurant which claims an innocent life, to the murder of a famous influencer: it’s almost as if Neha is ticking off the numbers of cases just to be able to cross over to the other side, with a sidekick (Aatm Prakash Mishra, who had a lot to do in the *Criminal Justice* series) and is here reduced to delivering pointedly funny lines, which call attention to themselves.

And then, of course, when daddy’s rich builder pal (Vijayant Kohli) is in the dock, Neha goes off sleuthing — why do feisty female lawyers in Hindi movies wade into unknown territory without batting an eyelid? Not only do they jump into these spaces, they also come up triumphantly with answers. Old Delhi seems to be the only address for those who are struggling financially, in Bollywood’s imagination; rickshaws miraculously appear late in the night; and my pet peeve, homes invariably look like decorated sets.

The contrivances do not end here: The climactic confrontation, in which the killer is revealed, is nothing but an eye roll.

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS**
1 Season well (6)
4 A reminder to lay down Japanese wine (8)
9 Carry on with a summary (6)
10 Worked hard and cleared the grounds (8)
12 It flows out of line (4)
13 Firm support for a king maybe (5)
14 Leaf-destroying parasite (4)
17 Break up and scatter inside target (12)
20 Shows what a discontented group does (12)
23 The last word used by me in the article (4)
24 Golfer's slice? (5)
25 Facts obtained from the scoreboard at a match (4)
28 Directions on a ship for finding the coast (8)
29 Mother, can I possibly have a fruitcake? (6)
30 Accommodating countrywoman? (8)
31 Puzzle set in game (6)
- DOWN**
1 Night air coming through the window (8)
2 Uneasy when lacking support (8)
3 One is entitled to be called it (4)
5 Go-ahead to join low-key revolution (12)
6 Leap about the ring (4)
7 Records of non-U plants (6)
8 Create goodwill by being close to the listener (6)
11 Got up and blushed pink (4-8)
15 Some strangers give offence (5)
16 Begin spreading tar on the street (5)
18 Taking one drink laced with another (8)
19 Local ranch where Incas ate perhaps (8)
21 Holds back the Spanish girl (6)
22 Stay to check mother in (6)
26 Use the wrong sort of tackle perhaps (4)
27 Grass is classified as fine material (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 5995 **ACROSS:** 1 Muses, 4 Careful, 8 Sue, 9 Fortnight, 10 Enlarge, 11 Order, 13 Reward, 15 Unwary, 18 Dryad, 19 Mascara, 21 Reckoning, 23 Ian, 24 Spectre, 25 Sated **DOWN:** 1 Masseur, 2 Steal away, 3 So far, 4 Caries, 5 Run down, 6 Fog, 7 Later, 12 Dramatist, 14 Redcoat, 16 Yearned, 17 Empire, 18 Darts, 20 Signs, 22 Cue.

JUMBLLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Pain is no evil, unless it ___ us. - Charles Kingsley (8)

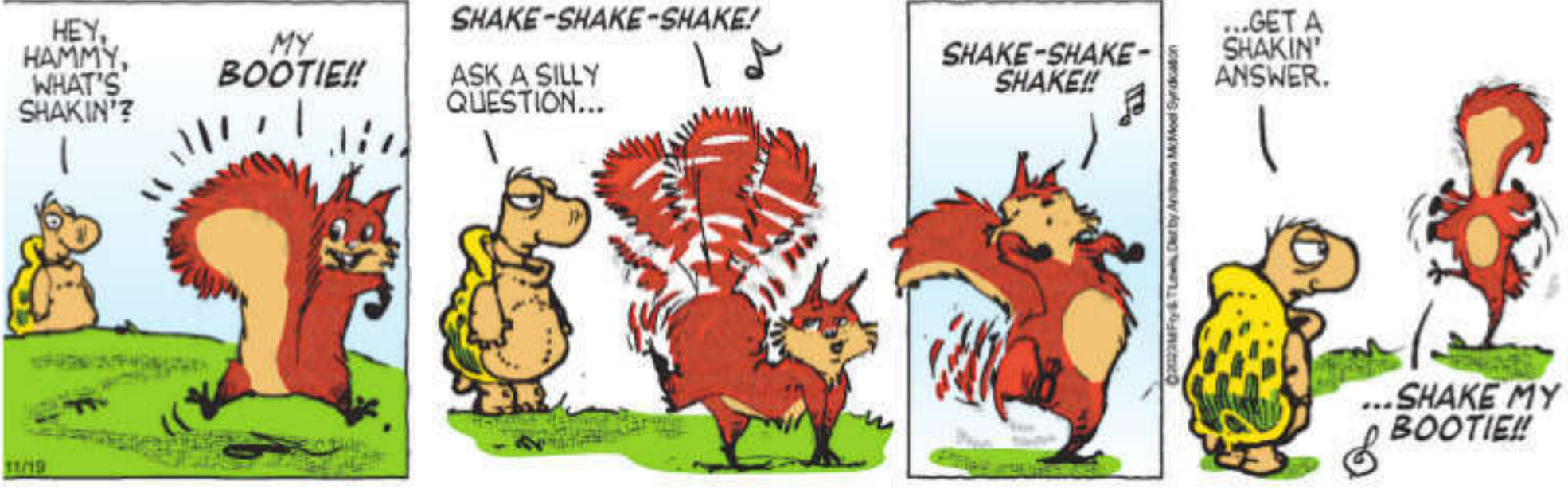
LPYER ACOTNU

POONS AELUCQ

ANSWER: Pain is no evil, unless it annoys us. - Charles Kingsley

NOTIONS: Reply, Snooty/Spoon, Toucan, Claque/Calque

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL
4s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6327

2								
	8				3	4		
			8	1	7		2	
9	3			4				
			9	7				
			2			7	3	
3	2	5	9					
	7	6				1		5

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6326

7	4	3	1	5	6	2	8	9
9	1	2	7	4	8	6	3	5
8	5	6	3	2	9	7	1	4
5	8	7	6	1	3	4	9	2
3	9	4	5	8	2	1	6	7
6	2	1	4	9	7	8	5	3
1	6	9	2	3	4	5	7	8
4	7	8	9	6	5	3	2	1
2	3	5	8	7	1	9	4	6

ROYAL STARS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Your confidence is strong today and you're ready to take action at work. You might take over a project or you might initiate something. You'll have no trouble expressing your ideas to others. You see that someone has to take the lead. Tonight: Work.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): This is a strong day for you. It's a wonderful day to socialise and enjoy the company of kids, as well as friends. Theatrical outings and get-togethers will appeal to you. Today in particular you appreciate the beauty of your daily surroundings. Tonight: Play.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): You might be keen to make improvements at home and start a new programme. The key might be to get others on board. Fortunately, you have the gift of gab. Tonight: Family discussions.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Although you're happy to take a backseat right now and be low-key, today you're full of clever ideas that you want to share with friends or perhaps a group or an organization. Speak up. People respect you now. (And you've earned it.) Tonight: Conversations.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): This is a popular time for you, and today you have some ideas related to money or something you own. Perhaps you have a moneymaking idea. Why not run it up the flagpole to see if anyone salutes? Tonight: Check your money.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Today the Moon is in your sign bouncing off a number of planet, but one of them is fiery Mars. You feel energised and proactive. You might want to make travel plans. You might want to talk to a someone in authority about a revolutionary new idea. Tonight: You win.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Behind-the-scenes research might reveal interesting data that will impress someone. It might relate to travel plans. You are keen to expand your horizons. Tonight: Enjoy your own company.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Today you will be vivacious and enthusiastic when dealing with friends. You might take charge and lead the way. Meanwhile, be patient with those who are closest to you; they could be annoying. Remember, patience is a virtue. Tonight: Be friendly.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Today your energy level is high and you might be keen to take on a new project or direct something. You might assume the role of leadership in part because you're radiating excitement. Tonight: You're admired.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Today you're full of enthusiasm to explore new ideas and meet interesting people. Fun outings will particularly appeal to you. Don't hesitate to explore new avenues that offer a change of pace. Why not? Tonight: Explore.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): In discussions about wills, inheritances, taxes, debt or anything to do with shared property, you'll have no trouble standing your ground. You feel confident. Fortunately, you are charming and fun-loving as well. Tonight: Check your finances.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): You might attract someone enthusiastic. Or perhaps you will be the enthusiastic person who bowls somebody else over. Discussions at home about repairs will be lively. Tonight: Cooperate.

Jharkhand BijliVitrان Nigam Limited
(CIN :U40108JH2013SGC001702)
O/o General Manager cum Chief Engineer, Ranchi Electric Supply Area
Kusal Colony, Doranda, Ranchi- 834002
Phone No. 0651-2490550 Fax No. 0651-2490670 E mail ID :- gm_rncjseb@yahoo.in

1ST TIME EXTENSION
1st Time extension for NIT No. 64/PR/JBVNL/2026-27 under ADP Head is as below :-
EXTENSION SCHEDULE OF DATES

1	Availability of tender document on website	From:- 07.05.2026 to 25.05.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs.
2	Last date and time for submitting e-tender	25.05.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs.
3	Last date and time of receipt of bid documents (Online)	25.05.2026 up to 14.00 Hrs.
4	Date and time of opening of tender (Techno-Commercial Cover) i.e Cover-I	26.05.2026 At 15.00Hrs..

1. Tender Time Extension Notice' is also available on our website : www.jbvnl.in
2. Tender Notice' is also available on our website : www.jbvnl.in
3. For any clarification please contact:- 0651-2490550 /9431135609
Note :- Our terms and conditions of NIT's will remain the same as duly available on website.

PR No. 379086
स्वाहित एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बढ़ाई। कृपया अपनी शिकायतों को टोल फ्री नं० 1800 345 6570 पर दर्ज कराई।

Sd/-
General Manager-Cum-Chief Engineer
ESA, Ranchi

PR 380512 Jharkhand Bijlee Vitrان Nigam Ltd(26-27).D

कार्यालय अभियंता, ग्रामीण यांत्रिकी सेवा
संभाग सूरजपुर, जिला-सूरजपुर (छत्तीसगढ़)
Phone: 07775-266048 E-Mail ID: ee-res.surajpur@gov.in

"निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना"

क्रमांक/783/वलेलि/ग्रा.या.से/2026-27 सूरजपुर दिनांक 20/05/2026

छत्तीसगढ़ के राज्यपाल की ओर से लोक निर्माण विभाग छत्तीसगढ़ में एकीकृत पंजीयन प्रणाली के अंतर्गत "डी" एवं उच्च श्रेणी में पंजीकृत सिविल ठेकेदारों से ग्रामीण यांत्रिकी सेवा के निम्नलिखित निर्माण कार्य हेतु प्रतिशत दर पर ऑनलाइन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है:-

क्र	कार्य का विवरण	अनुमानित लागत (रुपए लाख में)	निविदा डाउनलोड करने की अंतिम तिथि	अमानत राशि सच सखीयंत्र संधि एवं तकनीकी दस्तावेज खीड पोस्ट से जमा करने की तिथि
1	2	3	4	5
1	Zonal tender under Janpad Panchayat Odgi Gr-3, Ramanujanagar Gr-1, 3, 4 & Premnagar Gr-1, 2,4 Distt-Surajpur (C.G.)	100.00	25.05.2026 17:30 PM	26.05.2026 17:00 PM

उपरोक्त निर्माण कार्य की निविदा की सामान्य शर्तें, धरोहर राशि, विस्तृत निविदा विज्ञापि, निविदा दस्तावेज व अन्य जानकारी दिनांक 14.05.2026 से कार्यालयीन समय में उपस्थित होकर एवं विभागगी वेबसाईट https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in/ प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

कार्यालयन अभियंता
ग्रामीण यांत्रिकी सेवा,
संभाग सूरजपुर जिला-सूरजपुर

RO NO 262700900-6

Jharkhand Bijli Vitrان Nigam Limited
(CIN: U40108JH2013SGC001702)
Regd. Office: Engineering Building, H.E.C., Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004.
Telephone: 0651-2400799 & Fax: 0651-2400799
Website: https://www.jbvnl.co.in | Email: cecr2018@gmail.com

First extension of Expression of Interest (EOI) No. 62/JBVNL/2025-26

Jharkhand Bijli Vitrان Nigam Limited (JBVNL) hereby invitesFirst extension of Expression of Interest (EOI) from eligible wind power project developers for supply of 100 MW wind power on a long-term basis through a e tender bidding process, followed by reverse e-auction.

SL.No.	Details of Work
1	Jharkhand Bijli Vitrان Nigam Limited proposes to appoint vendors for the supply of wind power under a Short term/long-term arrangement. JBVNL shall enter into a Power Purchase Agreement (PPA) with the selected bidders for procurement of wind power. The tariff payable to the selected bidders shall remain fixed, as discovered through the e-bidding and reverse auction process conducted under this Request for Selection (R/S) guidelines.
2	Call ender Event:
3	Date of publication of EOI documents at website
4	Start Date and Time for rate submission (Online)
5	Last Date and Time for rate submission (Online)

The EOI documents with detailed conditions can be submitted toJBVNL official mail id.Email: cecr2018@gmail.com
Contact No-8809088144,9431523787

Sd/-
General Manager (Commercial)
JBVNL, Ranchi

PR NO. 379036
स्वाहित एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बढ़ाई। कृपया अपनी शिकायतों को 18003456570(टोल फ्री) पर दर्ज कराई।
PR.NO.380539 Jharkhand Bijlee Vitrان Nigam Ltd(26-27).D

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / END (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSM&E, ROHTAK	POG. HIGH PAST LIGHTING INSTALLATION, SERVICE LINE AND STREET LIGHT IN NVAH AT NUK	21.05.2026 28.05.2026	END Rs. 44,500/-	https://tenders.hry.nic.in	9862200811 serelectricta2025.harb@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 45512/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / END (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PRINCIPAL COMMITTEE, KALANUR	CONSTRUCTION OF FIVE PUBLIC TOILETS AT VARIOUS LOCATIONS IN PRINCIPAL COMMITTEE AREA UNDER SPN-2 D.D. AT PG KALANUR - 1 WORK	21.05.2026 01.06.2026	Rs. 75.58 LACS	https://tenders.hry.nic.in	9862200811 municipalcommitteekalanur@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 45516/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / END (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PT. B.D. SHARMA PGMS, ROHTAK	E TENDER FOR PURCHASE OF MEDICINES AT PGMS, ROHTAK PREBID MEETING WILL BE HELD ON 05.06.2026 AT 11:00 AM IN THE COMMITTEE ROOM, MEDICAL SUPERINTENDENT OFFICE, PGMS, ROHTAK	25.05.2026 25.06.2026	MENTIONED GROUP-WISE IN TENDER DOCUMENT	www.hhr.ac.in	9862200811 purchase.pgms@hhr.ac.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 45492/HRY

Himachal Pradesh Public Works Department
"CORRIGENDUM"

The online e-tenders called vide this office letter No. PWH/HD/CB/T-1/2024-25-321-30 dated 17.04.2026 (RO No.0453/2026-24(Classified) and due for starting for downloading bid w.e.f. 15.05.2026 vide RO No.0522/2026-24 (Classified) at 09.30 AM & further corrigendum No.1246-53 dated 13.05.2026 for downloading w.e.f. 21.05.2026 vide RO No.0753/2026-27(Classified) at 09.30 AM is hereby extended as under due to administrative/technical reasons:-

Key Dates

S. No.	Description	Old Dates	Amended/new dates
1.	Date of online publication	21.05.2026 (09.30 AM)	01.06.2026 (09.30 AM)
2.	Documents download start and end date/time	21.05.2026 (09.30 AM) up to 27.05.2026 (10.30 AM)	01.06.2026 (09.30 AM) up to 06.06.2026 (10.30 AM)
3.	Bid submission start and end date/time	21.05.2026 (09.30 AM) up to 27.05.2026 (10.30 AM)	01.06.2026 (09.30 AM) up to 06.06.2026 (10.30 AM)
4.	Date of Technical Bid opening	21.05.2026 (11.00 AM)	06.06.2026 (11.00 AM)

Other terms and conditions of the tenders shall remain unchanged.

Executive Engineer,
HPPWD Division, Haroli,
Distt.Una HP,
No. 0777/HP
Dated:-21.05.2026

कार्यालय-कार्यपालक अभियंता, एन०आर०ई०पी०, साहेबगंज
ई०-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना
अति अल्पकालीन ई०-निविदा संख्या-04 / 2026-27 / NREP/Sahibganj

क्र०	आईडेंटिफिकेशन संख्या	योजना का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख में)	अयकन की राशि (लाख में)	निविदा शुल्क	कार्य समाप्ति की तिथि
1	NREP/Sahibganj /01/2026-27	Construction of Road from NH-80 Madansahi to Sakrigali Road, Part-A START CH-208.40 to 210.30 km Length 1.900 Km	4,49,68,300.00	9,00,000.00	10000	12 माह
2	NREP/Sahibganj /02/2026-27	Construction of Road from NH-80 Madansahi to Sakrigali Road, Part-B START CH-210.30 to 212.20 km Length 1.900 Km	4,49,18,200.00	9,00,000.00	10000	12 माह

- वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि- 29.05.2026
- ई-निविदा प्रक्रिया की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय :-05.06.2026 अपराहन 05.00 बजे तक।
- निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय - 07.06.2026 अपराहन 3.00 बजे।
- केवल ई-निविदा ही स्वीकार की जायेगी।
- ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग एवं पथ निर्माण विभाग के समुचित श्रेणी के संवेदक ही निविदा में भाग लेंगे।
- निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियन्ता, एन०आर०ई०पी०, साहेबगंज।
- निविदा संबंधी जानकारी विशेष जानकारी हेतु मोबाइल नं०-7870217090 पर कार्यालय अवधि में सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है। विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाईट <https://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
एन०आर०ई०पी०
साहेबगंज

PR 380449 NREP (26-27).D
epaper.indianexpress.com

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE
Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawans on their Balidan Diwas.

 INSPECTOR KRISHAN KUMAR JHA 25.11.1966 – 23.05.2004	 ASSISTANT SUB INSPECTOR RAVINDER KUMAR 05.07.1968– 23.05.2022	 HEAD CONSTABLE ACHINTA KUMAR SIL 11.07.1954 – 23.05.1995	 HEAD CONSTABLE RAMCHARAN DWIVEDI 05.12.1960 – 23.05.2004
 HEAD CONSTABLE BARUN KUMAR SARKAR 10.06.1963 – 23.05.2004	 HEAD CONSTABLE /DRIVER MATHAN SINGH MARTIYED ON 23.05.2004		
 CONSTABLE HARENDRA RAM 18.08.1979 – 23.05.2004	 CONSTABLE HANUMANT APPA K 21.10.1983 – 23.05.2004	 CONSTABLE CHOUHAN CHIRAG KUMAR 21.10.1983 – 23.05.2004	 HEAD CONSTABLE HOSHIYAR SINGH 28.02.1957 – 23.05.2004

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

 Veer Balidani Shri I. S. Dagar Dy SP 38 Bn 01-03-1949 To 23-05-1982	DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Dy SP (Asstt. Comdt.) Shri I. S. Dagar of 38 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating insurgents during an operation near village Bhuvan, Mizoram on 23 May 1982. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.
 Veer Balidani Lance Naik Shailender Singh 62 Bn 11-11-1962 To 23-05-1997	DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Lance Naik Shailender Singh of 62 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating insurgents during a combing operation in Assam on 23 May 1997. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.
 Veer Balidani Constable Deepak Sharma 138 Bn 25-01-1980 To 23-05-2005	DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to four bravehearts of 138 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an operation in district Bastar, Chhattisgarh on 23 May 2005. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.
 Veer Balidani Constable Vijay Pratap 138 Bn 20-03-1982 To 23-05-2005	
 Veer Balidani Constable Soyal Rana Mondal 138 Bn 10-02-1983 To 23-05-2005	
 Veer Balidani Constable Mortate Vilas Piraji 138 Bn 08-10-1976 To 23-05-2005	



LATUR

Where it all started: Junior colleges

AROUND 9 am at Udyog Bhavan in Latur city, small groups of students carrying spiral-bound notes walk past giant banners, counselling offices and hostel buildings.

This is the city's 'Tuition Area', the coaching hub that's sold as the starting block for the race of a lifetime: a seat in one of the premier engineering and medical colleges in the country. Now, in the midst of one of the worst scandals to rock the town — the paper leak of the National Eligibility and Entrance Test or NEET exam for entry into medical colleges — the race stands disrupted. For the first time since NEET began in 2016, the exam had to be cancelled and rescheduled.

The probe took the CBI investigators from Sikar, where the case first unravelled, to Latur, which is emerging as a key node in the scandal. So far, two of the 10 arrested are from Latur — Shivraj Maotegaonkar, the founder of a coaching institute, and retired chemistry lecturer Pralhad Kulkarni.

But as is evident in Latur, it won't be long before the coaching hub gets back on track.

May, the period after the NEET examinations, is usually a quieter period in the city. This time, though, some institutes have resumed classes for ReNEET, the re-examination scheduled for June 21. As parents and students make enquiries for the next academic cycle, one prominent absence stands out — the building of 'RCC Classes', once among the busiest centres in the area, is now shut following the arrest of founder Motegaonkar.

Yet, the ecosystem in Latur continues to function. Mess kitchens remain active; hostels house "repeater students" and those attending ReNEET-related sessions; flex boards with all-India toppers and faculty advertisements hang across narrow lanes lined with stationery shops, libraries and food stalls. Through all this, the students move — some wearing black shirts with red collars, others in blue T-shirts with institute logos, their backpacks hanging from tired shoulders. Some walk towards giant coaching complexes promising NEET ranks and IIT success, others emerge from hostel buildings built over homes.

A success story

Unlike Rajasthan's Kota, which started as a coaching hub for competitive exams, Latur's story began in the 1970s and 80s, inside the classrooms of its old junior colleges such as Rajarshi Shahu College and Dayanand Science College. Here, teachers didn't tailor their teaching to the entrance exam system but were driven by something far more egalitarian — identifying poor students with promise and working on their fundamentals to prepare them for the Maharashtra Board exams.

This model, centred around repeated testing, revision sessions, close teacher monitoring and hostel-linked academic supervision, soon came to be known as 'Latur Pattern'.

The results began to show by the 1990s and early 2000s, when students from Latur began appearing on merit lists of Class 10 and 12 state Board examinations.

The district became particularly known for its science education, with students from rural Marathwada securing admissions into engineering and medical colleges.

Babruwan Kishanrao Gomsale counts himself as a product of that system. Gomsale, who later worked in engineering services at ONGC, says he had dropped out after Class 10 because his family could not afford his further education. "Then, one day, two teachers from Shahu College came looking for me in our village and took me to the college. I initially refused because we had no money. But they told me I could study under the 'earn and learn' system — stay at the college, do small jobs like preparing food for students, fetching water, etc. and study as well," he says. "Our teachers guided us continuously through tests, revision, counselling and personal mentoring."

Dr Sopan Jatal, who owns a hospital in Latur, recalls a similar experience. "The foundation of the Latur Pattern was not coaching classes. It was the culture of continuous study, discipline and personal attention created by schools and colleges," Jatal says.

But today, the 'Latur Pattern' stands at a crossroads, caught between its legacy of educational excellence and an aggressive coaching economy worth hundreds of crores.

NEET disrupted the pattern

The transformation started around 2000, coinciding with the rise of the state

The Big Picture

Latur & Sikar

A tale of two coaching cities

For years, two of India's largest coaching hubs have had students chasing coveted medical and engineering seats. Now, as the two towns find themselves linked by the NEET paper leak, VALLABH OZARKAR from Latur and HAMZA KHAN from Sikar track the economies built around the entrance-exam culture



Students leave a coaching institute in Sikar. HAMZA KHAN

SIKAR

From 'safer' alternative to the eye of NEET leak storm

AFTER COMPLETING his BTech from Kota's Engineering College in 1996, Shrawan Choudhary decided to launch Career Line Coaching (CLC) in Sikar.

As Sikar grew, so did CLC. In one of his interviews, Choudhary, speaking about what led him to start his institute in Sikar, said Kota's coaching industry was missing "parental care". "Sikar has people from rural backgrounds, *jo bacche kotok dete hain* (where they pull up a child). If a student comes late to his PG, the owner would pull him up, while Kota has a city culture," Choudhary said. CLC's tagline is '*Shiksha Sanskar, Suraksha, Safalta*', or 'education, culture, safety and success', where the road from education to success passes through culture and safety.

As more centres came up here over the next three decades, this culture of "individual care" became its most advertised USP, setting it apart from Kota, the other giant of India's coaching industry.

Now, as the NEET-UG leak controversy unfolds, Sikar finds itself at the centre of uncomfortable questions about its vast coaching machinery.

The emerging hub

Historically, the Shekhawati region was known for sending youth to the armed forces. Pradeep Budania from Sikar's Gurukripa coaching classes says there was a time "when a government job here meant a job in the Army". "First, families sent their children in droves to the Army. Then teaching came up and families pushed their children towards it," Budania says.

The region was also home to Marwari businessman and industrialist families who, wanting to give back to society, set up trusts to open educational institutions. Around the turn of the millennium, aspirations rose and families gravitated towards MBBS, and by the 2010s, Sikar had emerged as a coaching hub, powered by IITians who had gone

through the Kota system.

In 2018, the Maheshwari brothers-led Allen Group set up its 17th coaching centre in the city. Over the next few years, others followed — from Physics Wallah and Unacademy to Aakash Institute.

Soon, Sikar emerged as a cheaper alternative to Kota. According to Piyush Sunda, Director of Prince Career Pioneer, one of the early entrants in the town's coaching industry, the turning point came after 2020, when Kota reported a string of student suicides, and Sikar marketed itself as a safer learning destination for students.

The next milestone came in 2024, when the Supreme Court asked the National Testing Agency to publish centre-wise data. The data showed that Sikar had 27,216 students appearing for NEET in 2024 — almost the same as Kota's 27,118. When the final results came in, Sikar had 4,297 students scoring over 600 marks compared to Kota's 2,599; 2,037 scoring over 650 compared to Kota's 1,066; and 149 scoring over 700 against Kota's 74.

Even before this data catapulted Sikar into the limelight, coaching centre administrators claim the city had been outperforming Kota for the last 5-7 years. For proof, they cite NEET and JEE student numbers — 80,000 annually in Sikar compared to around 70,000 in Kota.

Institutes in Sikar cite factors such as their "personal touch", better access to teachers, attached hostels, monitored self-study, a less crowded environment and a cheaper fee structure as reasons for this.

At a state-of-the-art coaching centre with an attached hostel, students sit in classrooms till at least 10 pm under the watchful eyes of a teacher. "Even if a student is not keen to study but has to sit with a book, then usually they end up studying," says an administrator.

Students are insulated from the world outside. Mobile phones are disallowed; those wanting to make an audio call to their families can only use wall-mounted phones. Each student's code brings up two phone numbers and they can choose which one to call on.

On another wall nearby are similar wall-mounted phones, these with video-calling facilities. Calls are made in public. Vikram

Bhambu, 30, who runs a hostel for about 120 students, says students "spend only 10% of their time at the coaching centre, and the rest at the hostel. Parents don't want us to let them roam around." At his hostel too, students are permitted only basic keypad phones.

All of this, say institutes, sets them apart from Kota. "There is *mahaull* teaching in Kota... It's all atmospherics. Personalities are built around teachers. We have expressly told our teachers to stick to the course material and avoid making jokes," says a senior faculty member at a coaching centre.

Different city, same problems

While Sikar may market itself as a cheaper, more humane alternative to Kota, it is plagued by many of the same problems, though arguably on a smaller scale.

In September 2025, during a debate on the Bill to regulate coaching centres in the state, Deputy Chief Minister and Higher Education Minister Prem Chand Bairwa quoted data from the previous four years to say that of the 88 students who died by suicide in coaching centres, 70 were in Kota and 14 in Sikar.

The paper leak scam has raised more questions. In an interview after the leak, Allen co-founder and Director Brajesh Maheshwari said Sikar has "always been a suspicious centre". Alleging that private schools chosen as examination centres work hand in glove with coaching centres, he said: "There were no selections from here when it [Sikar] didn't have centres. I'm talking openly... Board exam papers and all kinds of papers used to be sold easily".

But coaching administrators in Sikar deny these allegations, citing NTA's 2024 data in their defence. The data shows that of the top 50 centres across India where students scored over 650 marks, 37 were in Sikar alone. "How can you influence all 37 centres?" asks Narendra Kok of Sikar's Matrix Academy.

To put these allegations to rest, the institutes want the NTA to release centre-wise data for the Re-NEET as well, pointing out that Sikar is where the 2026 leak was caught.

Those hit hardest by these events are the students, many of whom have had to return for the rescheduled NEET exam on June 21. At Vikram Bhambu's hostel, a dejected Sukhveer Singh, 20, from Ganganagar, says the recent NEET was his second attempt. "I was relaxing at home when news of the paper leak came in. It was shocking. I joined a library to study, but it wasn't working out. My parents told me to try once more," he says.

Sitting next to him, Narendra Kumar, 19, also from Ganganagar, says he did not want to return. "My first thought was: I will again have to lose sleep, go through the same books, the same process."



Latur's Rajarshi Shahu College has integrated Class 11 and 12 with NEET and JEE preparation. VALLABH OZARKAR

Around 10.30 pm on a weekday, as students and teachers sat in one of the classrooms on campus, poring over sample papers and worksheets, there is evidence of the older 'Latur Pattern' — continuous testing systems, CET-focused academic cells, hostel-linked mentoring and supervised study routines.

D K Deshmukh, coordinator of the CET Cell at Shahu College, says, "Our focus has never been only on marks. Teachers monitor students closely, repeatedly test concepts and build study-discipline."

A student, who spoke on condition of anonymity, says the institution's integrated system offers a different environment compared to the large coaching centres. "Here, we are continuously in touch with the teachers; there are no fixed timings. We live here and also study here. After the ReNEET announcement, teachers counselled and motivated us. They told us to treat the earlier exam as a mock test and prepare again with the same focus," she said.

Deshmukh says the college receives applications several times higher than its intake capacity of 2,100 students.

Gradually, a parallel structure emerged as students who failed to secure admission to the more prominent junior colleges opted for private coaching institutes. They would, on paper, take admission in a junior college while spending all their time preparing for NEET-JEE inside coaching institutes.

Like elsewhere in Kota and Sikar, it's a machine that has delivered results. In the first round of MBBS admissions in Maharashtra in 2025, 1,203 candidates were from Latur, the highest in the state.

A city built for students

Local educators estimate that around 40,000 students arrive in Latur every year for Class 11-12, NEET and JEE preparation.

Like Kota, entire neighbourhoods in Latur have reorganised themselves around coaching institutes and student housing. In several lanes of the Tuition Area, residential buildings have been partially or fully converted into student hostels that charge anywhere between Rs 25,000 and Rs 2 lakh annually per student. Local estimates place the annual turnover of Latur's student economy at over Rs 500 crore.

As the stakes expanded, so did the business of the coaching institutes. Many of them have expanded to provide hostels, mess facilities and other services centred around students.

It's an ecosystem marketed as "end-to-end service", but for students, this has meant a life that revolves almost entirely around ranks, mock tests and selection lists.

The students arrive here, from nearly every district of Maharashtra and neighbouring states, some as young as 12. They live in cramped hostels, away from their families, and are told to focus on a single goal — a seat in a medical or engineering college. Students attend classes from early morning till late evening, followed by compulsory study hours, and appear for weekly ranking tests.

Around 5.30 pm, a group of students crowd outside a fast food outlet in the Tuition Area. Many of them are from villages in Marathwada and are now back in Latur for ReNEET.

They talk about life back home and how cracking NEET seems like the only future they have — and the only one they know.

"Most of our families own agricultural land, but because of water scarcity, agriculture alone is not enough. That is why education is important for us," says one of them.

"Many people say coaching here is expensive, but compared to bigger cities, Latur is still affordable. I pay around Rs 60,000 a year, while in bigger cities, the fee is much higher. We all come from poor families, so all these things matter to us," says a student from Hingoli district. He pays Rs 25,000 annually as hostel fee. "Four of us stay in one room. Since all of us are preparing for NEET, we help each other with revision, studying and problem-solving," he says.

As evening falls, around them, giant NEET and IIT-JEE signboards, promising "100% success", begin glowing brighter.

Common Entrance Tests (CET) for admission to medical and engineering, followed by NEET and other NCERT-based entrance examinations that started in 2012-13.

"The teaching in junior colleges focused mostly on the Maharashtra Board examinations and the state CET, but NEET and JEE increasingly became NCERT-based and concept-oriented, with multiple choice questions. That gap created space for private coaching institutes. Until then, students here were not merely coached for examinations, they were shaped academically and personally," says Sachin Bangad, an educational counsellor in Latur.

Madhur Chitte, a resident of Latur who earlier ran a study room for students, says the city changed rapidly after 2000.

"Earlier, there were traditional subject-based tuitions. Students would go to separate teachers for specific subjects. Students would come to my study room to sit and study and we would counsel them," he says.

That changed, says Chitte, with a full-fledged organised coaching system taking

over, where everything from hostel accommodation to mess facilities are coordinated by the institute.

Latur's Rajarshi Shahu College, which once focused on the state Board exams, adapted to the change by integrating its Class 11 and 12 education with NEET and JEE preparation.

The Science wing of the college, with 1,200 students, is housed in a separate building. Students stay on campus and, after school hours, spend time on CET, NEET and JEE coaching.

MS will make a decision in best interest of team: Simons

Express News Service
Mumbai, May 22

CSK BOWLING coach Eric Simons left the door open for MS Dhoni's return in IPL 2027, while making it clear that the final call will rest entirely with the former captain himself.

Dhoni missed the entirety of IPL 2026, but Simons said the veteran wicketkeeper-batter looked sharp in training sessions and has been struck the ball as cleanly as ever in the nets. However, he stressed that Dhoni's comeback would depend on his own assessment of fitness and readiness.

"Are you seriously asking me that question? We always are. I mean, honestly, he has hit the ball so well. He obviously had a leg injury, which made it very difficult for him to run, so that's why he couldn't play. But in terms of hitting the ball in the nets, he's hitting it as well as I've ever seen him hit it. But I keep saying this, only MS will know, and MS will make the decision about when he's ready and when he's right. And I tell you what, if he knows he's not, he won't play. But if he is right, he will. He'll make the decision in the best interest of the team and not for himself as an individual. But it will be great to have him playing. It's been great just having him around the unit and being someone to tap into for knowledge and calmness," Simons said in the post-match presentation.

Simons reflected on the evolution of the team's identity over the course of the season and pointed to the performances of younger players like Kartik Sharma and Urvil Patel, adding that they had come a long way in knowing themselves as a group. "I think a lot of the positives come around the fact that we started getting an understanding of ourselves as a unit. I think that's an important part of winning an IPL, is that you get your balance right, and you have a side that can carry itself through, and your changes are made a long way before the game."

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ERIC SIMONS
CSK BOWLING COACH

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, May 22

SOMETIME LAST year, an India coach – a big name with close ties with the Chennai Super Kings (CSK) old-timers – explored the possibility of a coaching role with the five-time champions.

The timing seemed apt. The franchise had finished at the bottom, and all signs pointed to a major overhaul. Instead, he was told to wait.

Now that CSK has missed the play-off qualification for the third straight year, there is clamour for total revamp again. But the extent of it depends on the future of MS Dhoni, the club's face and heartbeat.

As long as he is around, coaches would remain hesitant to assume charges, fearing their powers would be curtailed. According to reliable sources, at least one interested candidate seemed convinced that until Dhoni is around, there is no way he will throw his hat in the ring. The coming weeks will give a clear picture.

This much is certain. The five-time champions are under immense pressure to ring in the changes. There is uncertainty over Stephen Fleming, who has been the coach since 2009. He revealed that the management

Now that CSK has missed the play-off qualification for the third straight year, there is clamour for total revamp again. But the extent of it depends on the future of MS Dhoni, the club's face and heartbeat.

would decide whether he leaves or not, and they haven't had a conversation yet.

But the bigger puzzle is around Dhoni's future. He missed all 14 games, the first time since the league's inception; the soul of the franchise came to the stadium just once—for the final home game. When CSK played their last league game in Ahmedabad, Dhoni was in Ranchi, carrying the suspense around his future with him. The question on Dhoni's future came up, after CSK suffered their worst-ever defeat, in Ahmedabad. "You and I will get to know it next year," captain Ruturaj Gaikwad would say.

The Kohli example

This suspense is doing no favours to anyone. What Dhoni decides from here should be irrelevant.

At 44, he has overstayed as a player. For a long time, as CSK's majority shareholder N Srinivasan once said, "CSK means Dhoni and Dhoni means CSK". But it has come to a point where they need to look

TIME FOR A REBOOT

CSK's biggest puzzle: Phasing out the face

The five-time champions owe their identity and stature to Dhoni but his uncertain future continues to put the IPL franchise's future plans on hold



MS Dhoni walks towards the dressing room after a parade in Chennai on Monday. CREIMAS/BCCI

beyond him. If he has a future at the franchise, it is as support staff, not as a player. Should they decide to look beyond Fleming, then they have to take a call on Dhoni and not leave it to the former captain himself.

The example is in Royal Challengers Bengaluru. After years of underachievement, when they wanted to start fresh, Andy Flower spoke to Virat Kohli and made him fit to the team's needs. RCB was not

going to fit into their most powerful player's needs.

At CSK, the story is opposite with Dhoni.

The word from within the camp is that since the 2025 season, Dhoni has detached himself from the planning and preparation.

This season was largely the same — until differences emerged over the use of Shivam Dube as a finisher. The left-hander's career kick-started at

CSK, where his six-hitting made him a valuable asset in India's twin T20 World Cup wins. Pushed into an unfamiliar finishing role, he managed fewer than the 21 sixes he hit last season. The numbers said what the dressing room could not.

When the squad assembled in the first week of March, there was optimism of at least making the playoffs. Having started building mid-way through last

season, there was genuine belief—Sanju Samson's arrival, a batting unit that showed intent. Instead, there was chaos. Three straight losses, a mini-recovery, another stutter, a comeback that promised something before the gas fizzled out.

Five players who would have been regulars were lost along the way, which did not help. But the problems ran deeper than injuries. Their six wins all came against teams that finished below them. Their defeats against the top three were all huge.

There are broader questions about Fleming, too. With the IPL increasingly dictated by Indian talent, his familiarity with India's domestic players outside the established names is limited to scout reports and videos. Last season, he flew to Chennai during the off-season for a week of trials — a genuine effort.

But Sakib Hussain, passed over, went to Sunrisers Hyderabad and thrived. He skipped Priyansh Arya, who found his feet at Punjab Kings. CSK went into the season without a single Indian frontline spinner, having not pursued Ravi Bishnoi at the auctions.

Gaikwad has not been able to assert himself either. Filling into the huge shoes of Dhoni,

With the IPL increasingly dictated by Indian talent, Stephen Fleming's familiarity with India's domestic players outside the established names is limited to scout reports and videos.

there is space behind his heel as well as wriggle room in front of his toes. IPL is not a three-month gig anymore. Other franchises have camps even in the off-season, and there is constant tracking across the year. The top-rung of CSK's support staff all happen to be overseas and they don't spend time in India during off-season. If local players need a camp, they only have Sridharan Sriram and Rajiv Kumar to turn to.

With Fleming still having plenty of admirers in the franchise management, he could be given a wider role — like using his expertise in the overseas leagues CSK run, the SA20 and MLC — and free him up for IPL to bring in an Indian coach.

With the MLC starting soon, there are indications that once it concludes, there will be a discussion about the way forward. Any new coach would need the off-season to prepare for the mini-auction, identify the core, and begin the longer rebuild that leads to the bigger auctions at the end of next season. So the quicker Dhoni decides, the better it is for the franchise.



Ram Babu first met Dhoni in 2013. EXPRESS

Dhoni's superfan says he will be heartbroken if his hero calls it a day

Tanishq Vaddi
Hyderabad, May 22

"JAB TAK Suraj chand rahega, Dhoni sir ka naam rahega (As long as the sun and moon exist, Dhoni sir's name will remain)." Ram Babu has been saying this for twenty years.

It was 11:37 on a chilly night in Dharamsala when Ram Babu met his 'bhagwan' for the first time. Seven years he had been attending matches to get to this moment. "I touched his feet, he held my hand and hugged me," Ram Babu recalled. "I didn't sleep at all that night. I felt like meeting Dhoni sir again and again."

From that night on, MS Dhoni began arranging match tickets for him.

Now, Ram Babu, like the rest of the CSK faithful is unsure if he will see his hero playing in yellow again. Injury and the need to keep a winning combination going saw Dhoni sit out of all CSK's games this season. Post the loss to Gujarat Titans on Thursday, CSK captain Ruturaj Gaikwad said there would be clarity on Dhoni's future only next year. "Bahut saal se tapasya mein hamara...bahut dukh hoga (After years of devotion, it will be sad if he does not play anymore)," Ram Babu said on Friday.

Ram Babu is from Mohali. He first saw Dhoni in 2004. It took three more years, three ICC trophies, and a nickname — Captain Cool — before something shifted. "He was so lucky for the Indian team," Ram Babu said. "He has won three ICC trophies for India. I loved him with all my heart."

He has been attending matches for over two decades now. Eleven months away from home every year. No steady job — a job would mean missed matches. "Sometimes I miss the deaths of my relatives," he said. "I am jobless. I can't do any job now. If I do a job, then I will not be able to watch the match. I have to leave a lot of things."

His mother never stopped asking, "Beta, what is this job? This is no job. You keep roaming around with the flag."

He kept roaming. "I feel very proud of it," he said. "The whole of India knows me because of MS Dhoni's name."

Pick any game, he says, and two constants appear: him and Sudhir Kumar Chaudhary, the Sachin Tendulkar fan.

Friends helped for a while,

“Sometimes I miss the deaths of my relatives. I am jobless. I can't do any job now. If I do a job, then I will not be able to watch the match. I have to leave a lot of things.”

RAM BABU
DHONI'S SUPERFAN

but Ram Babu stopped asking after a point. The financial situation at home was not good either. He got into trains without tickets instead. "I was caught by the TTE many times," he said. "I used to tell them my situation. If you want to put me in the cell, go ahead." Most let him travel. "If someone tells something with honesty, and if it comes from the bottom of the heart, others will also accept it."

Then came Bangladesh. The 2014 T20 World Cup. Ram Babu fell ill during the tournament — fever, dropping platelet count — but kept attending matches. He fell a few times in the stands. Dhoni called Ram Babu to practice ahead of the semifinal against South Africa, looked at the reports and said: "Your condition is very bad."

Ram Babu did not want to leave. India had not finished their campaign. He said he would manage the flag.

Dhoni explained first. "You don't have the strength to stand. So how will you watch the match? How will you wave a six-metre flag?" Ram Babu said he would manage. Then Dhoni asked him to show his passport. Ram Babu handed it over. Dhoni put it in his own pocket and told Ram Babu to leave. The phone rang at four in the morning. "Take your passport and go. Your flight is booked. 8 am to Chandigarh."

Ram Babu left on the morning of the semifinal. A doctor in Chandigarh told him: "Say thanks to Dhoni sir. One or two more days and your condition would have been very bad." Ram Babu has not forgotten. "That second life is thanks to Dhoni sir," he said.

He has one promise for himself, for the day it finally ends — when Dhoni walks away from the IPL. "I will leave IPL too."

KEY BATTLE

RCB fail to chase down SRH's mammoth score but make enough to finish in top 2

SYNOPSIS: It was an Orange party in Hyderabad as the SRH bowlers played their part after the batsmen went big.

Tanishq Vaddi
Hyderabad, May 22

WITH ISHAN Kishan leading the way with the bat and Heinrich Klaasen and Abhishek Sharma also playing key roles SRH had enough on the board to challenge the defending champions. SRH managed to keep the dangerous Royal Challengers Bengaluru batting lineup in check throughout the chase of 256 runs.

Orange party

"Boys are going to enjoy it tonight," is what Sunrisers Hyderabad skipper Pat Cum-

mins said at the toss, and his batters did just that. If anything, Royal Challengers Bengaluru bowlers would complain SRH indulged in too much hitting. RCB had plans. When these two sides first met on the opening night of the season, Jacob Duffy cramped the batters for room by hitting a hard length that worked well. They tried a similar ploy to start with, but SRH batters were prepared this time.

Travis Head came up with the plan, giving himself room and fiercely cutting the ball through the cover and point boundaries. For Abhishek, it did not matter much. Like he had been doing all season, it was to see the ball and hit the ball. When it was bowled into the body, he swatted over the legside. When it was on the off-stump, he smoothly sent it over the long-off boundary.

Rasikh Salam Dar bowled a fierce yorker on the off-stump after seeing Head backing away to give himself room. The delivery uprooted the Aussie's off-stump and ended the opening partnership. Ishan Kishan came in. 'Anchor' is not a word in usage, but if anything comes close to describing that role, it was Ishan's knock today.

When these two sides met in Bengaluru earlier, Ishan scored 80 from just 38 deliveries that night; all SRH did was attack, and they could only get 201. But today the evolution was there to be seen. Although his score was 79 off 46 balls—a lower strike rate compared to that day—his gear changing was precise. While Abhishek was going all guns blazing, Ishan took his time and let the other southpaw do the work.

After Abhishek fell, Kishan eased off the pressure with



Ishan Kishan made 79 from 46 balls to top score for SRH. AP

some boundary hitting when Heinrich Klaasen did not start as fluently as he would have liked. Klaasen was on five from nine deliveries, and then he hit a six against Josh Hazlewood off a pace off delivery into his favourite mid-wicket area. That kick-started his innings. He

scored 40 runs from the next 14 deliveries. It has not been too often this season that RCB has looked rattled on the field, but while the partnership between Kishan and Klaasen was going at a frantic pace, the bowling looked short of ideas. Klaasen-Kishan put on 113 runs from

● IPL table						
Teams	M	W	L	P	NRR	
RCB (Q)	14	9	5	18	0.783	
GT (Q)	14	9	5	18	0.695	
SRH (Q)	14	9	5	18	0.524	
RR	13	7	6	14	0.083	
PBKS	13	6	6	13	0.227	
KKR	13	6	6	13	0.011	
CSK (E)	14	6	8	12	-0.345	
DC	13	6	7	12	-0.871	
MI (E)	13	4	9	8	-0.510	
LSG (E)	13	4	9	8	-0.702	

just 48 deliveries.

Template defence

Once the runs were put on the board, the defence fell into the SRH template. Venkatesh Iyer started the chase by going ballistic. Cummins and wrist-spinner Shivang Kumar took a

severe beating. But once again, Eshan Malinga, who has been a nightmare for the batters here at Uppal, broke the partnership with his cunning variations. It was a delivery dug into the surface, which Iyer mishit to Abhishek at cow-corner. Sakib Hussain got Virat Kohli with a slower ball. And Malinga returned in the ninth over to dismiss Devdutt Padikkal, who was racing through his innings; the left-hander clipped one straight to Abhishek at the same position.

And around that 10th over mark, like it has been happening all season here, with the slightly oldish ball, the wicket started to stop a bit. SRH bowlers used the into-the-surface slower balls, suffocating both Rajat Patidar and Krunal Pandya. SRH identified the short ball as the length to contain the RCB skipper, and he

looked in quite a bit of discomfort. For his first 30 runs, he hit only three boundaries and no sixes, and his half-century came in 37 deliveries.

Krunal, at the other end, did not show any urgency or proactiveness to go after the bowling. With the required rate touching 20s, the shots chosen were quite safe. However, RCB only needed to get over 166 runs to finish in the top two, which is what was at stake for both teams coming into the game, and the visitors ticked their box.

BRIEF SCORES: SRH 255/4 in 20 overs (Abhishek Sharma 56, Ishan Kishan 79, Heinrich Klaasen 51; Rasikh Salam Dar 2/52) beat RCB 200/4 in 20 overs (Venkatesh Iyer 44, Rajat Patidar 56, Krunal Pandya 41 not out; Eshan Malinga 2/33) by 55 runs.

LIGHTENING STRIKES TWICE AT FED CUP

Kujur sprints into record books, Gurindervir follows

Animesh clocks 10.15s in heats to reclaim 100m national mark

Prithish Raj
Ranchi, May 22

THE WEATHER in Ranchi was breezy and calm when things started to heat up on the track as the much revered 100m national record fell twice within five minutes at Federation Cup Athletics on Friday.

First came a stunning run from former NR holder Gurindervir Singh, who clocked 10.17s, but as he posed for the pictures, the second heat of 100m semi-final commenced with current NR holder Animesh Kujur, gearing up for history. The 22-year-old from Chhatisgarh saw his training partner breaking the NR and thought, "If you can do it, I can do it too." He blazed to the finish line in 10.15s breaking the NR again and breaching the qualification mark for Commonwealth Games 2026.

"You know they are trying to kill each other on the track but are best buddies off track," quipped their coach James Hillier who was gushing at his two wards creating history. "These two lads are in very good shape but honestly, I was not thinking about the records, not in the semis. I just told them to run the race like you want to run in the final," he told *The Indian Express* on the sidelines.

This is the fourth time the duo has lowered the national record in past two years. At the start of 2025 in March, Gurindervir clocked 10.20s at Indian Grand Prix in Bengaluru to lower the previous national record of 10.23s of Manikanta Hoblihar. Animesh equalled it with 10.20s and then broke it in Greece last July, to clock 10.18s.

The cooler evening session of the Ranchi event was in complete contrast to the morning session when athletes struggled with heat and performances were sub-optimal. So the finals on Saturday evening at 7.10 pm, will be a cracker.

When the national record



Animesh Kujur celebrates after a blazing 100m run at the Federation Cup in Ranchi. PRITHISH RAJ

fell for the first time, the photo on the finish line showed Gurindervir leaning backwards as if he was holding himself back. "I just ran for the 80m mark," said Gurindervir before rushing for an ice bath session and soft tissue recovery.

Later coach Hillier clarified what he meant. "Since, he was running in the semis, I think he went all-in for the first 80m before just holding himself back. Now, I wish he didn't do that but it's fine because the final is also important for us," he explained.

But as Gurindervir reined himself in for a bit, he missed the Commonwealth Games qualification mark by 0.01s though he will have a chance again when he runs tomorrow in the 100m final.

Animesh blazes again

While Gurindervir rationed his effort, Animesh decided to go all out and just glided on the track after a superb start off the blocks. Animesh, who had troubles with his starts in the 100m, was quickly off the blocks and finished in a flash leaving the rest of the field and the onlookers in awe.

"You have to give it to Animesh. He is such a fierce competitor. He saw Guri doing the NR and said, 'I'll do it again. For Animesh, we had one target in mind and we have got it, the qualification for CWG,'" said Hillier. Gurindervir who was

• Ancy's record jump

ASIAN GAMES silver medallist Ancy Sojan recorded the third best Indian jump with an effort of 6.75m — behind Shaili Singh (6.76m) and Anju Bobby George (6.83m). However, she missed the CWG qualification mark of 6.84m. Shaili Singh won silver with a best jump of 6.58m.

RESULTS (FINALS): 10000m: Deepak Bhatt (29:42.93), Shailesh Kushwaha (29:57.56), Prashant Chaudhary (30:36.97); **Hammer Throw:** Ashish Jakhar (68.52m), Damneet Singh (67.62m), Ajay Kumar (64.93m); **3000m Steeplechase:** Balkrishna (8:56.01), Sharuk Khan (8:56.63), Sunil Joliya (8:58.38) **Women: 10000m:** Ravina Gayakwad (35:30.98), Sonia (36:16.22), Aarti Pawara (36:24.79); **Discus Throw:** Seema (57.29m), Nidhi Rani (55.05m), Krishna Jayshankar (55m)

also amazed at his compatriot's performance, gave him a hug and posed for couple of pictures before wheeling off.

"Me and Guri (Gurindervir) just laughed it off after Animesh's result. I mean Guri did what he had to but you can't top this. Important thing for both of them is to take rest, recover mentally and focus on the finals tomorrow," said Hillier. Hillier believes that the rise

of this group of sprinters has pushed the competition in the event to a different level. To put it in context, it took nine years for the Indian sprinters to improve the national record from 10.26s to 10.20s. But in the space of less than 12 months, the record has gone further down to 10.15s. "When you have a group of competitors who are regularly doing well at both national and international level, I think it pushes the envelope further. That is exactly what the group of these four (Gurindervir, Animesh, Manikanta, and Amlan) has done in the past two years," said Hillier.

With Gurindervir dipping below 10.20s, India has two sprinters below 10.20s for the first time in history. While the achievement doesn't look mammoth as compared to world levels, it is significant for a country that has barely known sprinters breaking national records so frequently.

"Both of them need to perform tomorrow. There is no point if you don't have a blazing 100m final," concluded Hillier.

As the sun would rise over Birsa Munda Stadium in Ranchi tomorrow, the spotlight will shift to the showdown between two of India's fastest men. Whether the national record falls yet again or not, one thing is certain — there will be drama, a sprinting drama.

100m final: 7pm, AFI YouTube channel

• BRIEFLY



Michael Carrick was initially appointed on an interim basis. REUTERS

Carrick to continue as Manchester United head coach until 2028

MANCHESTER UNITED have appointed Michael Carrick as their permanent manager on a contract until 2028, the Premier League club said on Friday, rewarding the former midfielder for the club's turnaround in fortunes in less than half a season. The 44-year-old Englishman has guided United to 11 victories in 16

matches to climb to third in the Premier League and seal a berth in next season's Champions League. "From the moment that I arrived here 20 years ago, I felt the magic of Manchester United. Carrying the responsibility of leading our special football club fills me with immense pride," he said. REUTERS

New low for Indian football in Asian tourneys

THE ADMINISTRATIVE mess in Indian football contributed to a new low in the continental stage as the country was handed just one play-off slot for the 2027-28 season of the AFC Challenge League, the third and last tier in Asia's club structure. In the past, Indian clubs had even played in the group stage of the top-tier AFC Champions League. PTI

Bhambri enters season's first final in Geneva

YUKI BHAMBRI locked his first ATP final of the season after the Indian and his New Zealand partner Michael Venus advanced to the doubles title clash of the Geneva Open with a straight-set win over Petr Rikl and Adam Pavlasek. They won 7-5, 6-3. PTI

OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR: ANIMAL HUSBANDRY UNIT DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT, GOVT. OF NCT OF DELHI ZORAWAR SINGH MARG, NEAR PURL MITHAI, TIS HAZARI DELHI-110054

TEL NO. 011-20833238

Email ID- directorahdelhigov@gmail.com

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NOTICE & DIRECTIVES ON THE OCCASION OF BAKRA-EID

On the occasion of the Bakra-Eid Festival to be celebrated in Delhi on 28th May 2026, there is a likelihood of a large number of animals being sacrificed in the traditional manner. All citizens are requested to celebrate the festival peacefully, responsibly, and in compliance with the laws and to kindly adhere to the following guidelines:

1. Animals should not be subjected to any cruelty during transportation.
2. The sacrifice of cows and camels is strictly prohibited.
3. Selling of Meat at unlicensed place is strictly prohibited.
4. Sacrifices should only be carried out at authorized locations. Do not perform sacrifices on roads, in streets, or in public places.
5. Do not allow blood to flow into drains or the public sewage system.
6. No illegal slaughter of animals will be permitted during the festival.
7. Sale and purchase of Animals in public strictly prohibited.
8. For any complaint/information contact nearest Police Station/PCR.

Sd/-
Director,

Animal Husbandry Unit
Development Department

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0068/26-27

Sinner chases history at French Open, rivals struggle to keep up

Namit Kumar
New Delhi, May 22

LET'S GET the superlatives out of the way.

In the injury-induced absence of Carlos Alcaraz, his only equal at the summit of present-day men's tennis, Jannik Sinner has been on a generational run. By becoming the first Italian to win their national open in 50 years last week in Rome, Sinner extended his winning streak to 29 matches. He joined Novak Djokovic in making history, becoming only the second player to have won each of the nine Masters 1000 events.

Sinner has beaten anyone and everyone—including Alcaraz in a final on clay—who have come in his way with a ruthlessness that suggests he is razor sharp heading into the French Open, starting Sunday. In Paris, he is hoping to become just the eighth man in history to complete the Grand Slam (winning each of the four Major tournaments) in the Open Era.

While Alcaraz beat him to the feat at the Australian Open, becoming the youngest to do so, victory at Roland Garros will allow Sinner to pip him to what is arguably a greater achievement in their series of one-upmanship.

He is aiming to become only the second player, once again after Djokovic, to win each of the 14 most significant tournaments in a tennis calendar: the nine Masters, the four Majors, and the year-end Finals. All at the ripe age of 24.

The achievements are staggering; Sinner has already gone places that eluded greats like Roger Federer and Rafael Nadal. Yet as he mounts his ascent to history at the French Open this fortnight, the object



Jannik Sinner is on a 29-match winning streak heading into the French Open. AP

of equal fascination is his stark lack of competition.

According to the pre-French Open rankings, Sinner is 9,000 points ahead of second seed Alexander Zverev. For context, winning a Major awards 2,000 points. It is a gulf that illustrates Sinner's dominance as much as it tells the story of a chasing pack that dithered and failed to take their opportunities while the duopoly was growing.

The challengers

Consider his list of challengers. Zverev is the nailed-on favourite to reach the final by seeding and prestige alone, but his history of mental fragility suggests that the pressure of those expectations alone will be tough to deal with. He also enters the tournament in indifferent form, having been hammered by Sinner in their last nine matches.

Djokovic will invariably take some headlines and deserves a mention, especially after his resounding victory over Sinner in their five-setter at the Australian Open this year. But at 39, the Serb is not much more than a part-timer who makes special

appearances at the Slams. He has played one match on clay this year: a first-round defeat to the World No. 71.

Go further down the list, and an even more unlikely set of challengers emerge. Plucky fourth seed Felix Auger-Aliassime seems to be having a career revival after bursting onto the tour as a teenager, but he has shown no signs of Major-winning pedigree.

The same can be said about fifth seed Ben Shelton, especially on his weakest surface of clay. Daniil Medvedev may enter the conversation; he did push Sinner quite hard in their semifinal in Rome last week. But his aversion to the surface of clay has reached internet meme-lore. He has also only won four matches in the last five Majors.

Not since Djokovic in his pomp a decade ago, or Nadal's god-like aura going into Roland Garros in the 2000s, has the build-up around a Major been so focused on one player. So, what if Sinner cracks? What if injury strikes at the wrong time or he succumbs under the burden of making history? Who is best positioned to take advantage?

To pick a conventional contender, all signs point back to Djokovic: unquestionably an indictment of how weak the world's current top 10 are if you take the two best players out of the reckoning.

Sinner has shown no signs of faltering under pressure. The circus-like atmosphere that follows a Major will put him and his bid for history under the spotlight, and in his current form, he remains overwhelmingly likely to get over the line. The question of 'If not Sinner, then who?', however, could cause all sorts of chaos.

Malaysia Masters: Chaliha's run ends in quarters



Ashmita Chaliha lost 23-21, 18-21, 11-21. BADMINTON PHOTO

Press Trust of India
Kuala Lumpur, May 22

INDIA'S ASHMITA Chaliha produced a spirited performance before going down narrowly to world No. 23 Line Hojmark Kjærsefeldt of Denmark in the women's singles quarterfinals of the Malaysia Masters Super 500 badminton tournament here on Friday.

Returning after an eight-month rehabilitation following a medial meniscus tear in her right knee, Chaliha squandered a hard-fought opening game advantage to lose 23-21 18-21 11-21 to the eighth seed in a contest lasting a little over an hour at the Axiata Arena. Chaliha started brightly, opening up an 11-6 lead at the interval in the opening game.

Line clawed her way back after the break to narrow the gap to 13-12 and later moved ahead 19-18, but the Indian held her nerve in a gruelling battle to pocket the game. The second game followed a similar pattern as Chaliha again surged ahead 10-5 before the Dane restored parity at 13-13. Line then broke away from 15-15 to force the match into a decider. The final game, however, was largely one-way traffic.

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